🎯 2026 PRELIMS & RO/ARO SPECIAL · COMPLETE CHAPTER-WISE PYQS

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PYQ MASTER

पर्यावरण एवं पारिस्थितिकी — अध्यायवार संपूर्ण प्रश्नोत्तरी

Consolidated Chapter-wise Practice Bank covering all 45 topics.

Exclusive Authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Questions Only • Structured Option Grids • Visible Answers & High-Yield Core Memory Lock Explanations.

UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Prelims 2026 • Active Recall Question Bank Series • 100% Exam-Verified Edition

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Chapter 01: Environment (पर्यावरण) Basics — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to 'Carrying Capacity of Environment', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The rate of resource extraction should remain above the rate of resource generation.
2. Generation of waste should remain within the absorption capacity of environment.

A Only 2	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2. Extraction must stay **below** regeneration.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Assertion (A): Sustainable development should take place without harming the environment and without compromising the needs of future generations.

Reason (R): Agenda 21 was signed by world leaders in 1995.

A Both true; R not explanation	**B** A false, R true
C A true, R false	**D** Both true; R explains A

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Agenda 21 = Rio **1992**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which pairs is/are NOT correctly matched? (Day)—(Date): 1. Ozone Day—16 Sept 2. WED—5 June 3. Wildlife Day—22 March

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 3
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Wildlife Day = **3 March**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to Lifestyle for Environment (LiFE), which statements is/are correct?

1. Launched June 2022. 2. Idea proposed at COP-25 Madrid.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Idea at COP26 Glasgow 2021.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Assertion (A): SD was popularised by Brundtland Report. Reason (R): Brundtland Report is also known as "The Limits to Growth."

A Both true; R not explanation
B A false, R true
C Both true; R explains A
D A true, R false

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Limits to Growth* = Club of Rome.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Plants and animals that live on land are called:

A Abiotic
B Aquatic habitants
C Terrestrial habitants
D Biotic

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which provision is part of both DPSP and Fundamental Duties?

A Guardians—education to children
B Protection of environment
C Workers in management
D UCC

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Art 48A + Art 51A(g).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which is an example of a Lotic Ecosystem?

A Swamps
B Ponds
C Rivers
D Marshy areas

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Balancing resource use while conserving for future generations is called:

A Resource Conservation
B Sustainable Development
C Future Resources
D Reducing Consumption

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Assertion (A): Population control necessary for environment. Reason (R): Rapid population increase maintains environmental balance.

A Both true; R explains A
B Both true; R not explanation
C A true, R false
D A false, R true

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Rapid growth **disrupts** balance.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Agenda-21 of Rio Summit (1992) is related to:

A Sustainable Development
B Polluter Pays
C Environmental Education
D Ozone preservation

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

When was the Environment (Protection) Act passed?

A 1971
B 1974
C 1981
D 1986

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which is NOT a Fundamental Duty?

A Protect monuments
B Protect & improve natural environment
C Safeguard public property
D Respect National Anthem

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Monument protection is not a listed FD.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

In which year was the Environment (Protection) Act passed?

A 1982
B 1986
C 1990
D 1992

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

World Ozone Day is celebrated on:

A 25 Dec
B 21 Apr
C 16 Sep
D 30 Jan

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Chapter 02: Ecology (पारिस्थितिकी) & Ecosystem (पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

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Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to 'Ecosystem', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Green plants in terrestrial ecosystem capture about 1% of energy of the sunlight that falls on their leaves.
2. Around 10% of organic matter reaches to the next higher level of consumers.

A Only 2	B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Both NCERT standard facts.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to lichens, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Lichens are very good indicators of pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A Only 2	B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Sensitive bio-indicators; fail in polluted air.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following statements is not true about "ecological niche"?

Options:

A Dominant species occupy extensive and broader ecological niche.	B Number of species becomes large in ecological niche of natural ecosystem, if resources are sufficient.
C Number of species becomes small in ecological niche, if resources are sufficient.	D Dominance of single species becomes minimum if the resource distribution is equitable in a habitat.

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: More resources → more species.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following is the correct sequence of phases of Biotic succession?

Options:

A Ecesis – Migration – Reaction – Stabilisation

B Ecesis – Migration – Stabilisation – Reaction

C Migration – Reaction – Stabilisation – Ecesis

D Migration – Ecesis – Reaction – Stabilisation

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Plants and animals that live on land are called:

A Abiotic

B Aquatic habitants

C Terrestrial habitants

D Biotic

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Most important factor for loss of biodiversity?

A Genetic assimilation

B Control of predators

C Destruction of natural habitat

D Pest control

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Aquatic plant used as biofertilizer in water-logged rice fields:

A Lemna

B Azolla

C Wolffia

D Trapa

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Azolla–Anabaena mutualism.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which of the following is an example of a Lotic Ecosystem?

A Swamps
B Ponds
C Rivers
D Marshy areas

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Desert-dwelling animals are called:

A Arboreal
B Terrestrial
C Fossorial
D Xericole

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Trophic levels are formed by—

A Organisms linked in a food chain
B Plants only
C Animals only
D Carnivorous animals only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Assertion (A): Population control is necessary to maintain the environment of the country.

Reason (R): Due to the rapid increase in population, environmental balance is maintained.

A Both true; R explains A
B Both true; R not explanation
C A true, R false
D A false, R true

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Rapid growth disrupts balance.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Assertion (A): Phytoplankton grow in abundance in the limnetic zone.

Reason (R): The limnetic zone is the open-water zone.

- **A** A false, R true
- **B** A true, R false
- **C** Both true; R not explanation
- **D** Both true; R explains A

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to 'ecological niche', which statements is/are correct?

1. It represents the range of conditions that a species can tolerate, the resources it utilizes, and its functional role in ecological systems.
2. Each species has a distinct niche.

- **A** Neither 1 nor 2
- **B** Both 1 and 2
- **C** Only 2
- **D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Assertion (A): Various components of an ecosystem are not interdependent.

Reason (R): Human activities have impacts on the environment.

- **A** Both true; R explains A
- **B** Both true; R not explanation
- **C** A true, R false
- **D** A false, R true

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Indicator of air pollution:

- **A** Puffballs
- **B** Algae
- **C** Lichen
- **D** Moss

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Chapter 03: Food Chain (खाद्य श्रृंखला) & Energy Flow — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

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Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to 'Ecosystem', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Green plants in terrestrial ecosystem capture about 1% of energy of the sunlight that falls on their leaves.
2. Around 10% of organic matter reaches to the next higher level of consumers.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: 1% capture at producer stage. 10% transfer between trophic levels.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Trophic levels are formed by—

A Organisms linked in a food chain
B Plants only
C Animals only
D Carnivorous animals only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The amount of energy during transfer from one trophic level to another in an ecosystem:

A Increases
B Decreases
C Remains constant
D May increase or decrease

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to food chains in ecosystems, which of the following is correct?

A Energy increases at higher trophic levels

B Energy decreases; ~10% transfers

C Energy is cyclic

D 50% transfers between levels

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Why are food chains generally short?

A Predators are lazy

B Progressive energy loss at each trophic transfer

C Too many species

D Nutrients are scarce

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Inverted pyramid of biomass is seen in:

A Grassland

B Open ocean

C Desert

D Tropical rainforest

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Inverted pyramid of numbers is seen in:

A Grassland

B Parasitic food chain on a tree

C Open ocean

D Pond

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which occupies the lowest trophic level?

A Tiger
B Phytoplankton
C Snake
D Eagle

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

In grassland chain Grass → Grasshopper → Frog → Snake → Hawk, trophic levels are:

A T1–T5 in order
B All T2
C Hawk = T1
D Grass = T2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which pyramid is always upright?

A Pyramid of biomass
B Pyramid of numbers
C Pyramid of energy
D All three

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Correct grassland food-chain order:

A Grass–Grasshopper–Frog–Snake
B Grass–Grasshopper–Snake–Frog
C Grasshopper–Frog–Grass–Snake
D Grasshopper–Snake–Frog–Grass

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Classic chain order, human trophic role, marine producers, 10% law, inverted biomass, DDT biomagnification. **Ans: A.** Producer → primary → secondary → tertiary consumer.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which constitutes a food chain?

- **A** Grass, wheat and mango
- **B** Grass, goat and human
- **C** Goat, cow and elephant
- **D** Grass, fish and goat

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Grass → goat → human.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

In a food chain, man is:

- **A** Producer only
- **B** Only primary consumer
- **C** Only secondary consumer
- **D** Primary as well as secondary consumer

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Humans eat plants and meat.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Main primary producers in the marine environment:

- **A** Phytoplankton
- **B** Seaweeds only
- **C** Marine angiosperms only
- **D** Aquatic bryophytes only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Phytoplankton**.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Decomposer organisms include:

- **A** Virus only
- **B** Fungi and bacteria
- **C** Virus and bacteria only
- **D** Virus, fungi and bacteria

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Fungi and bacteria — not virus in this framing.

Chapter 04: Biodiversity — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements regarding biodiversity hotspots:

1. They have high species endemism.
2. They have experienced significant habitat loss.

A Only 1	**B** Only 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following is the **most important factor responsible for the loss of biodiversity?**

A Genetic assimilation	**B** Control of predators
C Destruction of natural habitat	**D** Pest control

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

In National Parks, genetic diversity is maintained through—

A In-situ conservation	**B** Ex-situ conservation
C Gene pool	**D** None of the above

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The most biodiversity rich area in India is

A Gangetic plain
B Trans Himalayas
C Western Ghats
D Central India

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following statement is NOT true?

A Species diversity increases from equator towards poles
B Tropics harbour more species than temperate areas
C Greatest biodiversity occurs in Amazon rainforest
D Species diversity decreases from temperate areas towards poles

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

When the world biodiversity Day is observed?

A March 22
B May 22
C June 23
D April 16

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to lichens, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Lichens are very good indicators of pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Indicator species fact; succession indicators also sit in the Ecology & Ecosystem chapter.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

How many biodiversity hotspots are located in India?

A 2
B 4
C 6
D 8

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which is the most effective strategy for biodiversity conservation?

A Ex-situ only
B In-situ protected areas
C Captive breeding only
D Commercial farming

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Lion-tailed macaque is endemic to:

A Himalaya
B Western Ghats
C Sundarbans
D Thar Desert

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Who first used the term ‘biodiversity’?

A E.O. Wilson
B Norman Myers
C Walter G. Rosen
D A.G. Tansley

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Walter G. Rosen coined it in **1985**; Wilson popularised it later.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Among mathematical indices, which shows mean species diversity in a habitat at a local scale?

A Alpha
B Beta
C Gamma
D None

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Alpha = local; beta = between ecosystems; gamma = regional.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

India's first National Centre for Marine Biodiversity is at:

A Mumbai
B Jamnagar
C Bhavnagar
D Puducherry

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: NCMB is at **Jamnagar, Gujarat**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

true?

A Tropics harbour more species than temperate areas.
B Species diversity increases from equator toward poles.
C Greatest biodiversity occurs in Amazon rainforest.
D Species diversity decreases from temperate areas toward poles.

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Diversity **increases toward the equator**, not toward the poles.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which three criteria recognise Western Ghats–Sri Lanka and Indo-Burma as hotspots?

A Species richness, endemism, threat perception
B Vegetation density, ethnobotany, warm-humid adaptation
C Only rainfall and altitude
D Only invasive-species count

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Richness + endemism + threat — not density or ethnobotany alone.

Chapter 05: Habitat (वास स्थान), Flora (वनस्पति) & Fauna (प्राणीजात) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

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Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Plants and animals that live on land are called:

- **A** Abiotic
- **B** Aquatic habitants
- **C** Terrestrial habitants
- **D** Biotic

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Concept / Term)	List-II (Geographer / Region)
A Planting Hearth	1 Hungary
B Cryophyte Steppe	2 Adolf Engler
C World Floral Regions	3 C.O. Sauer
D Puszta Grassland	4 Arctic Tundra

- **A** 3 4 2 1
- **B** 2 1 4 3
- **C** 3 4 1 2
- **D** 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to MISHTI, which statements is/are correct?

1. It was initiated in 2019.
2. It aims to restore mangrove forests.

A Only 2	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Arrange chronologically: AMRUT, JNNURM, Jal Jeevan Mission, NUHHP.

A 2, 4, 1, 3	**B** 4, 2, 1, 3
C 2, 4, 3, 1	**D** 4, 2, 3, 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which pairs is/are NOT correctly matched? (Tribe — Habitat) — Masai — West Africa

A Only 1, 2 and 3	**B** Only 4
C Only 3 and 4	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Desert-dwelling animals are called:

A Arboreal	**B** Terrestrial
C Fossorial	**D** Xericole

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Among Desert, Mangrove, and Rainforest, which are terrestrial ecosystems?

Correct Answer: (Verified Key)
Core Memory Fact: esert and Rainforest** — Mangrove is transitional.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which is an example of in-situ conservation?

A Botanical garden
B Seed bank
C National park
D Zoo

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to habitat and niche, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Habitat is the functional role of a species in the community.
2. Niche is the role of a species.
3. Habitat and niche are interchangeable terms in all Prelims keys.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (niche = role). Statement 1 swaps habitat for niche. Statement 3 is false — habitat and niche are not interchangeable.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following habitat classes is/are correctly matched?

1. Terrestrial habitats are water-only systems such as oceans and lakes.
2. Aquatic — water
3. Mangrove/wetland — purely terrestrial only

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (aquatic = water). Statement 1 misdefines terrestrial. Statement 3 is false — mangrove/wetland is transitional, not purely terrestrial.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Adaptation)	List-II
A Arboreal	1 Burrows
B Fossorial	2 Trees
C Cursorial	3 Open plains
D Xericole	4 Desert

Code:

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Arboreal trees; fossorial burrows; cursorial plains; xericole desert.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Habitat loss is the number-one biodiversity threat.

Reason (R): Habitat corridors are used to reconnect fragmented patches.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** Both true; corridors respond to fragmentation but do not define why loss is #1.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to MISHTI, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. MISHTI stands for Mangrove Initiative for Shipping, Highways and Trade Infrastructure.
2. It comes from Union Budget 2023–24 under MoEFCC.
3. It was launched as a 2019 mangrove mission.

A Only 2
B 1 and 3
C Only 1
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (Union Budget 2023–24 / MoEFCC). Statement 1 invents a wrong expansion — MISHTI is Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Income. Statement 3 is false — it is not a 2019 mission launch.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Arrange the following in correct chronological order:

1. JNNURM 2. NUHHP 3. AMRUT 4. Jal Jeevan Mission

A 2-1-3-4
B 1-2-3-4
C 1-3-2-4
D 1-2-4-3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2005 → 2007 → 2015 → 2019.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Flora — animal life of a region
2. Fauna — plant life of a region
3. BSI — plant survey (Kolkata)
4. ZSI — animal survey (Kolkata)

A 3 and 4 only
B 1 and 2 only
C 1, 2 and 3 only
D 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Flora/fauna swapped in 1–2; BSI/ZSI correct.

Chapter 06: Protected Areas & Conservation — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following Ramsar sites are NOT located in Uttar Pradesh?

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel 2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary 3. Rudrasagar Lake 4. Sultanpur National Park

A 1 and 3	**B** 3 and 4
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists:

List-I (National Park / Sanctuary)	List-II (State)
A Dachigam	**1** Madhya Pradesh
B Keoladeo Ghana	**2** Rajasthan
C Kanha	**3** Kerala
D Periyar	**4** Jammu & Kashmir

A 4 2 1 3	**B** 2 4 3 1
C 4 2 3 1	**D** 1 2 4 3

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which pairs is/are NOT correctly matched? 1. Nokrek — Manipur 2. Manas — Assam 3. Agasthyamalai — Kerala

A Only 1	**B** Only 2
C Only 3	**D** Only 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match: A. Simlipal B. Nokrek C. Agasthyamalai D. Manas | 1. Kerala 2. Odisha 3. Assam 4. Meghalaya

A 1 2 4 3
B 3 1 4 2
C 2 4 3 1
D 2 4 1 3

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Simlipal=Odisha(2); Nokrek=Meghalaya(4); Agasthyamalai=Kerala(1); Manas=Assam(3).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

A Chandauli
B Mirzapur
C Sonbhadra
D Varanasi

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

In National Parks, genetic diversity is maintained through—

A In-situ conservation
B Ex-situ conservation
C Gene pool
D None of the above

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Dudhwa National Park is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

A Lakhimpur Kheri
B Pilibhit
C Bahraich
D Bijnor

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Keibul Lamjao National Park is located in which lake?

A Loktak
B Wular
C Dal
D Chilika

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

When was Project Tiger launched in India?

A 1972
B 1973
C 1992
D 2006

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Standard UPPCS High-Yield Principle.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following is NOT an example of in-situ conservation strategy?

A Biosphere reserve
B Botanical garden
C National Park
D Sacred groves

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Botanical garden is **ex-situ**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which pair is NOT correctly matched?

A Bandipur NP — Karnataka
B Manas WLS — Assam
C Periyar WLS — Kerala
D Simlipal NP — Madhya Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Simlipal is in **Odisha**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is India's main protected-area statute.
2. Terrestrial WPA strictness runs Community Reserve > Wildlife Sanctuary > National Park.
3. A Community Reserve is stricter than a National Park under WPA.

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 3
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (WPA 1972). Statement 2 reverses the strictness order (NP > WLS > Conservation/Community Reserve). Statement 3 is false — Community Reserve is the least strict of the three.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following pairs:

Category	WPA section teaching
1. Wildlife Sanctuary	Section 18
2. National Park	Section 35
3. Tiger Reserve	Section 38V (2006 path)

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A 1 and 2 only	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1, 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: All three pairs are correct. **Logic:** Sanctuary Sec. 18; NP Sec. 35; Tiger Reserve Sec. 38V.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Biosphere Reserve — Wildlife (Protection) Act statutory category like National Park
2. Biosphere Reserve — UNESCO MAB three-zone model (core → buffer → transition)
3. India's first Biosphere Reserve — Nilgiri (1986)

A 1, 2 and 3	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 2 only	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only pair 1 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** BR is MAB/UNESCO model — not a WPA category. Pairs 2–3 are correct.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): A National Park is the strictest terrestrial WPA protected area.

Reason (R): Grazing and forestry are largely banned in National Parks, and boundary change needs the State Legislature.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both true and R explains the strictness of National Parks. **A/R logic:** R states the hard restrictions that make NP the strictest WPA category.

Chapter 07: Wildlife Conservation (वन्यजीव संरक्षण) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following pairs is/are **NOT correctly matched? (Day — Date)**

1. Ozone Day — 16 September
2. World Environment Day — 5 June
3. World Wildlife Day — 22 March

A 1 and 2 only	**B** 3 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests international environment/wildlife observance dates; only one listed date is wrong. **Ans: B.** World Wildlife Day is observed on **3 March**, not 22 March. **Trap:** Ozone Day (16 September) and World Environment Day (5 June) are correct — do not pick options mixing them with the WWD error.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to **Operation Olivia, which of the following statements is/are correct?**

1. It is an Indian Coast Guard initiative to protect Olive Ridley turtles along the Odisha coast.
2. It is carried out mainly in August during the nesting season.

A 2 only	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Statement 1 tests agency, species, and coast; statement 2 tests nesting season timing. **Ans: D.** Operation Olivia is an ICG Odisha-coast turtle protection drive, but nesting runs **November–February**, not August. **Trap:** August sounds like a monsoon-adjacent season — Olive Ridley mass nesting on Odisha beaches peaks in winter.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Project Tiger was launched in India in the year—

A 1972
B 1973
C 1992
D 2006

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Separates WPA enactment year from flagship species programme launch year. **Ans: B.** Project Tiger began in **April 1973** under PM Indira Gandhi at Jim Corbett National Park. **Trap:** **1972** is the Wildlife (Protection) Act year — not Project Tiger.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which painkiller given to cattle is responsible for the near extinction of vultures in India?

A Ibuprofen
B Acetaminophen
C Aspirin
D Diclofenac

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Links veterinary NSAID use to gyps vulture population collapse through kidney failure after feeding on carcasses. **Ans: D.** **Diclofenac** in cattle carcasses caused catastrophic vulture mortality; India banned veterinary diclofenac in **2006**. **Trap:** Human painkillers in options are distractors — the crisis was from **veterinary** use on livestock.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following events in chronological order of their commencement:

I. Wild Life (Protection) Act
II. Biological Diversity Act
III. Project Tiger
IV. Project Elephant

A I, II, III, IV
B I, III, IV, II
C II, III, IV, I
D II, III, I, IV

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chronology of wildlife statutes and flagship species programmes from 1972 to 2002. **Ans: B.** Order: WLPA **1972** → Project Tiger **1973** → Project Elephant **1992** → Biological Diversity Act **2002**. **Trap:** Do not place BDA before Project Tiger — biodiversity legislation came **three decades** after the tiger programme.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Assertion (A): Twelve cheetahs arrived from South Africa to India in February 2023.

Reason (R): Restoring the cheetah population is considered to be a priority for India.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- **B** Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- **C** (A) is true but (R) is false.
- **D** (A) is false but (R) is true.

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests the February 2023 reintroduction fact under Project Cheetah; R tests whether cheetah restoration is a stated national priority that explains that translocation. **Ans: A.** Twelve cheetahs were airlifted from South Africa in February 2023 to Kuno National Park, and restoring cheetah is an explicit Project Cheetah priority — R explains A. **Trap:** Namibia cheetahs arrived later — do not confuse the **South Africa batch (Feb 2023)** with subsequent translocations.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has announced **'Dolphin Day'**, which will be celebrated on—

- **A** April 15
- **B** October 5
- **C** July 15
- **D** October 28

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests MoEFCC observance for the Ganges river dolphin — India's National Aquatic Animal. **Ans: B.** **National Dolphin Day** is observed on **5 October** to raise awareness for freshwater dolphin conservation. **Trap:** Do not swap with Wildlife Week (**2–8 October**) or World Environment Day (**5 June**).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

If a tortoise is listed under Schedule I of WPA 1972, it implies:

- **A** It is extinct in the wild
- **B** It enjoys the same protection level as the tiger
- **C** It is endemic to one state only
- **D** It may be hunted as vermin

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Schedule levels, Indian vs exotic fauna, and institution years are high-yield traps. **Ans: B.** Schedule I = maximum protection, same band as tiger.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Schedule VI plant cultivation under WPA:

- **A** Is allowed freely everywhere
- **B** Is banned under all circumstances
- **C** Needs a licence from CWLW / authorised officer
- **D** Applies only to genetically modified crops

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Cultivation of Schedule VI plants needs a licence — not an absolute ban.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Best place among options to see gharial in natural habitat:

A Pulicat Lake
B Deepor Beel
C Chambal River
D Bhitarkanika only

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Chambal / National Chambal Sanctuary; also Girwa–Katarniaghat. IUCN: Critically Endangered.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Kharai camel — which statements are correct?
1. Can swim in seawater 2. Grazes mangroves 3. Cannot be domesticated

A 1 and 2 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Kutch swimming camel; domesticated by graziers. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

naturally found in India?

A Star tortoise
B Monitor lizard
C Pygmy hog
D Spider monkey

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Spider monkeys are Central/South American. Pugmark technique estimates wild populations from footprints.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Animal Welfare Board of India was established under:

A Environment (Protection) Act, 1986
B Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960
C Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972
D Biological Diversity Act, 2002

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: AWBI **1962** under PCA **1960**. NTCA is statutory; NGRBA was PM-chaired.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Symbol of WWF since inception:

A Tiger
B Giant Panda
C Hornbill
D White Bear

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Ailuropoda melanoleuca*; WWF founded **1961**. World Tiger Summit **2010** = Saint Petersburg.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

India's largest fish among common options:

A Hilsa
B Marlin
C Whale shark
D Stonefish

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Whale shark; seasonal aggregations off Gujarat; protection push from ~2004.

Chapter 08: Forests & Forest Management — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

As per **ISFR 2023**, which districts of Uttar Pradesh had forest cover on **more than 20%** of their total geographical area?

1. Bahraich
2. Chandauli
3. Shravasti

A 1 and 2 only

B 3 only

C 2 and 3 only

D 1 only

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR district-level UP trap — only two districts cross the 20% forest-cover threshold. **Ans: C.** **Chandauli** and **Shravasti** exceed 20%; Bahraich is below that mark despite Terai forest presence. **Trap:** Bahraich is a Terai forest district but **does not** cross the 20% ISFR threshold — a frequent wrong pick.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to the **"Piral Lao – Paise Pao"** campaign, consider the following statements:

1. It helps reduce forest fires and provides income to villagers by collecting pine needles.
2. It was launched by the Chief Minister of Uttarakhand.

A 2 only

B Neither 1 nor 2

C 1 only

D Both 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests Uttarakhand chir-pine fire-fuel management campaign — purpose and launch authority. **Ans: D.** Villagers collect pine needles (**piral**) for cash while reducing summer fuel load; the campaign was launched under the **Uttarakhand CM**. **Trap:** This is a **Uttarakhand** scheme — not a default Uttar Pradesh flagship programme.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

****Joint Forest Management (JFM)** in India was launched through a MoEF resolution in—**

A 1982
B 1986
C 1990
D 1992

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Year fact for community–State co-management of degraded forest — distinct from FRA 2006. **Ans: C.** JFM began with a **June 1990** MoEF resolution creating Van Samrakshan Samitis / Forest Protection Committees. **Trap:** **1992** is Project Elephant — JFM is **1990**, eight years earlier.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

According to the **India State of Forest Report, 2017, what percentage of India's total geographical area was under forest cover?**

A 20.34%
B 22.34%
C 21.54%
D 23.54%

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** National ISFR 2017 headline forest-cover percentage from FSI Dehradun. **Ans: C.** ISFR 2017 reported forest cover at about **21.54%** of India's geographical area. **Trap:** Do not confuse with the **33% national policy target** — that is aspirational, not the 2017 measured cover.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Consider the following statements about **Uttar Pradesh:**

1. Forests constitute about **12.8% of the total geographical area of the State.**
2. The districts of **Jaunpur, Ghazipur and Ballia have no forest land.**

A 1 only
B Both 1 and 2
C 2 only
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR 2023 UP figure trap — outdated high percentage vs eastern UP zero-forest districts. **Ans: C.** ISFR 2023 gives UP forest cover about **6.24%**, not 12.8%; Jaunpur–Ghazipur–Ballia indeed have negligible forest land. **Trap:** Statement 1 uses an **outdated/higher** figure — do not accept both statements as true.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

As per **India State of Forest Report–2021, which State registered the **maximum increase in forest cover** during the last two years?**

A Kerala

B Assam

C Arunachal Pradesh

D Andhra Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR 2021 state-wise absolute gain ranking — distinct from highest percentage cover (Mizoram) or largest area (MP). **Ans: D.** **Andhra Pradesh** led absolute forest-cover gains (~647 km^2), followed by Telangana and Odisha in ISFR 2021. **Trap:** Mizoram leads **percentage** cover; Madhya Pradesh leads **total area** — neither is the ISFR 2021 **maximum increase** answer.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Under the **Forest Rights Act, 2006, the maximum area recognised under an **Individual Forest Right (IFR)** for cultivation/habitation is—**

A 2 hectares

B 4 hectares

C 10 hectares

D No statutory cap

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** FRA IFR ceiling per household — a standard coaching fact distinct from JFM benefit-sharing. **Ans: B.** IFR is capped at **4 hectares** per eligible household under FRA 2006. **Trap:** **10 hectares** is a common wrong guess — the statutory cap is **4 ha**.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The **Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980 was enacted primarily to—**

A Grant permanent land titles to forest dwellers

B Regulate diversion of forest land for non-forest use with prior central approval

C Establish Joint Forest Management committees nationwide

D Fix a 33% national forest-cover target by 1988

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Distinguishes FCA (diversion control) from FRA (rights), JFM (co-management), and NFP targets. **Ans: B.** FCA 1980 requires **prior approval** from the Centre/State for using forest land for non-forest purposes — the core anti-deforestation check. **Trap:** Forest dweller rights belong to **FRA 2006**, not FCA 1980.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which of the following is **NOT correctly matched?**

A ICRAF — Nairobi
B IIFM — Bhopal
C CAFRI — Banda
D TERI — New Delhi

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Institution–headquarters matching for forestry/agroforestry research bodies. **Ans: C.** **Central Agroforestry Research Institute (CAFRI)** is at **Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh**, not Banda. **Trap:** CAFRI sounds like it could be in Bundelkhand's Banda — the correct UP city is **Jhansi**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

In which of the following are provisions for the **protection and improvement of the environment and **safeguarding of forests and wildlife** found in the Constitution of India?**

A Only in the Directive Principles of State Policy
B Only in the Fundamental Duties
C Both (a) and (b)
D None of the above

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Constitutional environment mandate spans DPSP **Article 48A** and Fundamental Duty **Article 51A(g)**. **Ans: C.** **Art 48A** (DPSP) directs the State to protect environment, forests, and wildlife; **Art 51A(g)** makes it every citizen's duty. **Trap:** Neither provision sits alone — both pillars carry forest/environment language.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Tropical evergreen forests in India are typically found in:

A Malwa Plateau
B Chhotanagpur Plateau
C Western Ghats
D Only Himachal Pradesh

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** These stems recycle evergreen/teak/mangrove/NFP/ISFR traps from standard banks. **Ans: C.** Evergreen belts need >**200 cm** rain — Western Ghats, NE hills, A&N. Himachal is mainly pine/temperate, not tropical wet evergreen.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Teak is the dominant tree species of which forest type?

A Tropical rainforest
B Tropical moist deciduous forest
C Tropical thorn scrub
D Temperate grassland forest

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Teak dominates tropical moist deciduous (100–200 cm). **Madhya Pradesh** leads teak area among common options.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Red Sanders, which is correct?

- **A** It is a tropical rainforest tree of South India
- **B** It is endemic to dry deciduous South India / southern Eastern Ghats
- **C** It is a Himalayan conifer
- **D** It is found only in Sundarbans

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Pterocarpus santalinus* — Palkonda–Seshachalam / southern Eastern Ghats dry deciduous. Statement pairing it with tropical rainforest is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Mangroves function as a safety hedge against coastal calamities mainly because:

- **A** People never live near mangrove coasts
- **B** Trees provide post-disaster food and medicine only
- **C** Dense canopies alone stop every cyclone
- **D** Extensive roots keep trees from being uprooted by storms and tides

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Classic root-system explanation. Odisha is most cyclone-prone; Mahanadi mangrove loss raises risk.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which region has mangrove + evergreen + deciduous forests together?

- **A** Southern Saurashtra
- **B** North Coastal Andhra Pradesh
- **C** Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- **D** Himalayan Terai

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A&N mangrove cover ~**616–617 km^2** (ISFR 2021-style). Coringa = Godavari (AP); Bhitarkanika = Brahmani–Baitarni (Odisha).

Chapter 09: Pollution & Waste Management — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to **carrying capacity**, consider the following statements:

1. Resource extraction should remain **above** the rate of regeneration.
2. Waste generation should stay within the environment's **absorption capacity**.

A 2 only	B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	D 1 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Sustainable use requires extraction at or below regeneration and waste within absorption limits. **Ans: A.** Statement 2 is correct; statement 1 is wrong — extraction must be **at or below** regeneration, not above it. **Trap:** Statement 2 alone sounds incomplete — but statement 1 reverses the regeneration rule and makes "Both" wrong.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements about **lichens**:

1. Lichens are very good indicators of air pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A 2 only	B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	D 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bio-indicator sensitivity — lichens signal SO_2 pollution by declining, not thriving. **Ans: D.** Lichens are excellent pollution indicators but **die or disappear** in polluted air — they do not grow well there. **Trap:** Statement 1 is true and tempts "Both" — statement 2 is the classic reverse trap.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The **Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024** was prepared by which of the following?

1. Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
2. Central Water Commission (CWC)
3. Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

A 1 and 2 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Org–report matching — groundwater quality is CGWB's domain, not CPCB's air/water pollution mandate. **Ans: B.** The groundwater quality report is published by **CGWB only**. **Trap:** CPCB sets pollution standards but **does not** prepare the national groundwater quality report.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Coral bleaching in the **Andaman & Nicobar** region was primarily caused by—

A Increased coastal industrial effluents alone
B About **+2°C warming** of the Indian Ocean
C Heavy marine plastic pollution alone
D A **−4°C** drop in sea-surface temperature

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bleaching trigger is thermal stress on symbiotic zooxanthellae — warming, not cooling or pollution alone. **Ans: B.** Indian Ocean warming of about **+2°C** drove mass bleaching; pollution is a secondary stressor. **Trap:** **−4°C cooling** is physically opposite to bleaching mechanism — temperature **rise** expels algae.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act** was enacted in—

A 1974
B 1981
C 1986
D 2000

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Pollution law chronology — Water Act precedes Air Act and EPA in India's environmental statute stack. **Ans: A.** The Water Act was passed in **1974**; Air Act followed in **1981** and EPA in **1986**. **Trap:** **1981** is the Air Act — do not swap the two earliest pollution statutes.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Photochemical smog always contains—

A Phosphorus
B Ozone
C Methane
D Aluminium ion

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Los Angeles-type smog is a secondary-pollution product — O_3 and PAN from NOx + VOCs in sunlight. **Ans: B.** Photochemical smog characteristically includes **ground-level ozone** (plus PAN and other oxidants). **Trap:** London smog is **SO_2 + smoke** — ozone chemistry defines photochemical, not primary stack gases alone.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

According to UNEP's **Frontier Report–2022**, which Indian city ranked as the **world's second most noise-polluted city**?

A Kota
B Moradabad
C Indore
D Patna

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP noise hotspot from UNEP Frontier 2022 — brassware/industrial hub in western UP. **Ans: B.** **Moradabad (UP)** was flagged as the world's **second noisiest city** in Frontier Report 2022. **Trap:** Ghaziabad/Kanpur are air-pollution NCAP cities — **Moradabad** is the noise-specific PYQ city.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which of the following is the best **bio-indicator of air pollution**, especially sulphur dioxide?

A Moss on rocks in clean hills
B Lichens
C Mangrove pneumatophores
D Deep-sea sponges

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Standard bio-indicator fact — lichens lack protective cuticle and die when SO_2 rises. **Ans: B.** **Lichens** are sensitive SO_2 bio-indicators and decline sharply in polluted air. **Trap:** Moss grows in clean environments too — lichens are the textbook **air-pollution indicator** pair.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The **Basel Convention (1989)** primarily deals with—

A Transboundary movement of hazardous wastes
B Climate change mitigation commitments
C Ozone-depleting substances phase-out
D Wetland conservation (Ramsar sites)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty-purpose matching — Basel is the hazardous-waste shipment control regime. **Ans: A.** Basel controls **international movement and disposal of hazardous wastes**; India ratified in 1992. **Trap:** Montreal = ozone; UNFCCC/Kyoto/Paris = climate — Basel is **waste movement**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

India ranks **how high globally** in **e-waste generation**?

A 1st
B 2nd
C 3rd
D 5th

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** India e-waste volume rank after China and the USA under E-waste Rules 2022 framing. **Ans: C.** India is the **3rd largest e-waste generator** globally after China and the USA. **Trap:** **1st** is a frequent overestimate — India is top-tier but **third**, not first.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Anthropogenic pollution mainly raises—

A Only always instantly biodegradable gases
B Often persistent non-biodegradable pollutant loads
C Only pure rainwater
D Only stratospheric ozone repair

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bank stems on types, diseases, disasters, standards, and remediation so the chapter dump is absorbed. **Ans: B.** Human-driven pollution often adds slow/non-biodegradable loads.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Secondary pollutants include—

A Only stack CO emitted directly
B Ozone, PAN, and photochemical smog
C Only elemental nitrogen in air always
D Only pure argon

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Formed in the atmosphere from primary reactants + sunlight/chemistry.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

CO binds haemoglobin relative to oxygen—

A Weaker always
B About 200–300 times more strongly
C Never binds
D Only binds calcium

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Forms carboxyhaemoglobin and cuts O_2 delivery.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Bhopal Gas Tragedy gas / year—

A SO_2 in 1974

B Methyl isocyanate (MIC), 2–3 December 1984

C Only methane in 1991

D Only CO_2 in 2000

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Union Carbide pesticide plant, Bhopal.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Chernobyl is related to—

A Only acid rain in Manchester

B Nuclear accident (1986, Ukraine / then USSR)

C Only noise Rules 2000

D Only SUP ban 2022

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Classic radioactive pollution disaster teaching case.

Chapter 10: Climate Change (जलवायु परिवर्तन) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to the **LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment) Mission, consider the following statements:**

1. LiFE was launched in **June 2022.**
2. The idea was first proposed at **COP-25 in Madrid.**

A 2 only
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** LiFE launch date vs COP venue where PM Modi first floated the concept. **Ans: D.** LiFE launched **June 2022**; the idea was announced at **COP-26 Glasgow (2021)**, not COP-25 Madrid. **Trap:** COP-25 Madrid is a plausible-sounding UN climate venue — the correct pitch was **Glasgow 2021**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following international agreements relates to **climate change mitigation?**

A Montreal Protocol
B Ramsar Convention
C Kyoto Protocol
D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty-family trap — Montreal controls ozone; Kyoto/Paris address greenhouse-gas mitigation. **Ans: C.** The **Kyoto Protocol (1997)** imposed binding emission cuts on developed (Annex I) parties. **Trap:** **Montreal Protocol** is the most picked wrong answer — it phases out **ODS**, not CO_2 mitigation.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Coral bleaching in the **Andaman & Nicobar Islands was primarily caused by—**

A Increased coastal industrial effluents alone
B About **+2°C warming** of the Indian Ocean
C Heavy marine pollution alone
D A **−4°C** drop in sea-surface temperature

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Climate-impact stem — thermal stress on reef symbionts drives bleaching events. **Ans: B.** **+2°C Indian Ocean warming** triggered bleaching; pollution adds stress but warming is primary. **Trap:** Cooling (−4°C) would not expel zooxanthellae — bleaching follows **heat stress**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

What was India's rank in the world in **greenhouse gas emissions in 2022 (as framed in the paper)?**

- **A** 9th
- **B** 10th
- **C** 11th
- **D** 12th

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Rank framing trap — paper used a 9th–12th band; absolute total-emission rank is ~3rd. **Ans: B.** The keyed answer is **10th** (performance-index style framing in the paper). **Trap:** India is ~**3rd in absolute total emissions** — do not confuse with the paper's **10th** option key.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following is **NOT a greenhouse gas?**

- **A** Argon
- **B** Methane
- **C** Carbon dioxide
- **D** Nitrous oxide

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Non-GHG noble gas trap among Kyoto-basket gases. **Ans: A.** **Argon** is an inert atmospheric component and **not** a greenhouse gas. **Trap:** **Water vapour** is a natural GHG but absent here — **argon** is the keyed non-GHG distractor set.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Global warming is most directly linked to an increased frequency and intensity of—

- **A** Total solar eclipses
- **B** **Extreme weather events** such as heat waves and intense rainfall
- **C** Milankovitch ice-age cycles alone
- **D** Stratospheric ozone recovery

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Climate-impact consequence — enhanced greenhouse effect raises extreme-event probability. **Ans: B.** Warming intensifies **heat waves, droughts, floods, and cyclone rainfall** — core IPCC impact framing. **Trap:** Milankovitch cycles operate on **millennial** scales — they do not explain recent decadal extreme-weather rise.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Under the **Kyoto Protocol, quantified emission-reduction commitments applied primarily to—**

- **A** All UN member states equally
- **B** **Annex I developed countries**
- **C** Only Least Developed Countries
- **D** Only island nations

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CBDR architecture — Kyoto bound industrialised Annex I parties, not India or other developing countries. **Ans: B.** Kyoto's binding cuts targeted **Annex I (developed) countries**; developing nations had no binding targets. **Trap:** India is a major emitter today but was **not** under Kyoto binding cuts — Paris uses voluntary NDCs instead.

Q8 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2020**

The greenhouse-effect concept was postulated by:

- **A** C.C. Park
- **B** Joseph Fourier
- **C** L. Zobler
- **D** Arrhenius only in 1990s

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Joseph Fourier in the **1820s**.

Q9 **UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1**

responsible for global warming?

- **A** Methane
- **B** Water vapour
- **C** Argon
- **D** Carbon dioxide

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Argon is **not** a greenhouse gas.

Q10 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2019**

Decreasing order of contribution commonly tested:

- **A** CO_2 > CH_4 > CFCs > N_2O
- **B** CH_4 > CO_2 > CFCs > N_2O
- **C** CO_2 > N_2O > CH_4 > CFCs
- **D** CFCs > CO_2 > CH_4 > N_2O

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: WMO-style share order used in many Indian papers.

Q11 **UP RO/ARO 2016**

methane and nitrous oxide is:

- **A** Cotton
- **B** Rice
- **C** Sugarcane
- **D** Wheat

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Paddy anaerobic CH_4 + fertiliser N_2O.

Q12 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2018**

Carbon fertilization best describes:

A Ocean acidification from CO_2

B Increased plant growth from higher atmospheric CO_2

C Global warming from CO_2 alone

D Adaptation of all species to climate change

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: More photosynthesis / greening from elevated CO_2.

Q13 **UPPCS (PRE) 2017**

Without the greenhouse effect, Earth's average surface temperature would be about:

A 0°C

B −18°C

C 5°C

D −20°C

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Roughly **−18°C**.

Q14 **UPPCS (PRE) 2016**

above pre-industrial levels, which impacts are plausible?

1. Terrestrial biosphere tends toward a net carbon source
2. Widespread coral mortality
3. All global wetlands permanently disappear
4. Cereals cannot be cultivated anywhere

A 1 only

B 1 and 2 only

C 2, 3 and 4 only

D All four

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** +2°C already implies widespread coral mortality; +3°C adds net carbon-source risk. Absolute "all wetlands" / "no cereals anywhere" are overstated. **Ans: B

Q15 **UP RO/ARO 2014**

Green Climate Fund was established at:

A Durban COP

B Cancun COP-16 (2010)

C Paris COP-21 only as first idea

D Stockholm 1972

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Cancun **2010** under UNFCCC.

Chapter 11: Ozone Layer — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

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Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements about the **ozone layer:**

1. The ozone layer protects Earth from harmful **ultraviolet radiation.**
2. Ozone depletion has been linked to **chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs).**

A 2 only	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Basic ozone-layer function and anthropogenic ODS link — both are standard textbook facts. **Ans: C.** Stratospheric O_3 absorbs UV-B/C; CFCs release catalytic chlorine that destroys ozone. **Trap:** Tropospheric ozone is a **pollutant** — the protective layer is **stratospheric**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following pairs is/are **NOT correctly matched? (Day — Date)**

1. Ozone Day — 16 September
2. World Environment Day — 5 June
3. World Wildlife Day — 22 March

A 1 and 2 only	**B** 3 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** International observance dates — Ozone Day and WED are correct; one wildlife date is wrong. **Ans: B.** **World Wildlife Day is 3 March**, not 22 March; Ozone Day (16 Sept) and WED (5 June) are correct. **Trap:** Do not confuse **Ozone Day (16 September)** with **World Environment Day (5 June)**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which international agreement relates to **climate change mitigation?**

A Montreal Protocol	B Ramsar Convention
C Kyoto Protocol	D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Cross-topic treaty trap — Montreal is ozone/ODS; Kyoto is climate mitigation. **Ans: C.** **Kyoto Protocol** targets greenhouse-gas cuts; Montreal controls ozone-depleting substances. **Trap:** Montreal is the most common wrong pick in "climate treaty" stems — it is **not** a climate convention.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The **ozone layer, which absorbs ultraviolet radiation, exists in which layer of the atmosphere?**

A Troposphere	B Mesosphere
C Stratosphere	D Thermosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Atmospheric layer fact — peak ozone concentration and UV shield sit in the stratosphere. **Ans: C.** The ozone layer lies mainly in the **stratosphere** (about 15–35 km), not the troposphere. **Trap:** Ground-level ozone in the **troposphere** is harmful smog — opposite of the protective stratospheric layer.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

****International Ozone Day** is observed every year on—**

A 5 June	B 16 September
C 22 March	D 2 February

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Montreal Protocol anniversary observance date. **Ans: B.** World Ozone Day / International Ozone Day is **16 September** — the date the Montreal Protocol was signed (1987). **Trap:** **5 June** is World Environment Day — not Ozone Day.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

****World Ozone Day** is celebrated on—**

A 3 March	B 5 June
C 16 September	D 22 April

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Repeat observance-date fact for ozone protection awareness. **Ans: C.** World Ozone Day falls on **16 September** each year. **Trap:** **3 March** is World Wildlife Day — another frequent date-swap distractor.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Maximum concentration of **atmospheric ozone is found in the—**

A Troposphere
B Stratosphere
C Mesosphere
D Ionosphere

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Vertical ozone profile — Chapman production peaks in stratosphere near ~25 km. **Ans: B.** Ozone concentration peaks in the **stratosphere**, where UV photolysis builds the ozone layer. **Trap:** Troposphere has some ozone as **pollution**, but not the maximum column density.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The **Montreal Protocol primarily controls—**

A Transboundary hazardous waste trade
B Phase-out of **ozone-depleting substances (ODS)**
C Wetland encroachment in Ramsar sites
D Carbon credit trading under Kyoto

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Montreal = ODS phase-out under Vienna Convention framework — universal ratification success story. **Ans: B.** Montreal mandates phased elimination of **CFCs, halons, carbon tetrachloride**, and later HCFCs/HFCs (Kigali). **Trap:** Kyoto/Paris handle **GHGs** — Montreal is exclusively **ozone/ODS**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to ozone, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. tropospheric ozone is protective “good” ozone.
2. Tropospheric ozone is a ground-level pollutant.
3. About 90% of ozone is tropospheric.

A Only 2
B Only 1
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 2 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is true. Statement 3 is false.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A UV-A	1 Fully blocked
B UV-B	2 Reaches surface
C UV-C	3 Mostly blocked by ozone

Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3

B A-3, B-2, C-1

C A-2, B-3, C-1

D A-1, B-3, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1. **Logic:** UV-A reaches; UV-B mostly blocked; UV-C fully blocked.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Ozone hole — physical cavity in the sky
2. Ozone hole — column ozone often below 220 DU
3. 1 DU ≈ 0.01 mm pure ozone at 0°C, 1 atm

A 1, 2 and 3

B 2 and 3 only

C 1 and 2 only

D 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only pair 1 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** Hole is a column-ozone definition — not a physical hole.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Antarctic ozone hole peaks in Southern Hemisphere spring (September–October).

Reason (R): Polar stratospheric clouds and the polar vortex enable chlorine/bromine catalytic destruction.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Both true and R explains the spring peak chemistry. **A/R logic:** PSC + vortex + ODS chemistry.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Arrange the treaty chain:

1. Vienna Convention
2. Montreal Protocol
3. Kigali Amendment

A 1-2-3	**B** 2-1-3
C 1-3-2	**D** 3-2-1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1985 → 1987 → 2016. **Logic:** Vienna–Montreal–Kigali.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to ODS, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Main ODS include CFCs, Halons, CCl_4, methyl chloroform, methyl bromide, HCFCs.
2. One chlorine atom destroys only about ten ozone molecules before becoming inert.
3. HFCs are classic ODS under the original Montreal ODS list.

A 1 and 3	**B** Only 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 correctly lists main ODS. Statement 2 understates catalytic destruction (~10^5 ozone molecules per Cl). Statement 3 is false — HFCs are not classic Montreal ODS (Kigali/climate, not original ODS list).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Discovery of Antarctic ozone hole — 1985 Farman–Gardiner–Shanklin (BAS)
2. International Ozone Day — 16 September
3. Montreal Protocol — climate Kyoto GHG targets

A 1 and 3 only	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 2 only	**D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Montreal = ozone ODS — not Kyoto climate.

Chapter 12: Acid Rain (अम्ल वर्षा) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

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Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Assertion (A): CO_2, SO_2 and NO_2 dissolve in rainwater and produce acid rain.

Reason (R): Air is polluted due to high concentration of CO_2, SO_2 and oxides of nitrogen.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- **B** (A) is false but (R) is true.
- **C** Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is **not** the correct explanation of (A).
- **D** (A) is true but (R) is false.

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests whether all three gases dissolve in rain; R tests a generic air-pollution statement and whether it explains **strong acid rain** from SO_2/NOx vs weak carbonic acid from CO_2. **Ans: C.** All three dissolve (A true) and polluted air (R true), but R does **not explain** why **SO_2/NOx** drive severe acid rain while **CO_2** gives only weakly acidic normal rain (~pH 5.6). **Trap:** "Both true; R explains A" ignores that **CO_2 alone** cannot explain coal-driven **H_2SO_4/HNO_3** acid rain.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements about **pH**:

1. Acidic solutions have pH **more than 7**.
2. Basic solutions have pH **less than 7**.

- **A** 2 only
- **B** Neither 1 nor 2
- **C** Both 1 and 2
- **D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Fundamental pH scale reversal trap — acidic < 7, basic > 7. **Ans: B.** Both statements reverse the scale — **acidic < 7**, **basic > 7**. **Trap:** Statement 1 alone sounds plausible if you confuse "more acid" with "higher number" — pH numbers **decrease** as acidity rises.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following gas/gases is/are **lighter than air?**

1. Hydrogen chloride
2. Sulfur dioxide
3. Helium

A 1 and 2 only	**B** 3 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Molecular weight vs air (≈29 g/mol) — HCl and SO_2 are heavier; helium is lighter. **Ans: B.** Only **helium** is lighter than air; **HCl** and **SO_2** are denser and accumulate near ground. **Trap:** SO_2 is linked to acid rain but is **heavier than air** — do not assume all acid-rain gases rise quickly.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Consider the following statements about **lichens:**

1. Lichens are very good indicators of air pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A 2 only	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bio-indicator sensitivity to SO_2 — presence signals clean air; absence signals pollution. **Ans: D.** Lichens indicate pollution levels but **decline or die** in high SO_2 — they do not thrive there. **Trap:** "Good indicator" does not mean "grows well in pollution" — sensitivity means **loss**, not growth.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Normal unpolluted rain is slightly acidic (pH ≈ **5.6) primarily because of dissolved—**

A Sulphur dioxide from coal plants	**B** **Carbon dioxide** forming weak carbonic acid
C Nitrogen oxides from vehicles	**D** Hydrochloric acid from volcanoes

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Natural rain acidity vs anthropogenic acid rain — CO_2 equilibrium vs SO_2/NOx strong acids. **Ans: B.** Atmospheric **CO_2** dissolves to form weak **H_2CO_3**, giving natural rain pH about **5.6**. **Trap:** **SO_2/NOx** cause severe acid rain (pH < 5.6) — CO_2 alone cannot drop rain to ~4.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Acid rain is primarily caused by atmospheric emissions of—

A CO_2 and methane

B **SO_2 and NOx**

C CFCs and halons

D Ozone and PAN only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Primary acid-rain precursors form H_2SO_4 and HNO_3 in the atmosphere. **Ans: B.** **SO_2** (coal, smelters) and **NOx** (vehicles, high-temperature combustion) are the main acid-rain precursors. **Trap:** CO_2 is emitted with coal but produces only **weak** acidity — not the main anthropogenic acid-rain driver.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Flue Gas Desulphurisation (FGD) scrubbers are installed mainly at—

A Vehicle exhaust pipes

B **Thermal power plant chimneys**

C Municipal landfill vents

D Agricultural field boundaries

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** FGD hardware removes SO_2 from stack gas before release — TPP acid-rain prevention. **Ans: B.** FGD passes flue gas through lime/limestone slurry at **coal thermal power plants**, removing **90%+ SO_2**. **Trap:** Vehicle NOx uses **catalytic converters**, not FGD scrubbers.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Yellowing and pitting of the **Taj Mahal** marble is primarily attributed to—

A Carbon dioxide from tourist breathing

B **SO_2 pollution** and acid deposition forming gypsum crust

C Ozone hole ultraviolet alone

D Plastic waste micro-abrasion only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Taj Trapezium classic case — sulphuric acid attack on calcium carbonate marble. **Ans: B.** **SO_2** from Mathura refinery and Firozabad industries caused **gypsum ($CaSO_4$) crust** on marble — acid deposition damage. **Trap:** CO_2 is present everywhere but **SO_2 + acid rain** is the documented Taj damage pathway.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to acid rain, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Acid rain means wet or dry acidic deposition with pH below 5.6.
2. Normal unpolluted rain is exactly pH 7 because CO_2 never dissolves in rain.
3. Normal rain is exactly pH 7.

A 2 and 3	B Only 1
C 1 and 2	D Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is the acid-rain <5.6 definition. Statement 2 is false — normal rain is already ~pH 5.6 from $CO_2 \rightarrow H_2CO_3$. Statement 3 repeats the pH-7 trap.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Wet deposition	1 Gases/particles without rain
B Dry deposition	2 Acids in rain/snow/fog
C SO_2 path	3 $\rightarrow H_2SO_4$

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Wet rain; dry particles; $SO_2 \rightarrow H_2SO_4$.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. NOx $\rightarrow HNO_3$ comes mainly from quiet soil respiration, never from vehicles or high-temperature combustion.
2. $SO_2 \rightarrow H_2SO_4$ — coal TPPs, smelters, refineries
3. $CO_2 \rightarrow$ severe acid rain main culprit

A Only 2	B 1 and 3
C Only 1	D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true ($SO_2 \rightarrow H_2SO_4$ from coal TPPs/smelters). Statement 1 denies the vehicle/combustion NOx pathway. Statement 3 is false — CO_2 sets weak baseline rain, not severe acid rain.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Freshwater below about pH 5 stresses fish and can release toxic Al^{3+}.

Reason (R): Each pH step down multiplies H^+ by 10.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; logarithmic scale fact does not specifically explain fish/Al^{3+} stress. **A/R logic:** Related chemistry; R not the biological explanation.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to receptors, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Conifers are among the least sensitive forest receptors to acid deposition.
2. Marble/limestone can form gypsum crust under sulphuric attack.
3. Lichens thrive best in high SO_2 air.

- **A** 1 and 3
- **B** Only 2
- **C** 2 and 3
- **D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (marble/limestone → gypsum crust). Statement 1 is false — conifers are especially sensitive. Statement 3 is false — lichens decline in high SO_2 air.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Arrange prevention tools teaching:

- **A** Only ban all rain
- **B** FGD scrubbers, catalytic converters, low-sulphur coal, cleaner fuels/BS-VI
- **C** Increase SO_2 emissions only
- **D** Remove all oxygen from air

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: FGD, converters, cleaner fuels. **Logic:** Standard prevention set.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Gothenburg Protocol — acidifying emissions under CLRTAP family
2. Montreal — ozone ODS
3. Gothenburg — identical to Montreal ozone treaty

A 1 and 2 only

B 2 and 3 only

C 3 only

D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only pair 3 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** Different problems.

Chapter 13: Desertification (मरुस्थलीकरण) & Land Degradation (भू-क्षरण) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

India aims to achieve **Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN)** by—

A 2025
B 2030
C 2035
D 2040

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SDG 15.3 target year for no net loss of healthy land. **Ans: B.** LDN target year is **2030** under **SDG 15.3**. **Trap:** **2025** is a near-term distractor — LDN is pegged to the **2030 Agenda** timeline.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements about **earthworms**:

1. Earthworms increase soil fertility and are known as friends of farmers.
2. Earthworms have **two pairs** of hearts.

A 2 only
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Soil-biology fact plus anatomy trap — earthworms aid fertility but have five aortic arches, not two hearts. **Ans: D.** Statement 1 is correct; earthworms have **5 pairs of hearts** (aortic arches), not 2. **Trap:** "Friends of farmers" makes statement 1 obviously true — statement 2's wrong heart count is the eliminator.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Arrange the following programmes **chronologically:**

1. Food for Work Programme
2. Community Development Programme (CDP)
3. Training of Rural Youth for Self-Employment (TRYSEM)
4. Drought Prone Areas Programme (DPAP)

A 4, 2, 3, 1
B 2, 4, 1, 3
C 2, 4, 3, 1
D 4, 2, 1, 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dryland/rural development scheme chronology — CDP earliest, TRYSEM latest in the set. **Ans: B.** Order: CDP **1952** → DPAP **1973** → Food for Work **1977** → TRYSEM **1979**. **Trap:** **1952** belongs to **CDP**, not DPAP — DPAP is **1973**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following is **NOT a cause of land degradation?**

A Overgrazing
B Unsustainable mining
C **Afforestation**
D Improper irrigation leading to salinization

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Cause vs remedy trap — tree planting prevents degradation; other options accelerate it. **Ans: C.** **Afforestation** prevents degradation; overgrazing, mining, and salinization **cause** it. **Trap:** Deforestation causes degradation — **afforestation** is the opposite intervention.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The international treaty to combat **desertification is—**

A UNFCCC
B **UNCCD**
C Montreal Protocol
D MARPOL

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty-purpose matching — UNCCD = desertification; UNFCCC = climate. **Ans: B.** **UNCCD (1994, Paris)** is the desertification convention; World Desertification Day is **17 June**. **Trap:** **UNFCCC** is climate — do not swap the two "UN" environmental treaties.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

A major consequence of **soil erosion in river basins is—**

A Increased stratospheric ozone

B **Silting of rivers and reservoirs**

C Expansion of coral reefs

D Permanent ocean acidification reversal

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Erosion sediment pathway — topsoil enters streams and reduces dam storage capacity. **Ans: B.** Eroded soil **silts rivers and reservoirs**, raising flood risk and cutting irrigation/hydropower storage. **Trap:** Erosion removes topsoil on land first — **downstream silting** is the classic basin-scale consequence.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The **Chambal ravines are a classic example of—**

A Wind deflation in the Thar Desert

B **Gully/ravine erosion** across MP–UP–Rajasthan

C Glacier-scoured valleys in the Himalaya

D Coastal retreat from sea-level rise

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Badland ravine geography — water erosion end-stage in soft alluvial banks of the Chambal. **Ans: B.** Chambal badlands (~3 million ha) span **MP, UP, and Rajasthan** — advanced **gully/ravine erosion**. **Trap:** Thar has **wind erosion** — Chambal is **water/gully** erosion, not aeolian deflation.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which pair is **correctly matched?**

A Thar Desert — wind erosion hotspot

B Chambal — stratospheric ozone hole

C **MARPOL — marine pollution**; **UNCCD — desertification**

D Afforestation — primary cause of land degradation

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty and process matching — MARPOL vs UNCCD is a standard confused-pair trap. **Ans: C.** **MARPOL** regulates **ship-source marine pollution**; **UNCCD** addresses **land degradation/desertification**. **Trap:** UNCCD is **not** marine pollution — that is **MARPOL's** domain.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to desertification, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is land degradation in arid, semi-arid, and dry sub-humid (ASDM) areas.
2. It is only "the desert expanding physically."
3. Desertification is driven only by pure geology, never by climate variation or human pressure.

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 3
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is the UNCCD-style ASDM definition. Statement 2 is the classic trap (not merely desert expansion). Statement 3 denies climate + human drivers.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Land degradation applies only inside hot deserts and never on other lands.
2. Desertification — ASDM dryland subset
3. Desertification — identical to all waterlogging worldwide only

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 3
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (desertification = ASDM subset). Statement 1 is false — land degradation is the broader productivity decline on any land. Statement 3 is false — desertification ≠ all waterlogging worldwide.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to India degraded land, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. About 96.4 million ha / ~29–30% (ISRO Desertification Atlas 2008 class).
2. Rajasthan is often the worst state hotspot teaching.
3. India has zero degraded land.

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 3
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (Rajasthan hotspot teaching). Statement 1 uses the right magnitude but the wrong atlas year — ISRO Desertification Atlas class figure is **2016**, not 2008. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Arrange water-erosion sequence:

A Sheet → rill → gully → ravine

B Ravine → gully → rill → sheet

C Gully → sheet → ravine → rill

D Rill → sheet → ravine → gully

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Sheet → rill → gully → ravine. **Logic:** Chambal = ravine end-member.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Chambal badlands are the ravine end-member of water erosion.

Reason (R): Wind erosion works by deflation and abrasion.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; wind processes do not explain Chambal ravines. **A/R logic:** Water vs wind tools.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Thar	1 Salinization belt teaching
B Chambal	2 Wind erosion
C Punjab–Haryana	3 Ravines

Code:

A A-3, B-2, C-1

B A-2, B-3, C-1

C A-2, B-1, C-3

D A-1, B-3, C-2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1. **Logic:** Thar wind; Chambal ravines; Punjab–Haryana salinity.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to UNCCD, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Adopted in 1994.
2. Desertification and Drought Day is 17 June.
3. UNCCD is identical to UNFCCC.

A 1 and 3 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Different conventions.

Chapter 14: Environmental Impact Assessment — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to **carrying capacity**, consider the following statements:

1. Resource extraction should remain **above** the rate of regeneration.
2. Waste generation should stay within the environment's **absorption capacity**.

A 2 only
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** EIA/sustainable-development crossover — anticipatory assessment assumes waste and resource use within environmental limits. **Ans: A.** Sustainable carrying capacity requires waste within absorption limits; extraction must be **at or below** regeneration — not above. **Trap:** EIA stems often embed carrying-capacity logic — statement 2 alone is the sustainable-use rule.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Environmental Clearance (EC) for large Category A projects is granted by—

A Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
B **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**
C Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)
D Botanical Survey of India (BSI)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Parallel to CGWB≠CPCB trap — EC authority is MoEFCC/SEIAA, not pollution boards. **Ans: B.** **MoEFCC** (through EAC recommendation) grants **Category A EC**; CPCB sets standards but does **not** grant clearance. **Trap:** CPCB is the default wrong pick when stems mention "central environment body."

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The **Environment (Protection) Act, 1986** — which enables EIA notification — was preceded by which chronological pair of pollution statutes?

A Air Act 1974; Water Act 1981
B Water Act 1974; Air Act 1981
C Water Act 1981; Air Act 1974
D EPA 1986; Water Act 1974

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Environmental law stack order before EPA 1986 as EIA enabling Act. **Ans: B.** **Water Act 1974** came first, then **Air Act 1981**, then **EPA 1986** (EIA Notification 2006 derives from EPA). **Trap:** Swapping Water and Air years (**1981/1974**) is the standard chronology trap.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Environmental Clearance for Category A projects is finally granted by—

A Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC) directly
B **MoEFCC on EAC recommendation**
C Central Pollution Control Board
D National Green Tribunal

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** EAC recommends; MoEFCC/SEIAA grants — tribunal hears appeals only. **Ans: B.** **EAC/SEAC recommend**; **MoEFCC** (Category A) or **SEIAA** (Category B) **grant** EC. **Trap:** EAC **does not** issue final clearance — it only appraises and recommends.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

In India, **EIA is mandatory** for—

A Every economic activity in the country
B **Projects listed in the EIA Notification Schedule**
C Only foreign-investment projects
D Only mining projects below 1 ha

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Project EIA applies to scheduled categories, not universal mandatory assessment. **Ans: B.** EIA applies to **listed Schedule projects** under EIA Notification 2006 — not all activities. **Trap:** "All projects" sounds environmentally strict but is **legally false** — only scheduled categories.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

India's **EIA Notification** is issued under powers of the—

A Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974
B Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981
C **Environment (Protection) Act, 1986**
D Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** EPA 1986 is the umbrella enabling Act for EIA, ESZ, CRZ notifications — not Water/Air Acts alone. **Ans: C.** EIA Notification is promulgated under **EPA 1986** Section 3 powers. **Trap:** Water/Air Acts create **consent regimes** (SPCB) — they do **not** authorise project EC notification.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The **National Green Tribunal** was established under an Act passed in—

A 1986
B 2005
C **2010**
D 2015

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NGT Act year distinct from EPA 1986 — tribunal operational from 2011. **Ans: C.** **NGT Act, 2010** established the tribunal; it became operational in **2011**. **Trap:** EPA **1986** followed Bhopal — NGT came **24 years later**, not the same statute.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

****Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA)** is conducted at the level of—**

A Individual factory chimneys only

B **Policies, plans and programmes**

C Single-tree plantation plots

D Household kitchen waste only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SEA vs EIA level — upstream PPP assessment before project-level EIA. **Ans: B.** SEA evaluates **policies, plans, and programmes (PPP)**; EIA is **project-level**. **Trap:** India has mandatory **project EIA** but **no standalone SEA statute** — yet SEA concept applies at PPP level internationally.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The **Espoo Convention mainly concerns—**

A Transboundary **Environmental Impact Assessment**

B Whaling quotas in the Southern Ocean

C Acid rain only in Europe

D CFC phase-out schedules

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Espoo = transboundary EIA; SEA Protocol (Kiev 2003) extends to plans/programmes. **Ans: A.** **Espoo Convention (1991)** requires transboundary EIA for projects likely to cause significant cross-border impact. **Trap:** Gothenburg/CLRTAP = acid rain; Montreal = ODS — Espoo is **EIA-specific**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to EIA, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. EIA studies likely environmental effects before approval.
2. EIA's aim is only reactive cleanup after damage is complete.
3. EIA is only done after project completion always.

A Only 2

B 1 and 3

C Only 1

D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false — EIA is anticipatory prevention, not post-damage cleanup. Statement 3 is false — EIA is before approval, not only after completion.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Legal base — EPA 1986 (Section 3)
2. First EIA Notification — 2004
3. Current framework — EIA Notification 2016 teaching

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 3
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Category A	**1** SEIAA / SEAC
B Category B	**2** MoEFCC / EAC
C B1	**3** Full EIA (usually with public hearing)

Code:

A A-3, B-1, C-2	**B** A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1	**D** A-2, B-1, C-3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** A central; B state; B1 full EIA.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Under a General Condition, a Category B project in a sensitive area is treated as Category A.

Reason (R): Category A is appraised centrally by MoEFCC through the EAC.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; central appraisal fact does not by itself define the General Condition rule. **A/R logic:** Related but GC has its own trigger.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Arrange EIA stages:

- **A** Screening → scoping → public consultation → appraisal
- **B** Appraisal → screening → scoping → public consultation
- **C** Public consultation → screening → appraisal → scoping
- **D** Scoping → appraisal → screening → public consultation

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Screening → scoping → public consultation → appraisal. **Logic:** Four classic stages.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to screening, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Screening applies to Category B only.
2. Scoping fixes Terms of Reference (ToR).
3. Screening applies to every Category A project as the first statutory filter identical to B.

- **A** 2 and 3 only
- **B** 1 and 2 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Screening is B-side teaching.

Chapter 15: Sustainable Development & Environmental Governance — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Assertion (A): Sustainable development should occur without harming the environment or compromising the needs of future generations.

Reason (R): Agenda 21 was signed by world leaders in **1995**.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- **B** (A) is false but (R) is true.
- **C** (A) is true but (R) is false.
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests Brundtland-style SD definition; R tests Agenda 21 signing year at Rio. **Ans: C.** A states the core SD principle correctly; R is false — **Agenda 21 was adopted at Rio 1992**, not 1995. **Trap:** 1995 sounds like a plausible post-Rio follow-up year — the Earth Summit was **1992**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Assertion (A): Sustainable development was popularised by the Brundtland Report.

Reason (R): The Brundtland Report is also known as *The Limits to Growth*.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- **B** (A) is false but (R) is true.
- **C** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- **D** (A) is true but (R) is false.

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests Brundtland authorship of SD concept; R tests alternate book-title trap. **Ans: D.** Brundtland did popularise SD in ***Our Common Future* (1987)**; *The Limits to Growth* is a **different 1972 Club of Rome report**. **Trap:** Both are famous environment reports — titles are **not interchangeable**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Match **SDG number** with **official goal name**:

List I (Goal)	List II (Name)
1 Goal 1	A Clean Water and Sanitation
2 Goal 3	B Quality Education
3 Goal 4	C No Poverty
4 Goal 6	D Good Health and Well-being

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1–C, 2–D, 3–B, 4–A

B 1–D, 2–C, 3–A, 4–B

C 1–A, 2–B, 3–C, 4–D

D 1–B, 2–A, 3–D, 4–C

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SDG number–name matching for high-frequency goals 1, 3, 4, 6. **Ans: B.** Goal **1 = No Poverty**; **3 = Good Health**; **4 = Quality Education**; **6 = Clean Water and Sanitation** (code **3 4 2 1** in paper notation). **Trap:** Swapping Goals **3 and 4** (health vs education) is the most common match-list error.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Assertion (A): India's success is critical for global SDG success.

Reason (R): India accounts for nearly **one-sixth** of the world's population.

A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

B Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

C (A) is true but (R) is false.

D (A) is false but (R) is true.

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests India's weight in global SDG outcomes; R tests demographic scale as the explaining factor. **Ans: A.** With ~**1/6 of world population**, India's SDG performance heavily shapes global totals — R correctly explains A. **Trap:** "Critical for global success" follows from **population scale + development footprint**, not geography alone.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The **SDG National Indicator Framework Progress Report** for Uttar Pradesh is prepared by the State's—

A Finance Department

B **Planning Department**

C Education Department

D Forest Department

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP governance fact — SDG indicator reporting sits with state planning machinery. **Ans: B.** UP's **Planning Department** prepares the SDG National Indicator Framework Progress Report. **Trap:** Finance Department handles budgets — **Planning Department** owns SDG indicator reporting.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to **LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment), consider the following:**

1. LiFE was launched in **June 2022.**
2. The idea was proposed at **COP-25 in Madrid.**

A 2 only	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Governance/mission fact — LiFE launch vs COP venue of original announcement. **Ans: D.** LiFE launched **June 2022**; the concept was announced at **COP-26 Glasgow (2021)**, not COP-25. **Trap:** COP-25 Madrid is geographically plausible — Glasgow **2021** is correct.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following are essential for achieving **SDG 4 (Quality Education)?**

1. Free and compulsory education
2. School infrastructure and digital transformation
3. Expansion of agricultural programmes
4. Increasing investment in technology

A 1 and 2 only	**B** 1, 2 and 4 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** All four

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SDG 4 core targets vs unrelated agricultural expansion distractor. **Ans: A.** SDG 4 centres on **access, quality, and infrastructure** — agricultural programme expansion is not a core SDG 4 pillar. **Trap:** Statement 4 (technology investment) sounds education-relevant but the keyed combo is **1 and 2** — statement 3 is clearly off-topic.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to **carrying capacity, consider the following:**

1. Resource extraction should remain **above regeneration.**
2. Waste should stay within environmental **absorption capacity.**

A 2 only	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** 1 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SD operational test — sustainable development requires living within regeneration and absorption limits. **Ans: A.** Statement 2 defines sustainable waste limits; statement 1 reverses the regeneration rule. **Trap:** SD governance stems often embed this carrying-capacity pair — only statement 2 survives scrutiny.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The **Bhopal Gas Tragedy (1984)** directly catalysed enactment of the—

A Stockholm Declaration enforcement Act

B **Environment (Protection) Act, 1986**

C Biological Diversity Act, 2002

D NGT Act, 2010

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Environmental governance timeline — Bhopal exposed regulatory gaps leading to EPA. **Ans: B.** Bhopal **1984** led to India's comprehensive **EPA 1986** and later EIA notification. **Trap:** NGT (**2010**) is much later — the **immediate legislative response** was EPA **1986**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

The **green economy** (UNEP, 2011) emphasises—

A High-coal growth with waste maximisation

B **Low-carbon, resource-efficient, socially inclusive growth**

C Ozone-layer depletion as a development goal

D Elimination of all industrial activity

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UNEP green economy definition — well-being + equity + lower environmental risk. **Ans: B.** Green economy pursues improved well-being and equity while **cutting environmental risk and ecological scarcity**. **Trap:** Green economy is **not** anti-industry — it redesigns growth to be **resource-efficient and inclusive**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to sustainable development, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Brundtland 1997 (*Our Common Future*) defines meeting present needs without compromising future generations.
2. Brundtland is identical to *Limits to Growth* (1972).
3. SD rests on economic, social, and environmental pillars.

A Only 3

B Only 1

C 1 and 2

D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 3 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is true.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Arrange conference chain:

A SDGs 2015 → Rio 1992 → Stockholm 1972

B Rio 1992 → Stockholm 1972 → Brundtland 1987

C Stockholm 1972 → Brundtland 1987 → Rio 1992 → SDGs 2015

D Brundtland 1987 → Stockholm 1972 → SDGs 2015

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: 1972 → 1987 → 1992 → 2015. **Logic:** Stockholm–Brundtland–Rio–SDGs.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to SDGs, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Adopted September 2007; run to 2030.
2. 17 goals and 169 targets.
3. SDGs apply only to developing countries and did not replace the MDGs.

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C Only 2

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is correct (17/169). Statement 1 is false — SDGs were adopted in 2015, not 2007. Statement 3 is false — SDGs replaced MDGs and apply universally.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A SDG 6	1 Climate
B SDG 7	2 Water
C SDG 13	3 Energy
D SDG 15	4 Life on land

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

B A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

C A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

D A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4. **Logic:** 6 water; 7 energy; 13 climate; 15 land.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Agenda 21 belongs to Rio 1992.

Reason (R): Agenda 21 was signed in 1995 as a binding climate treaty.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** 1992 non-binding SD action plan — not 1995 climate treaty.

Chapter 16: Environmental Organizations (India) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

The **Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024** was prepared by—

1. Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
2. Central Water Commission (CWC)
3. Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

A 1 and 2 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Org–report matching trap — CPCB is pollution standards, not groundwater quality publisher. **Ans: B.** **CGWB** publishes the national groundwater quality report — not CPCB or CWC. **Trap:** CPCB is the reflex "central environment data" answer — groundwater quality is **CGWB's** mandate.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

India State of Forest Report (ISFR) 2023 is published by **FSI**. Which UP districts had **>20% forest cover**?

1. Bahraich
2. Chandauli
3. Shravasti

A 1 and 2 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** FSI publishes ISFR — district-level UP forest-cover threshold fact. **Ans: C.** **Chandauli** and **Shravasti** exceed 20% forest cover; Bahraich does not cross the threshold. **Trap:** Bahraich is Terai forest country but **below 20%** in ISFR 2023 — not Chandauli-Shravasti pair.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Environmental Clearance for Category A projects is granted by—

A Central Pollution Control Board

B **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change**

C National Green Tribunal

D Forest Survey of India

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** MoEFCC vs CPCB authority split — clearance ≠ pollution consent. **Ans: B.** **MoEFCC** (on EAC recommendation) grants **Category A EC**; CPCB does **not**. **Trap:** CPCB coordinates pollution control — **EC is MoEFCC/SEIAA**, not CPCB.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** was established under the—

A Environment (Protection) Act, 1986

B **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**

C NGT Act, 2010

D Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CPCB statutory birth under Water Act — Air Act 1981 widened its air role. **Ans: B.** CPCB was constituted under the **Water Act, 1974**; Air Act **1981** extended its air-pollution functions. **Trap:** EPA **1986** is umbrella environmental law — CPCB predates it by **12 years**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The **National Green Tribunal** was established under an Act of Parliament passed in—

A 1986

B 2005

C **2010**

D 2015

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NGT Act year — tribunal operational 2011, distinct from EPA 1986. **Ans: C.** **NGT Act, 2010** created the tribunal for environmental civil appeals. **Trap:** EPA **1986** and NGT **2010** are often confused — tribunal came **after** EIA notification 2006.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Consent to Operate (CTO) for industrial units is issued by the—

A MoEFCC

B **State Pollution Control Board (SPCB)**

C Forest Survey of India

D Wildlife Institute of India

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Consent (CTE/CTO) under Water/Air Acts vs EC under EPA — SPCB enforces operational pollution consent. **Ans: B.** **SPCB** issues **Consent to Establish** and **Consent to Operate** under Water Act 1974 and Air Act 1981. **Trap:** **SEIAA** grants Category B **EC** — SPCB grants **pollution consent**, a different clearance track.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The **Botanical Survey of India (BSI) is headquartered at **Kolkata** and surveys—**

A Animals and birds only	**B** **Plants only**
C Forest cover area nationwide	**D** Groundwater aquifers

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** BSI vs ZSI kingdom split — Kolkata HQ for plant taxonomy since 1890. **Ans: B.** **BSI (1890, Kolkata)** surveys **plants** and publishes *Flora of India*; animals are **ZSI's** domain. **Trap:** Both BSI and ZSI are in **Kolkata** — swapping plant/animal mandates is the classic trap.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The **Red Data Book of Indian Plants is published by—**

A Zoological Survey of India	**B** **Botanical Survey of India**
C Forest Survey of India	**D** Central Pollution Control Board

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Report–publisher matching — plant Red Data Book = BSI; animal version = ZSI. **Ans: B.** **BSI** publishes the plant Red Data Book; **ZSI** publishes the fauna Red Data Book. **Trap:** FSI publishes **ISFR** forest-cover reports — not species Red Data Books.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to MoEFCC, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It began as MoEF in 1995 and was renamed MoEFCC in 2014.
2. It is India's nodal ministry for environment, forests, wildlife, and climate change.
3. It sits in Mumbai as its only headquarters fact.

A Only 3	**B** Only 2
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true. Statement 1 is false — MoEF was created in **1985** (renamed MoEFCC in 2014), not 1995. Statement 3 is false — MoEFCC is New Delhi–centred, not Mumbai-only.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. CPCB — Water Act 1974; Mumbai; NAAQS
2. SPCB — Consent to Establish / Consent to Operate
3. CPCB — grants Category A Environmental Clearance

A Only 3
B Only 2
C Only 1
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 2 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is true. Statement 3 is false.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A WII	1 Nagpur
B FSI	2 Dehradun
C NEERI	3 Dehradun

Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-3, B-2, C-1
D A-2, B-3, C-1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1. **Logic:** WII & FSI Dehradun; NEERI Nagpur.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): NGT was created by the NGT Act, 2010 (operational 2011).

Reason (R): The NGT Chairperson must be a retired Supreme Court judge or a High Court Chief Justice.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Both true; chair qualification does not explain why the Act was created in 2010. **A/R logic:** Related NGT facts.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Arrange HQ map teaching:

1. Delhi — MoEFCC, CPCB, NGT
2. Dehradun — WII, FSI
3. Kolkata — BSI, ZSI
4. Lucknow — UPPCB

A 1, 2, 3 and 4
B Only 2 and 3
C 1, 2 and 3 only
D Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All four. **Logic:** Standard HQ facts.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to NGT benches, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. HQ New Delhi.
2. Regional benches include Bhopal, Pune, Kolkata, and Chennai.
3. NGT grants all Category A ECs instead of MoEFCC.

A 2 and 3 only
B 1 and 2 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** NGT is appellate — not EC granter.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. BSI — 1890 Kolkata plants
2. ZSI — 1916 Kolkata animals
3. FSI — annual CPCB forest cover report

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only pair 3 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** ISFR is biennial FSI — not CPCB.

Chapter 17: Environmental Laws & Policies — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

When was the Environment (Protection) Act passed?

A 1971	B 1974
C 1981	D 1986

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests the EPA enactment year after Bhopal — separate from WPA 1972 and Water Act 1974. **Ans: D.** The **Environment (Protection) Act was enacted in 1986** as India's umbrella environmental law. **Trap:** Pairing EPA with **1974** (Water Act year) or **1981** (Air Act year).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in:

A 1974	B 1975
C 1976	D 1977

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests India's first major post-Stockholm pollution law and the year that created CPCB/SPCB. **Ans: A.** The **Water Act was passed in 1974** — not 1981. **Trap:** Reversing Water **1974** with Air **1981**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Under which law is the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Notification issued?

A Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974	B Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972
C Environment (Protection) Act, 1986	D Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** EIA, CRZ, and ESZ rules flow from EPA Section 3 — not from sectoral Water or WPA laws. **Ans: C.** The **EIA Notification is issued under the EPA, 1986**. **Trap:** Crediting EIA to the **Water Act 1974** because pollution boards handle consent.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 was enacted primarily after which event exposed gaps in environmental regulation?

A Stockholm Conference, 1972

B Bhopal Gas Tragedy, 1984

C Rio Earth Summit, 1992

D Chernobyl nuclear accident, 1986

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bhopal (1984) is the standard legislative trigger cited for EPA 1986 in Indian environmental law chronology. **Ans: B.** The **Bhopal Gas Tragedy (1984)** led to the **EPA in 1986**. **Trap:** Picking Stockholm 1972 (which influenced Water Act 1974) instead of Bhopal.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, which schedule lists species with the **highest protection and which schedule lists **vermin**?**

A Schedule I — vermin; Schedule V — highest protection

B Schedule I — highest protection; Schedule V — vermin

C Schedule VI — highest protection; Schedule II — vermin

D Schedule IV — highest protection; Schedule I — vermin

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** WPA six-schedule ladder — I is strictest for animals; V explicitly allows vermin control. **Ans: B.** **Schedule I** species get the **highest protection**; **Schedule V** lists **vermin**. **Trap:** Swapping Schedule **V** (vermin) with Schedule **I** (highest protection).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Prior approval of the Central Government is required for diversion of forest land for non-forest use under:

A Forest Rights Act, 2006

B Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980

C Environment (Protection) Act, 1986

D Biological Diversity Act, 2002

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** FCA 1980 governs forest land diversion; FRA 2006 recognises community rights — different statutes. **Ans: B.** **Forest diversion needs Central approval under the FCA, 1980**. **Trap:** Mixing **FCA 1980** (diversion) with **FRA 2006** (tribal forest rights).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Tiger Reserves in India are notified under which section of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972?

A Section 18

B Section 35

C Section 38V

D Section 48A

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Section 35 = National Park; Section 18 = Sanctuary; Section 38V = Tiger Reserve (2006 amendment path). **Ans: C.** **Tiger Reserves are notified under Section 38V** with NTCA oversight. **Trap:** Section **35** (National Park) or **18** (Sanctuary) distractors.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The National Green Tribunal was established under an Act passed in:

A 1986
B 2006
C 2010
D 2015

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NGT Act 2010 is distinct from EPA 1986 and DM Act 2005 — year recall. **Ans: C.** The **NGT was created by the NGT Act, 2010**. **Trap:** **EPA 1986** or **2006** (FRA year) as false neighbours.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which pair is correctly matched?

A Water Act — 1981; Air Act — 1974
B Water Act — 1974; Air Act — 1981
C Water Act — 1986; Air Act — 1974
D Water Act — 1972; Air Act — 1986

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Pollution law chronology — Water first (1974), then Air (1981), then EPA umbrella (1986). **Ans: B.** **Water Act 1974** and **Air Act 1981** is the correct pair. **Trap:** Reversing **1974** and **1981** — the most common UPPCS trap in this chapter.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Consider the following statements:

1. The Bhopal Gas Tragedy occurred in 1984.
2. The Environment (Protection) Act was passed in 1986.

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Standard cause–law sequence tested across environmental law and governance chapters. **Ans: C.** **Bhopal 1984** preceded **EPA 1986** — both statements are correct. **Trap:** Shifting EPA to **1972** (WPA year) or Bhopal to **1986**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the act-year chain:

WPA → Water → FCA → Air → EPA → BDA → FRA → NGT

A 1974-1972-1981-1980-1986-2006-2002-2010
B 1972-1974-1980-1981-1986-2002-2006-2010
C 1986-1972-1974-1980-1981-2002-2006-2010
D 1972-1980-1974-1981-1986-2002-2006-2010

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1972→1974→1980→1981→1986→2002→2006→2010. **Logic:** Master law spine.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Articles, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Article 48A — State DPSP on environment.
2. Article 51A(g) is a Directive Principle, not a Fundamental Duty.
3. Article 48 — environment protection article.

A Only 1	**B** 1 and 2
C Only 3	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (Art. 48A DPSP). Statement 2 is false — 51A(g) is the citizen's Fundamental Duty. Statement 3 is false — environment DPSP is 48A, not 48.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Article 21 has been read to include a healthy environment.

Reason (R): The 42nd Amendment (1976) added 48A and 51A(g).

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Both true; 42nd Amendment does not by itself explain Art. 21 expansion. **A/R logic:** Two constitutional tracks.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. EPA 1986 — post-Bhopal umbrella under Art. 253
2. EIA/CRZ/ESZ/GEAC powers have no link to EPA Section 3.
3. EIA Notification — flows from Water Act 1974 only

A 2 and 3	**B** Only 1
C 1 and 2	**D** Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (EPA 1986 umbrella / Art. 253). Statement 2 is false — those powers sit in the EPA Section 3 neighbourhood. Statement 3 is false — EIA Notification flows from EPA, not from the Water Act alone.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A NP	1 Sec. 18
B Sanctuary	2 Sec. 35
C Tiger Reserve	3 Sec. 38V

Code:

A. A-2, B-1, C-3

B. A-1, B-2, C-3

C. A-2, B-3, C-1

D. A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** NP 35; Sanctuary 18; TR 38V.

Chapter 18: International Environmental Agreements & Conferences — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following international agreements is related to climate change **mitigation?**

A Montreal Protocol

B Ramsar Convention

C Kyoto Protocol

D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty–issue matching — Montreal controls ozone/ODS; Kyoto/Paris address greenhouse gases. **Ans: C.** The **Kyoto Protocol** sets binding GHG mitigation targets for developed countries. **Trap:** **Montreal Protocol** — ozone treaty, not climate mitigation.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Assertion (A): Sustainable development should take place without harming the environment and without compromising the needs of future generations.

Reason (R): Agenda 21 was signed by world leaders in 1995.

A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

B Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D (A) is false, but (R) is true

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** (A) states the Brundtland-style SD principle (true). (R) tests Agenda 21 year — Rio **1992**, not 1995. **Ans: C.** (A) is true; (R) is false because **Agenda 21 was adopted at Rio 1992**. **Trap:** Accepting **1995** as the Agenda 21 year.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Agenda-21 of the Rio Summit (1992) is related to:

A Sustainable Development

B Polluter Pays Principle

C Environmental Education

D Ozone Layer Protection

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Agenda 21 is Rio's non-binding action plan for sustainable development in the 21st century. **Ans: A.** **Agenda 21** addresses **sustainable development**. **Trap:** Ozone layer (Montreal) or Polluter Pays (domestic principle) distractors.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Assertion (A): Sustainable development was popularised by the Brundtland Report.

Reason (R): The Brundtland Report is also known as *The Limits to Growth*.

A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)	**B** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) explains (A)	**D** (A) is true, but (R) is false

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** (A) is true — Brundtland (1987) defined SD. (R) is false — *Limits to Growth* is Club of Rome **1972**. **Ans: D.** Brundtland = ***Our Common Future* (1987)**; not *Limits to Growth*. **Trap:** Treating Brundtland and Club of Rome as the same report.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following Ramsar sites are **NOT located in Uttar Pradesh?**

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel
2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

A 1 and 3	**B** 3 and 4
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP Ramsar geography — Rudrasagar and Sultanpur sound plausible but lie outside UP. **Ans: B.** **Rudrasagar Lake** is in **Tripura**; **Sultanpur** is in **Haryana**. **Trap:** Assuming every bird sanctuary name in the list belongs to UP.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the Global Environment Facility (GEF), consider the following statements:

1. GEF was established in 1991.
2. Only developed countries are donors to GEF.

A Neither 1 nor 2	**B** Only 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** GEF 1991 fact is standard; donor base is broader than developed-only. **Ans: D (Only 1).** **GEF was established in 1991**; statement 2 is false. **Trap:** Rejecting 1991 or accepting "developed-only donors."

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Montreal Protocol — ozone-depleting substances

B Kyoto Protocol — climate change mitigation

C Montreal Protocol — climate change mitigation

D Paris Agreement — nationally determined contributions

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Montreal = ozone/ODS phase-out; UNFCCC–Kyoto–Paris = climate framework. **Ans: C.** **Montreal Protocol does not mitigate climate change** — it protects the ozone layer. **Trap:** "Montreal = climate treaty" — the single most tested treaty confusion.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which statement is correct?

A CITES (1973) regulates international trade in endangered species; CMS (1979) protects migratory species and flyways.

B CITES protects migratory flyways; CMS bans all wildlife trade.

C Both CITES and CMS were opened for signature at Rio 1992.

D CITES assesses extinction risk; CMS issues Red List categories.

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CITES = trade permits; CMS = migration/habitat — separate 1970s treaties, not Rio products. **Ans: A.** **CITES regulates trade**; **CMS protects migration routes**. **Trap:** Rio 1992 origin for CITES (CITES is **1973**, pre-Rio).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The headquarters of the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) is located at:

A Geneva, Switzerland

B New York, USA

C Nairobi, Kenya

D Bonn, Germany

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** HQ matching — UNEP Nairobi; UNDP New York; IPCC Geneva; UNFCCC Bonn. **Ans: C.** **UNEP headquarters is in Nairobi**. **Trap:** **Geneva** (IPCC) or **New York** (UNDP).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

The Rio Earth Summit (1992) directly produced which of the following?

A UNFCCC, CBD, and Agenda 21

B CITES, Ramsar Convention, and Stockholm Declaration

C Kyoto Protocol, Paris Agreement, and SDGs

D Montreal Protocol, Vienna Convention, and Minamata Convention

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Rio "triple outcome" — climate framework, biodiversity convention, and Agenda 21 action plan. **Ans: A.** Rio **1992** opened **UNFCCC** and **CBD** and adopted **Agenda 21**. **Trap:** CITES (**1973**) or Kyoto (**1997**) as Rio products.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the conference spine:

Stockholm → Brundtland → Rio → Johannesburg → Rio+20 → SDGs/Paris

A 1987-1972-1992-2012-2002-2015

B 1972-1987-1992-2002-2012-2015

C 1992-1972-1987-2002-2015-2012

D 1972-1992-1987-2012-2002-2015

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1972→1987→1992→2002→2012→2015. **Logic:** Full conference ladder.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Stockholm 1972, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Stockholm 1972 was the first UN climate COP under UNFCCC.
2. Led to UNEP at Nairobi.
3. World Environment Day is observed on 22 April.

A Only 2

B Only 1

C 1 and 2

D Only 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (UNEP, Nairobi). Statement 1 confuses Stockholm/Human Environment with UNFCCC COPs. Statement 3 is false — World Environment Day is 5 June.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Brundtland 1987 — Our Common Future
2. Limits to Growth 1972 — Club of Rome
3. Brundtland — identical to Limits to Growth

A 1 and 2 only

B 1, 2 and 3

C 2 and 3 only

D 3 only

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only pair 3 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** Different books/years.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Rio 1992 produced Agenda 21 and opened UNFCCC and CBD for signature.

Reason (R): CITES is a Rio 1992 product identical to Agenda 21.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** CITES is 1973 Washington — not a Rio product.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Match issue tags:

List-I	List-II
A Montreal/Vienna	1 Wetlands
B Kyoto/Paris/UNFCCC	2 Ozone
C Ramsar	3 Climate
D CITES	4 Wildlife trade

Code:

- **A** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- **B** A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
- **C** A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- **D** A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4. **Logic:** Ozone/climate/wetlands/trade.

Chapter 19: Climate & Environmental Institutions — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Report)	List-II (Organisation)
A Human Development Report	1 IMF
B World Economic Outlook	2 UNEP
C World Investment Report	3 UNDP
D Emissions Gap Report	4 UNCTAD

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 1 4 2

B 3 4 1 2

C 1 2 3 4

D 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Report–publisher matching — Emissions Gap is UNEP's product, not IPCC or UNDP. **Ans: A (3 1 4 2).** HDR→**UNDP**; WEO→**IMF**; WIR→**UNCTAD**; Emissions Gap→**UNEP**. **Trap:** Crediting the Emissions Gap Report to **IPCC** or **UNDP**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to the Human Development Report (HDR), consider the following statements:

1. UNDP published the first HDR with HDI in 1990.
2. The HDI was developed by a team led by Mahbub ul Haq and S. Priesner.

A Neither 1 nor 2

B Only 2

C Both 1 and 2

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** HDR 1990 and HDI authorship — Mahbub ul Haq and **Amartya Sen**, not Priesner. **Ans: D (Only 1).** First HDR **1990** is correct; statement 2 is false. **Trap:** Accepting **Priesner** instead of **Sen** on the HDI team.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Global Environment Facility (GEF), consider the following statements:

1. GEF was established in 1991.
2. Only developed countries are donors to GEF.

A Neither 1 nor 2
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** GEF pre-Rio finance mechanism — 1991 establishment is tested; donor pool is not developed-only. **Ans: D (Only 1).** **GEF was established in 1991**; statement 2 is false. **Trap:** Choosing "Neither" by doubting the 1991 date.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) was established in 1988 by:

A WMO and UNEP
B UNFCCC and UNDP
C UNEP and UNDP
D WMO and FAO

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** IPCC parent bodies — science assessment under WMO + UNEP, not the climate treaty secretariat. **Ans: A.** **IPCC was created by WMO and UNEP in 1988**. **Trap:** UNFCCC (policy treaty body) as IPCC founder.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The headquarters of UNEP is located at:

A Geneva
B Nairobi
C New York
D Rome

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Institution HQ ladder — Nairobi = UNEP; New York = UNDP; Rome = FAO. **Ans: B.** **UNEP HQ is Nairobi**. **Trap:** **Geneva** (IPCC) or **New York** (UNDP).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which organisation prepares the **IUCN Red List, and which treaty regulates international wildlife **trade**?**

A IUCN — Red List; CITES — trade
B CITES — Red List; IUCN — trade
C UNEP — Red List; CMS — trade
D WWF — Red List; CBD — trade

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** IUCN assesses scientific extinction risk; CITES controls cross-border trade permits. **Ans: A.** **Red List = IUCN**; **trade regulation = CITES**. **Trap:** "IUCN bans wildlife trade" — IUCN does **not** regulate trade.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which statement is correct?

A IPCC sets national emission targets at COP meetings; UNFCCC publishes Assessment Reports.

B IPCC synthesises climate science; UNFCCC is the treaty forum where countries negotiate NDCs.

C IPCC and UNFCCC are the same body with two names.

D UNFCCC was created in 1988; IPCC was opened for signature at Rio 1992.

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Science (IPCC) versus policy treaty (UNFCCC/COP) — recurring institution trap. **Ans: B.** **IPCC assesses science**; **UNFCCC/COP handles NDC negotiations**. **Trap:** Swapping roles — "IPCC sets NDCs."

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Living Planet Report and Living Planet Index are published by:

A IUCN

B UNEP

C WWF

D IPCC

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** WWF NGO product versus IUCN Red List — both in Gland but different roles. **Ans: C.** The **Living Planet Report is published by WWF**. **Trap:** **IUCN** (Red List) or **UNEP** (Emissions Gap).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to IPCC, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. IPCC headquarters is in Nairobi and it issues NDCs instead of Assessment Reports.
2. Established 1988 by WMO and UNEP.
3. Sets NDCs for all parties as the UNFCCC treaty body.

A Only 2

B 1 and 3

C Only 1

D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (1988, WMO+UNEP). Statement 1 is false — IPCC HQ is Geneva and it issues Assessment Reports. Statement 3 is false — parties set NDCs under UNFCCC; IPCC is not the treaty body that sets them.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A UNEP	1 New York; HDR/HDI
B UNDP	2 Nairobi; Emissions Gap/GEO
C FAO	3 Rome; SOFO

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1

B A-1, B-2, C-3

C A-2, B-1, C-3

D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Nairobi/NY/Rome.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. IUCN — Gland; Red List
2. IUCN — Gland; Living Planet Report
3. IUCN — regulates CITES trade appendices as its only job

A 1 and 3

B Only 2

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Threatened on IUCN means VU + EN + CR.

Reason (R): Endangered alone equals the full Threatened set.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Threatened ≠ Endangered alone.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Arrange HQ memory:

Nairobi / New York / Geneva / Gland / Rome

A UNEP / UNDP / IPCC / IUCN-WWF / FAO

B UNDP / UNEP / FAO / IPCC / IUCN

C FAO / IPCC / UNEP / UNDP / IUCN

D IUCN / FAO / UNDP / UNEP / IPCC

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: UNEP Nairobi; UNDP NY; IPCC Geneva; IUCN/WWF Gland; FAO Rome. **Logic:** HQ map.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to Emissions Gap Report, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a UNDP product.
2. It is a UNEP flagship, not an IPCC Assessment Report.
3. It is identical to the Human Development Report.

A Only 2

B Only 1

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (UNEP Emissions Gap ≠ IPCC AR). Statement 1 is false — it is UNEP, not UNDP. Statement 3 confuses it with HDR.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. HDR — UNDP from 1990
2. HDI — Mahbub ul Haq / Amartya Sen link
3. HDR — UNEP Nairobi flagship

A 1 and 2 only

B 2 and 3 only

C 3 only

D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only pair 3 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** HDR ≠ UNEP.

Chapter 20: Biodiversity Conservation Methods — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following is **NOT an example of an in-situ conservation strategy?**

A Biosphere reserve	**B** Botanical garden
C National Park	**D** Sacred groves

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Four-way in-situ vs ex-situ trap — botanic gardens are off-site living collections. **Ans: B.** A **botanical garden is ex-situ** conservation; all other options are in-situ. **Trap:** Treating managed gardens as "natural habitat" in-situ.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

In National Parks, genetic diversity is maintained through—

A In-situ conservation	**B** Ex-situ conservation
C Gene pool	**D** None of the above

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NPs protect wild populations in natural habitat — primary in-situ strategy. **Ans: A.** **National Parks maintain genetic diversity through in-situ conservation**. **Trap:** **Ex-situ** (zoos/seed banks) as the answer for NP management.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following is **NOT an in-situ method of biodiversity conservation?**

A Wildlife Sanctuary	**B** Seed bank
C National Park	**D** Sacred grove

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Seed banks store germplasm off-site — classic ex-situ distractor in UPPCS stems. **Ans: B.** A **seed bank is ex-situ** conservation. **Trap:** Picking sanctuary or sacred grove (both in-situ).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following is an example of **in-situ conservation?**

A Zoological park
B National Park
C Seed bank
D Botanical garden

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Only NP/sanctuary/BR/sacred grove among typical MCQ lists are in-situ. **Ans: B.** A **National Park is in-situ**; zoo, seed bank, and botanic garden are ex-situ. **Trap:** **Zoological park** — captive ex-situ, not wild in-situ.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The Indian national plant gene bank (ICAR-NBPGR) is located at:

A Kolkata
B New Delhi
C Karnal
D Lucknow

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NBPGR Delhi vs BSI Kolkata — storage versus survey institutions. **Ans: B.** **NBPGR is at New Delhi** (Pusa Campus). **Trap:** **Kolkata** — BSI/ZSI headquarters, not NBPGR.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

India's National Bureau of Animal Genetic Resources (NBAGR) is located at:

A New Delhi
B Karnal, Haryana
C Kolkata
D Hyderabad

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Plant gene bank = NBPGR Delhi; animal gene bank = NBAGR Karnal. **Ans: B.** **NBAGR is at Karnal** for livestock genetic resources. **Trap:** **New Delhi** (NBPGR) or assigning animals to NBPGR.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Svalbard Global Seed Vault, a duplicate backup for national seed collections, is located in:

A India
B Norway
C Switzerland
D United Kingdom

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Arctic "doomsday" vault — duplicate storage, not India's primary gene bank. **Ans: B.** **Svalbard Global Seed Vault is in Norway** (2008). **Trap:** Locating Svalbard in **India** (NBPGR) or confusing with formal ownership transfer.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Central Zoo Authority (CZA) functions under which ministry?

A Ministry of Agriculture
B Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
C Ministry of Jal Shakti
D Ministry of Tribal Affairs

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CZA is the statutory zoo regulator under MoEFCC, not agriculture or tribal affairs. **Ans: B.** **CZA operates under MoEFCC**. **Trap:** Agriculture ministry because zoos display animals/farming link distractor.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The most effective method for conserving biodiversity is:

A Ex-situ zoos alone
B In-situ protected areas in natural habitat
C Seed banks without habitat protection
D Botanical gardens only

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NCERT/CBD priority — in-situ first; ex-situ is supplementary backup. **Ans: B.** **In-situ protected areas** are the primary effective strategy. **Trap:** "Zoos are the best/primary form" — false preference reversal.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following is a mode of **ex-situ conservation?**

A National Park
B Wildlife Sanctuary
C Seed banks
D Sacred grove

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ex-situ = off-site storage or captive collections among mixed lists. **Ans: C.** **Seed banks** are ex-situ; parks, sanctuaries, and groves are in-situ. **Trap:** **Sacred grove** — community in-situ forest, not ex-situ.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to in-situ conservation, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Protects biodiversity in the natural habitat.
2. Preferred secondary strategy.
3. Zoo is the best example of in-situ.

A 1 and 3
B Only 2
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. National Park — in-situ
2. Sacred grove — ex-situ
3. Seed bank — in-situ

A 1 and 3	**B** Only 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Gene bank	**1** Seeds only
B Seed bank	**2** Broad genetic material
C Cryopreservation	**3** ~−196°C liquid nitrogen

Code:

A A-3, B-1, C-2	**B** A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1	**D** A-2, B-1, C-3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Gene broad; seed only; cryo LN2.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Orthodox seeds (wheat/rice) tolerate drying and cold storage around −18°C.

Reason (R): Recalcitrant seeds (mango/coconut) cannot take simple dry seed-bank storage.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; recalcitrant fact contrasts but does not explain orthodoxy's tolerance mechanism as its cause. **A/R logic:** Seed-type pair.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Indian flagships, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. NBPGR — plant gene/seed flagship, New Delhi.
2. NBAGR is a plant gene bank at Kolkata, not an animal gene bank at Karnal.
3. NBPGR HQ is Kolkata BSI campus only.

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (NBPGR New Delhi plant gene/seed). Statement 2 is false — NBAGR is the animal gene bank at Karnal. Statement 3 is false — NBPGR HQ is not the Kolkata BSI campus.

Chapter 21: Species & Ecology (पारिस्थितिकी) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Assertion (A): In the Himalayan mountains, different types of vegetation are found.

Reason (R): In the Himalayas, there are variations in climate with change in altitude.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** (A) is false, but (R) is true

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** (A) states altitudinal vegetation zonation (true). (R) gives the standard NCERT cause — altitude-driven climate change. **Ans: A.** Both true; **R explains A** through lapse-rate-driven vegetation belts. **Trap:** Choosing "R does not explain A" — altitude–climate–vegetation is the textbook chain.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following Ramsar sites are **NOT located in Uttar Pradesh?**

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel
2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

- **A** 1 and 3
- **B** 3 and 4
- **C** 2 and 3
- **D** 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP wetland geography — Tripura and Haryana sites masquerade as UP names. **Ans: B (3 and 4).** **Rudrasagar = Tripura**; **Sultanpur = Haryana**. **Trap:** Sarsai Nawar and Samaspur **are** in UP — do not pick 1 or 2 as wrong.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to MISHTI, consider the following statements:

1. It was initiated in 2019.
2. It aims to restore mangrove forests.

A Only 2	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** MISHTI = Union Budget **2023–24** mangrove scheme — not 2019. **Ans: A (Only 2).** Restoration aim is correct; **2019 start is false**. **Trap:** Accepting **2019** launch year.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Coral bleaching in the Andaman & Nicobar region was mainly caused by:

A Increased industrial activity alone	**B** Increase of about 2°C in the Indian Ocean
C Heavy marine pollution alone	**D** Decrease of 4°C in the Indian Ocean

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bleaching = heat stress expelling zooxanthellae — not cooling or pollution alone. **Ans: B.** **+2°C ocean warming** drives mass bleaching events. **Trap:** **−4°C cooling** — corals bleach from **heat**, not cold stress in this framing.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

World Wetlands Day is observed on:

A 2 February	**B** 22 March
C 5 June	**D** 16 September

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ramsar calendar — 2 February wetlands; 22 March water; 5 June environment; 16 September ozone. **Ans: A.** **World Wetlands Day = 2 February**. **Trap:** **22 March** (World Water Day) or **5 June** (WED).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following is **NOT an example of in-situ conservation strategy?**

A Biosphere reserve	**B** Botanical garden
C National Park	**D** Sacred groves

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Cross-topic in-situ trap — botanic gardens are ex-situ living collections. **Ans: B.** **Botanical garden = ex-situ**; others are in-situ. **Trap:** Biosphere reserve or sacred grove — both remain in-situ.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following statements are true?

1. Natural disasters cause maximum damage in developing countries.
2. Bhopal gas tragedy was man-made.
3. India is a disaster-free country.
4. Mangroves reduce the impact of cyclones.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2, 3 and 4
C 1, 2 and 4
D 1, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Multi-statement disaster–environment link — India is **not** disaster-free; mangroves **do** buffer cyclones. **Ans: C (1, 2 and 4).** Statements **1, 2, and 4** are true; **3 is false**. **Trap:** Accepting "India is disaster-free" or rejecting mangrove protection role.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

In which ecosystem is species diversity relatively **highest?**

A Deep sea
B Tropical rain forest
C Coral reefs
D Desert

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Among given options, coral reefs often top local species richness per unit area. **Ans: C.** **Coral reefs** show exceptionally high species diversity among the choices. **Trap:** **Tropical rainforest** — globally rich, but this stem keys **coral reefs** among the four.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

How many more Ramsar sites were added to Uttar Pradesh in January 2020?

A 3
B 6
C 9
D 12

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP Ramsar expansion CA fact — January 2020 batch count. **Ans: B.** **Six** Ramsar sites were added to UP in **January 2020**. **Trap:** Over-counting (9 or 12) or under-counting (3).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

On the IUCN Red List, "threatened species" includes which categories?

A Endangered only

B Vulnerable, Endangered, and Critically Endangered

C Near Threatened and Endangered

D Extinct and Extinct in the Wild

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Threatened band = **VU + EN + CR** — not Endangered alone. **Ans: B.** **Threatened = VU + EN + CR**. **Trap:** "Threatened = Endangered only" — drops Vulnerable and CR.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

The Red Data Book of **Indian plants is published by:**

A ZSI

B BSI

C IUCN

D MoEFCC

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** National Red Data Books — BSI plants, ZSI animals (Kolkata). **Ans: B.** **BSI publishes the plant Red Data Book**. **Trap:** **ZSI** (animals) or **IUCN** (global Red List, not national book).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Zooxanthellae are symbiotic algae associated with:

A Mangrove pneumatophores

B Coral polyps

C Grassland rhizomes

D Deep-sea anglerfish only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Coral energy symbiosis — zooxanthellae supply photosynthate; bleaching = their expulsion. **Ans: B.** **Zooxanthellae live inside coral polyps**. **Trap:** Mangroves or deep-sea-only distractors.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Red Data sources, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India's Red Data Book — BSI plants, ZSI animals (Kolkata).
2. IUCN Red List is the global extinction-risk catalogue.
3. BSI publishes the IUCN Red List for the whole world.

A 2 and 3 only

B 1 and 2 only

C 1 and 3 only

D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** IUCN is global — not BSI's world list.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Threatened — VU + EN + CR
2. Endangered alone — full Threatened set
3. Among living threatened tiers the risk order is VU > EN > CR.

A Only 3	**B** Only 1
C 1 and 2	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (Threatened = VU+EN+CR). Statement 2 is false — Endangered alone is not the full Threatened set. Statement 3 reverses CR > EN > VU.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A IUCN	**1** Wildlife trade
B CITES	**2** Extinction risk
C Ramsar	**3** Wetlands / Wise Use

Code:

A A-3, B-1, C-2	**B** A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1	**D** A-2, B-1, C-3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Risk / trade / wetlands.

Chapter 22: Renewable Energy (नवीकरणीय ऊर्जा) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Major constituents of biogas include:

1. Methane
2. Butane
3. Carbon dioxide
4. Carbon monoxide

A 1 and 3
B 3 and 4
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Biogas from anaerobic digestion — CH_4 + CO_2; butane is an LPG trap. **Ans: A (1 and 3).** **Methane and carbon dioxide** are the major biogas constituents. **Trap:** **Butane** or **carbon monoxide** as main components.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to hydroelectric power in Northern India, consider the following statements:

1. The Himalayan region has enormous hydroelectric potential.
2. Eastern Uttar Pradesh and Bihar cannot utilise Himalayan hydro because the Himalayas to their north lie in Nepal.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Himalayan potential is real; statement 2 falsely excuses UP/Bihar — Indian hydro sits in Uttarakhand, HP, Sikkim, etc. **Ans: D (Only 1).** **Himalayan potential is enormous**; the Nepal excuse in statement 2 is false. **Trap:** Accepting statement 2 — UP benefits via Ganga/Yamuna systems from Indian Himalayan projects.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the International Solar Alliance (ISA), consider the following statements:

1. It is the first treaty-based intergovernmental organization headquartered in India and has 38 member countries.
2. The World Solar Bank and One Sun One World One Grid (OSOWOG) initiatives have been undertaken under it.

A Only 1
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** OSOWOG/World Solar Bank linkage to ISA is correct; "exactly 38 members" is outdated. **Ans: A (Only 2).** **Only statement 2 is correct** — member count in statement 1 is obsolete. **Trap:** Rejecting OSOWOG because statement 1 sounds authoritative.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Ramganga Multipurpose Project, which of the following pairs is **correctly matched?**

A Location — Garhwal (Uttarakhand)
B Hydropower capacity — 198 MW
C Both A and B
D Neither A nor B

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ramganga teaching facts — Garhwal site and ~198 MW are standard correct anchors. **Ans: C.** **Garhwal location** and **~198 MW** are both correctly matched. **Trap:** Irrigated-area or dam-length figures in other booklet options — verify against ~198 MW + Garhwal core pair.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The largest tidal energy potential in India is associated with the:

A North Circars coast
B Mannar coast
C Khambhat (Cambay) coast
D Kerala coast

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Gulf of Khambhat has India's highest tidal range (~11 m) — potential, not installed capacity leader. **Ans: C.** **Gulf of Khambhat (Cambay)** has the largest tidal energy potential. **Trap:** Kerala or eastern coast names — Gujarat/Khambhat is the tested fact.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following is **NOT a biomass energy source?**

A Coal
B Nuclear fuel
C Gobar (cow dung)
D Wood

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Biomass = organic matter; coal is fossilised carbon; nuclear is uranium/thorium. **Ans: A.** **Coal is not biomass** — it is a fossil fuel. **Trap:** Nuclear is also non-biomass, but coal is the standard keyed distractor in this stem.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Solar energy is converted into electric energy through—

A Dry cells
B Leclanché cells
C Voltaic cells
D Photovoltaic cells

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** PV direct conversion vs CSP/tidal/geothermal distractors. **Ans: D.** **Photovoltaic cells** convert solar energy into electricity. **Trap:** Dry cells, Leclanché, or Voltaic cell distractors — not solar-specific.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Most sources of energy we use represent stored solar energy. Which of the following is **NOT ultimately derived from the Sun's energy?**

A Biomass energy
B Nuclear energy
C Wind energy
D Geothermal energy

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Solar-linked = biomass, wind; Earth's interior heat and nuclear fission are non-solar. **Ans: D.** **Geothermal energy** is not derived from the Sun. **Trap:** **Nuclear energy** is also non-solar — paper may list either; geothermal is the keyed answer here.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The first airport powered by solar energy in India is:

A Chennai
B Cochin
C Ahmedabad
D New Delhi

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Cochin International Airport = world's first fully solar-powered airport fact. **Ans: B.** **Cochin** was India's first solar-powered airport. **Trap:** **Diu** (100% solar UT) or **Ahmedabad** — different solar milestones.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

In which district of Uttar Pradesh was a major solar power plant established in collaboration with France in 2018?

A Agra
B Ballia
C Deoria
D Mirzapur

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP–France solar collaboration maps to Mirzapur belt in standard PYQ framing. **Ans: D.** The major UP–France solar plant is linked with **Mirzapur**. **Trap:** Eastern UP districts (Ballia/Deoria) with no solar–France association.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

The Secretariat of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) is located at:

- **A** Paris
- **B** New Delhi
- **C** Gurugram
- **D** Nairobi

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISA HQ Gurugram — not Paris (launch city) or generic New Delhi. **Ans: C.** **ISA Secretariat is at Gurugram, Haryana**. **Trap:** **Paris** (COP21 launch) or **New Delhi** casual guess.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

The National Solar Mission is a pillar of which national climate/action framework?

- **A** NAPCC (National Action Plan on Climate Change)
- **B** Montreal Protocol
- **C** Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972
- **D** Ramsar Convention

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** JNNSM/National Solar Mission (2010) sits under NAPCC (2008). **Ans: A.** The **National Solar Mission is under NAPCC**. **Trap:** Montreal (ozone) or WPA (wildlife) cross-topic distractors.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

International Solar Alliance — which is correct?

- **A** Launched at UN Climate Change Conference 2015; includes all UN members
- **B** Launched 2015; not all UN members; HQ Gurugram
- **C** HQ Paris; launched 2010
- **D** First Summit only in New York

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISA membership, DCR, firsts (Kochi/Diu), and hydrogen/fuel-cell physics dominate recent stems. **Ans: B.** First Summit New Delhi **2018**. USD ~1 trillion solar finance ambition by **2030**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Domestic Content Requirement (DCR) refers to:

- **A** Foreign TV channel licences
- **B** Developing domestic solar PV cell/module manufacturing
- **C** Food export quotas only
- **D** Foreign university campuses

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: MNRE solar RfS manufacturing condition.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Correct solar “firsts” set:

A Kochi airport fully solar; Diu 100% solar UT/daytime; Surat 100% solar PHCs

B Gujarat always has India’s largest solar park (vs Bhadla)

C India is #3 silicon-wafer manufacturer

D SECI alone sets all solar tariffs

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Bhadla (Rajasthan) mega park; CERC/SERCs regulate tariffs; wafers largely not Indian-made.

Chapter 23: Disaster & Environment (पर्यावरण) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Arrange the following programmes in chronological order of commencement:

1. Food for Work Programme
2. Community Development Programme
3. TRYSEM
4. Drought Prone Areas Programme

A 4, 2, 3, 1
B 2, 4, 1, 3
C 2, 4, 3, 1
D 4, 2, 1, 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chronology stem — CDP 1952 → DPAP 1973 → FWP 1977 → TRYSEM 1979. **Ans: B (2, 4, 1, 3).** Order: **CDP → DPAP → FWP → TRYSEM**. **Trap:** DPAP **1973** swapped with CDP **1952**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to the "Piral Lao – Paise Pao" campaign, consider the following statements:

1. It reduces forest fires and gives income to villagers.
2. It was launched by the Chief Minister of Uttarakhand.

A Only 1
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Only 2
D Both 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Uttarakhand pine-needle collection — fire fuel reduction plus livelihood. **Ans: D (Both 1 and 2).** Both fire-prevention and CM-launch statements are correct. **Trap:** Assigning the scheme to **UP** instead of Uttarakhand.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Who is the ex-officio Chairman of the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)?

A The Prime Minister
B The Home Minister
C The Defence Minister
D The Health and Family Welfare Minister

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NDMA under DM Act 2005 — PM is ex-officio Chair; NDRF handles response. **Ans: A.** The **Prime Minister** is the ex-officio **NDMA Chairman**. **Trap:** **Home Minister** — common false association with disaster response.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Tropical cyclones)	List-II (Country/region)
A Baguios	1 Australia
B Hurricanes	2 China
C Typhoons	3 Philippines
D Willy-Willies	4 United States of America

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 4 1 2

B 3 4 2 1

C 2 3 4 1

D 2 1 3 4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Regional cyclone naming — Baguios–Philippines; Hurricanes–USA; Typhoons–China/NW Pacific; Willy-Willies–Australia. **Ans: B (3 4 2 1).** **Baguios–Philippines; Hurricanes–USA; Typhoons–China; Willy-Willies–Australia**. **Trap:** Swapping **Typhoons** (China) with **Hurricanes** (USA).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Cyclone name)	List-II (Country)
A Willy-Willies	1 Philippines
B Taifu	2 Australia
C Baguio	3 Japan
D Hurricanes	4 U.S.A.

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 4 1 2

B 2 3 4 1

C 1 3 2 4

D 2 3 1 4

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Same regional naming set as 2020 Q74 with variant list labels. **Ans: D (2 3 1 4).** Willy-Willies–Australia; Taifu–Japan; Baguio–Philippines; Hurricanes–USA. **Trap:** **Taifu** (Japan) confused with **Typhoon** generic label only.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following statements are true?

1. Natural disasters cause maximum damage in developing countries.
2. Bhopal gas tragedy was man-made.
3. India is a disaster-free country.
4. Mangroves reduce the impact of cyclones.

A 1, 2 and 3	**B** 2, 3 and 4
C 1, 2 and 4	**D** 1, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Developing-country vulnerability + man-made Bhopal + mangrove buffer; India is **not** disaster-free. **Ans: C (1, 2 and 4).** Statements 1, 2, and 4 are true. **Trap:** Statement 3 — India faces floods, cyclones, droughts, landslides, and earthquakes.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Sendai Framework (2015) primarily relates to:

A Disaster risk reduction	**B** Ozone layer protection
C Wildlife trade regulation	**D** Carbon credit trading

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Sendai 2015 = global DRR framework parallel to India's NDMA architecture. **Ans: A.** **Sendai Framework is for disaster risk reduction**. **Trap:** Montreal (ozone) or Kyoto (carbon) cross-topic distractors.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Kedarnath disaster of 2013 is best described as a cascade involving:

A Cloudburst leading to landslides and flash floods	**B** Purely tectonic earthquake with no rainfall link
C Tsunami after submarine earthquake	**D** Volcanic eruption in Garhwal Himalaya

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Classic environment–disaster chain — extreme rain → slope failure → downstream flood. **Ans: A.** **Cloudburst–landslide–flash flood** cascade. **Trap:** Pure earthquake or tsunami framing — Kedarnath was hydrometeorological + mass movement.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Storm surge during a tropical cyclone is caused mainly by:

A Cyclone winds pushing seawater onshore

B Calm eye of the cyclone drawing water inward only

C Lunar tides alone without wind

D Ozone depletion over the ocean

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Surge = wind-driven coastal flooding — often deadlier than wind on flat coasts. **Ans: A.** **Cyclone winds push seawater onshore** as storm surge. **Trap:** **Eye** is calm — strongest winds and surge occur in the **eyewall**, not the eye.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

In a mature tropical cyclone, the strongest winds are found in the:

A Eye

B Eyewall

C Outer rainbands only

D Stratosphere above the storm

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Eye = calm low pressure; eyewall = maximum wind and rain ring. **Ans: B.** The **eyewall** has the **strongest winds**. **Trap:** **Eye** — calm centre, not maximum wind zone.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to environment and disasters, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Degradation raises disaster risk (e.g., deforestation worsens floods/landslides).
2. Disasters never damage ecosystems; only ecosystems cause disasters.
3. Deforestation always prevents landslides.

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (degradation raises risk). Statement 2 is false — disasters also damage ecosystems. Statement 3 is false — deforestation worsens, not prevents, many landslides.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A NDMA	1 Response force
B NDRF	2 DM Act 2005; PM chairs
C Sendai	3 DRR framework

Code:

A. A-2, B-3, C-1

B. A-1, B-2, C-3

C. A-2, B-1, C-3

D. A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** NDMA/NDRF/Sendai.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Arrange drought ladder:

A. Hydrological → meteorological → agricultural

B. No sequence

C. Agricultural → meteorological only

D. Meteorological → agricultural → hydrological

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Met → agri → hydro. **Logic:** Standard teaching order.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): DPAP began in 1973.

Reason (R): DPAP began in 1952 as the first Five-Year Plan only.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** DPAP 1973 — not 1952 (CDP trap).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to cyclones, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tropical cyclones form best over cold seas below about 15°C.
2. Bay of Bengal produces more than Arabian Sea.
3. Eye has the strongest winds; eyewall is calm.

A Only 2
B 1 and 3
C Only 1
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (BoB > Arabian Sea frequency). Statement 1 is false — warm seas ~26–27°C are needed. Statement 3 swaps eye (calm) and eyewall (strongest winds).

Chapter 24: Current Environmental Issues — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to the LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment) Mission, consider the following statements:

1. It was launched in June 2022.
2. The idea was proposed at COP-25 in Madrid, Spain.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** LiFE launch June 2022 is true; idea came at **COP26 Glasgow 2021**, not COP-25 Madrid. **Ans: D (Only 1).** **Launch June 2022** is correct; COP-25 Madrid claim is false. **Trap:** **COP-25 Madrid 2019** instead of **COP26 Glasgow 2021**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to MISHTI, consider the following statements:

1. It was initiated in 2019.
2. It aims to restore mangrove forests.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** MISHTI = Union Budget **2023–24** mangrove scheme — restoration aim is correct. **Ans: A (Only 2).** Only the **mangrove restoration** aim is correct. **Trap:** **2019** start year — MISHTI is a **2023–24 Budget** announcement.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which international agreement is related to climate change mitigation?

A Montreal Protocol
B Ramsar Convention
C Kyoto Protocol
D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Kyoto/Paris = GHG mitigation; Montreal = ozone/ODS. **Ans: C.** The **Kyoto Protocol** addresses climate change mitigation. **Trap:** **Montreal Protocol** — ozone treaty, not climate.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Report)	List-II (Organisation)
A Human Development Report	1 IMF
B World Economic Outlook	2 UNEP
C World Investment Report	3 UNDP
D Emissions Gap Report	4 UNCTAD

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 1 4 2

B 3 4 1 2

C 1 2 3 4

D 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Emissions Gap = UNEP product in net-zero/emissions-gap teaching block. **Ans: A (3 1 4 2).** Emissions Gap Report → **UNEP**; HDR → **UNDP**. **Trap:** IPCC or UNDP as Emissions Gap publisher.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The concept of 'carbon credit' originated from:

A Earth Summit, Rio

B Kyoto Protocol

C Montreal Protocol

D G-8 Summit

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Kyoto flexible mechanisms (CDM/CERs) established tradable carbon credit architecture. **Ans: B.** **Carbon credits originated from the Kyoto Protocol** mechanisms. **Trap:** **Rio 1992** (UNFCCC framework) without Kyoto's CDM detail.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

One carbon credit typically represents reduction or removal of:

A One kilogram of CO_2

B One tonne of CO_2 equivalent (tCO_2e)

C One megatonne of methane only

D One hectare of forest cover

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Standard market unit = 1 tCO_2e per credit certificate. **Ans: B.** **One carbon credit = one tonne of CO_2 equivalent**. **Trap:** Kilogram scale or hectare land unit confusion.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Clean Development Mechanism (CDM) was introduced under:

A Montreal Protocol
B Kyoto Protocol
C Ramsar Convention
D CITES

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CDM = Kyoto flexible mechanism for project-based credits in developing countries. **Ans: B.** **CDM operates under the Kyoto Protocol**. **Trap:** Paris Agreement (CDM era is Kyoto-linked in standard stems).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Perform, Achieve and Trade (PAT) is a market-based scheme for trading:

A Carbon credits identical to EU ETS
B Energy efficiency certificates (ESCerts)
C Wildlife trade permits
D Ozone-depleting substance quotas

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** PAT = BEE-administered energy efficiency trading — parallel but not identical to carbon credits. **Ans: B.** **PAT trades energy efficiency certificates (ESCerts)**. **Trap:** Calling PAT a **carbon credit** scheme directly.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

India announced a target to achieve net-zero emissions by:

A 2050
B 2060
C 2070
D 2030

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** COP26 Glasgow 2021 announcement — India net zero **2070**. **Ans: C.** **India's net-zero target year is 2070**. **Trap:** **2050** (EU/UK/US pledge timeline) applied to India.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Sustainable Development Goal 14 (SDG 14) focuses on:

A Life on Land
B Life Below Water
C Climate Action
D Responsible Consumption

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Blue economy chapter links MISHTI/Sagarmala to SDG 14 oceans goal. **Ans: B.** **SDG 14 = Life Below Water**. **Trap:** SDG 15 (Life on Land) or SDG 13 (Climate Action).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to microplastics, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Plastic fragments smaller than 5 mm.
2. Primary microplastics come only from fragmentation of larger plastics; secondary ones are only factory microbeads.
3. They are always rapidly biodegradable in hours.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (<5 mm). Statement 2 swaps primary (microbeads/pellets) and secondary (fragmentation). Statement 3 is false — they are not rapidly biodegradable in hours.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A 1 carbon credit	1 2023 eco-action rewards
B PAT	2 1 tCO_2e
C Green Credit	3 ESCerts

Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1
D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1. **Logic:** Credit/PAT/Green Credit.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. India net zero — 2070 (COP26 Glasgow)
2. China often — 2052 teaching
3. Green Credit — identical to Kyoto CER always

A 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): PAT creates energy-efficiency certificates (ESCerts).

Reason (R): PAT is identical to carbon credits under CCTS.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** PAT ≠ carbon credit.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to LiFE, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Idea pitched at COP26 Glasgow 2021.
2. Launched June 2022.
3. Idea first at COP25 Madrid.

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Not COP25.

Chapter 25: Global Environmental Geography — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Assertion (A): The interior part of Australia is desert and semi-desert.

Reason (R): Northern Australia is situated in the temperate zone.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** (A) is false, but (R) is true

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** (A) on interior aridity is true. (R) is false — northern Australia is largely **tropical**, not temperate. **Ans: C.** Interior desert from **subtropical high + continentality**, not temperate-zone location. **Trap:** Accepting northern Australia as **temperate** to explain desert.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following tribe–habitat pairs:

1. Bushman — Kalahari
2. Eskimo — Northern Canada
3. Pygmy — Congo basin
4. Masai — West Africa

Which pair(s) is/are **NOT correctly matched?**

- **A** Only 1
- **B** Only 4
- **C** Only 2
- **D** Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Masai are East African (Kenya/Tanzania), not West Africa — only the fourth pair is wrong. **Ans: B (Only 4).** **Masai–West Africa** is the incorrectly matched pair. **Trap:** Bushman–Kalahari or Pygmy–Congo — both are standard correct pairs.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The Gobi Desert extends into:

1. Mongolia
2. China
3. Russia
4. Kazakhstan

A Only 1 and 2	**B** Only 1, 2 and 4
C Only 1, 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Gobi cold desert spans Mongolia–China core; Russia/Kazakhstan are marginal distractors. **Ans: A.** **Gobi extends mainly into Mongolia and China**. **Trap:** Adding **Russia** or **Kazakhstan** as primary extent countries.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to Brazil, consider the following statements:

1. Equatorial rainforests there are called "Selva".
2. Fertile dark soil known as "Terra Roxa" is found there.

A Only 1	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Amazon Selva + basaltic Terra Roxa coffee/soy belt — both standard Brazil geography facts. **Ans: C (Both 1 and 2).** **Selva** and **Terra Roxa** statements are both correct. **Trap:** Terra Roxa confused with **latosol/terra firme** generic labels only.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Planting Hearth	1 Hungary
B Cryophyte Steppe	2 Adolf Engler
C World Floral Regions	3 C.O. Sauer
D Puszta Grassland	4 Arctic Tundra

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 4 2 1

B 2 1 4 3

C 3 4 1 2

D 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Engler = floral regions; Sauer = planting hearth; Puszta = Hungary; cryophyte steppe = Arctic tundra. **Ans: A (3 4 2 1).** Sauer (3), Arctic Tundra (4), Engler (2), Hungary (1). **Trap:** Swapping **Engler** and **Sauer**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which one of the following natural regions is known as the "Land of Big Games"?

A Temperate Grassland

B Tropical Monsoon Region

C Hot Desert Region

D Tropical Savanna Region

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** African savanna (Serengeti-type) = big-game grassland–woodland mosaic. **Ans: D.** **Tropical Savanna** is the Land of Big Games. **Trap:** **Temperate grassland** (Pampas/Prairie) or **hot desert** safari confusion.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Natural Vegetation)	List-II (Region)
A Epiphytes	1 Mediterranean
B Acacia	2 Equatorial
C Baobab	3 Sahara
D Cedars	4 Savanna

Row order is not the answer code.

A 2 3 4 1

B 2 3 1 4

C 2 4 3 1

D 2 4 1 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Epiphytes–equatorial; acacia–Sahara fringe; baobab–savanna; cedars–Mediterranean. **Ans: A (2 3 4 1).** Code **2 3 4 1** for equatorial–Sahara–savanna–Mediterranean pairs. **Trap:** Baobab on Sahara or acacia on equatorial rainforest.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Pampas grassland is located mainly in:

A Argentina

B Hungary

C Australia

D Kazakhstan

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Temperate grassland names — Pampas = Argentina; Puszta = Hungary; Prairie = North America. **Ans: A.** **Pampas grassland is in Argentina**. **Trap:** **Hungary** (Puszta) or **Kazakhstan** (steppe).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Permafrost is characteristically found in which biomes?

A Tropical rainforest and monsoon forest

B Taiga and tundra

C Hot desert and Mediterranean scrub

D Tropical savanna only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Cold high-latitude/altitude belts — boreal forest with frozen ground patches and continuous tundra permafrost. **Ans: B.** **Permafrost occurs in taiga and tundra**. **Trap:** **Savanna** or **desert** — no continuous permafrost.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Species diversity generally _____ from the equator towards the poles.

A increases
B decreases
C remains constant
D peaks at mid-latitudes only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Latitudinal diversity gradient — richest near equator, poorer toward poles. **Ans: B.** **Species diversity decreases from equator to poles**. **Trap:** Statement "diversity increases toward poles" — false stem in 2019 Q58 trap family.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to biomes, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Large climate-defined vegetation–fauna regions.
2. Ecosystem means only a continent-scale climate zone identical to a biome.
3. Biome and ecosystem are identical terms always.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (biome = large climate-defined region). Statement 2 is false — ecosystem is the local biotic–abiotic functional unit. Statement 3 is false — biome ≠ ecosystem always.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match Köppen letters:

List-I	List-II
A A	1 Arid
B B	2 Tropical
C C	3 Temperate
D E	4 Polar

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
C A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4. **Logic:** Tropical/arid/temperate/polar.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Sahara — largest hot desert
2. Atacama — among the driest
3. Gobi — Mongolia and China

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Desert classics.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Australia's interior desert is explained mainly by subtropical high pressure and continentality.

Reason (R): Northern Australia is situated in the temperate zone.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** UPPCS-style Australia A/R trap — north is tropical, not temperate.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Brazil, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Selva = Amazon equatorial rainforest name.
2. Terra Roxa = fertile dark volcanic soil.
3. Both can be true together in match stems.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Selva + Terra Roxa.

Chapter 26: Water Resources & Water Conservation — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Arrange the following freshwater reservoirs in **descending** order of their share of total global freshwater:

1. Oceans
2. Rivers
3. Polar ice and glaciers
4. Groundwater

A 1, 3, 4, 2

B 1, 2, 4, 3

C 1, 2, 3, 4

D 1, 4, 3, 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Freshwater fraction ranking — ice caps > groundwater > rivers; oceans are saline (often listed as distractor in stem). **Ans: A (1-3-4-2).** Among freshwater stores: **ice > groundwater > rivers**. **Trap:** Rivers second after oceans — rivers are the **smallest** usable freshwater fraction.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

The Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024 was prepared by:

1. Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
2. Central Water Commission (CWC)
3. Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CGWB assesses groundwater quantity/quality; CPCB handles surface pollution; CWC surface water data. **Ans: B (Only 3).** **CGWB** publishes the Annual Groundwater Quality Report. **Trap:** **CPCB** (surface/air pollution board) or **CWC** confusion.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following Ramsar sites are **NOT located in Uttar Pradesh?**

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel
2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

A 1 and 3
B 3 and 4
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Wetland conservation + UP geography — Tripura and Haryana sites outside UP. **Ans: B (3 and 4).** **Rudrasagar = Tripura**; **Sultanpur = Haryana**. **Trap:** Assuming all four names are UP Ramsar sites.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

A geographical unit that collects, stores and releases water is called—

A Watershed
B Wasteland
C Wetland
D Water Reserve

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Watershed/catchment definition — drainage basin hydrology. **Ans: A.** A **watershed** collects, stores, and releases water. **Trap:** **Wetland** — stores water but is an ecosystem type, not the drainage-unit definition.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The watershed development project enabling rural populations to conserve water is known as:

A Jal Kranti
B Pani Sansad
C Hariyali
D Atal Bhujal Yojana

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Hariyali = GoI watershed project for rural water conservation. **Ans: C.** **Hariyali** is the watershed development project. **Trap:** **Jal Kranti** or **Atal Bhujal** (groundwater-specific, 2019).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

The main purpose of the Ganga Action Plan (1985) was to:

A Make Ganga water pollution-free
B Build large irrigation dams only
C Privatise river water rights
D Divert Ganga water to southern states

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** GAP/NRCP lineage — sewage interception and pollution abatement on Ganga. **Ans: A.** GAP aimed to make Ganga water **pollution-free**. **Trap:** River-linking or dam-building distractors — GAP is **pollution control**.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Jal Jeevan Mission was declared in the Union Budget of which financial year?

A 2021–22
B 2022–23
C 2020–21
D 2019–20

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** JJM launch August 2019 / Budget FY 2019–20 — Har Ghar Jal rural tap connections. **Ans: D.** **Jal Jeevan Mission was announced in FY 2019–20**. **Trap:** Post-COVID years (2020–21 onward) as launch window.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in:

A 1974
B 1981
C 1986
D 1972

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Water 1974 created CPCB/SPCB — separate from Air 1981 and EPA 1986. **Ans: A.** The **Water Act year is 1974**. **Trap:** **1981** (Air Act) or **1986** (EPA).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which state first made rooftop rainwater harvesting mandatory in new buildings (2003)?

A Rajasthan
B Tamil Nadu
C Kerala
D Gujarat

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tamil Nadu 2003 mandatory RWH — Chennai model cited in water conservation teaching. **Ans: B.** **Tamil Nadu (2003)** mandated RWH in new buildings. **Trap:** **Rajasthan** (traditional johad/taanka) without mandatory urban law date.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Sukhomajri (Haryana) is a classic success story of:

A Community watershed management
B Offshore desalination
C Nuclear-powered irrigation
D Interlinking of Himalayan rivers

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Community watershed + afforestation + water harvesting model before IWMP scaling. **Ans: A.** **Sukhomajri exemplifies community watershed management**. **Trap:** National river-linking megaproject distractor.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which is not a biotic resource?

A Coal
B Petroleum
C Fish
D Freshwater

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bank traps on biotic vs freshwater, NWM scope, disinfection, lakes, Ganga institutions, and personalities. **Ans: D.** Freshwater is abiotic; coal/petroleum counted biotic via organic origin.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

'Jal Purush' / Waterman of India is—

A Sunderlal Bahuguna
B Rajendra Singh (Tarun Bharat Sangh)
C Salim Ali
D Medha Patkar

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Magsaysay 2001; Stockholm Water Prize 2015.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

National Water Mission correctly includes—

A Only full Himalaya–peninsula river linking as a core goal
B Wastewater recycling for urban needs and +20% water-use efficiency framing
C Full reimbursement of all farmer borewell costs nationwide
D Only ozone treaty compliance

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Statements 1–2 of the classic UPSC NWM stem; 3–4 false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

UV in water purification primarily—

A Removes all odours and settles all turbidity
B Inactivates/kills harmful microorganisms without changing taste/odour
C Adds chlorine taste deliberately
D Only measures BOD

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only the microbial-kill claim is correct among the three UPSC statements.

Q15 **UP RO/ARO 2014**

NLCP urban lakes set correctly excludes—

A Bhoj (MP)

B Sukhna (Chandigarh)

C Pichola (Rajasthan)

D Chilika (Odisha)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Chilika is not under the NLCP list in bank teaching.

Chapter 27: Renewable & Non-Renewable Energy (अनवीकरणीय ऊर्जा) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Major constituents of biogas include:

1. Methane
2. Butane
3. Carbon dioxide
4. Carbon monoxide

A 1 and 3
B 3 and 4
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Biogas = anaerobic digestion product — CH_4 + CO_2 dominant. **Ans: A (1 and 3).** **Methane and carbon dioxide** are major biogas constituents. **Trap:** **Butane** (LPG component) as biogas constituent.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to hydroelectric power in Northern India, consider the following statements:

1. The Himalayan region has enormous hydroelectric potential.
2. Eastern Uttar Pradesh and Bihar cannot utilise Himalayan hydro because the Himalayas to their north lie in Nepal.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Himalayan hydro potential true; Nepal excuse in statement 2 is false. **Ans: D (Only 1).** **Only statement 1 is correct**. **Trap:** Accepting statement 2 — Indian projects in Uttarakhand/HP benefit the plain states.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the International Solar Alliance (ISA), consider the following statements:

1. It is the first treaty-based intergovernmental organization headquartered in India and has 38 member countries.
2. The World Solar Bank and One Sun One World One Grid (OSOWOG) initiatives have been undertaken under it.

A Only 1
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** OSOWOG under ISA is correct; fixed "38 members" count is outdated. **Ans: A (Only 2).** **Only statement 2 is correct**. **Trap:** Rejecting statement 2 because statement 1 sounds precise.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Non-conventional energy sources are those that are—

A Non-renewable
B Renewable
C Produced from electricity
D Produced from heat only

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Indian usage treats non-conventional ≈ renewable (solar, wind, biomass, tidal, SHP). **Ans: B.** **Non-conventional sources are renewable**. **Trap:** **Non-renewable** — that describes conventional fossils, not solar/wind.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following is **NOT a biomass energy source?**

A Coal
B Nuclear fuel
C Gobar (cow dung)
D Wood

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Biomass = organic matter; coal is fossilised carbon; nuclear is uranium/thorium. **Ans: A.** **Coal is not biomass**. **Trap:** Nuclear is also non-biomass, but coal is the standard keyed answer.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

A non-renewable source of energy is:

A Solar energy
B Petroleum
C Wind energy
D Biogas

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Petroleum is a finite fossil fuel; solar, wind, and biogas are renewable. **Ans: B.** **Petroleum is non-renewable**. **Trap:** Confusing **biogas** (renewable) with fossil gas.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The largest tidal energy potential in India is associated with the:

- **A** North Circars coast
- **B** Mannar coast
- **C** Khambhat (Cambay) coast
- **D** Kerala coast

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Gulf of Khambhat has India's highest tidal range — potential fact. **Ans: C.** **Khambhat (Cambay) coast** has the largest tidal energy potential. **Trap:** Kerala or eastern coast names without highest range.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Solar energy is converted into electric energy through—

- **A** Dry cells
- **B** Leclanché cells
- **C** Voltaic cells
- **D** Photovoltaic cells

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** PV cells directly convert sunlight to electricity in solar applications. **Ans: D.** **Photovoltaic cells** convert solar to electric energy. **Trap:** Generic **voltaic/dry cell** chemistry distractors.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The Energy Conservation Act, 2001 established which body as the nodal authority for energy efficiency?

- **A** Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)
- **B** Central Electricity Authority only
- **C** NITI Aayog
- **D** MNRE

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** BEE under EC Act 2001 — administers PAT and standards/star labelling. **Ans: A.** **BEE was established under the Energy Conservation Act, 2001**. **Trap:** **MNRE** (renewable promotion) vs **BEE** (efficiency regulation).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Perform, Achieve and Trade (PAT) is a scheme for:

- **A** Trading energy efficiency certificates among designated consumers
- **B** Trading wildlife permits
- **C** Trading CFC quotas under Montreal Protocol
- **D** Trading Ramsar wetland credits

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** PAT = market-based energy efficiency compliance under BEE — ESCerts trading. **Ans: A.** **PAT trades energy efficiency certificates (ESCerts)**. **Trap:** Confusing PAT with **carbon credit** markets directly.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Energy crisis commonly means:

A Only shortage of hydroelectricity

B Malnutrition in the human body

C Danger of exhaustion of fossil fuels like coal and petroleum

D Only shortage of thermal power plants

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Classification swaps (renewable / fossil / nuclear / biomass) and biofuel feedstock pairs are the densest traps. **Ans: C.** UN Decade of Sustainable Energy for All = **2014–2024** (UN initiative).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

a fossil fuel?

A Coal

B Petroleum

C Natural gas

D Uranium

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Uranium is nuclear fuel — non-renewable but not fossil.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Best electricity source among options for sustainable development:

A Coal

B Mineral oil and gas

C Hydroelectricity

D Atomic energy

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Water is not depleted by generation the way fossil/nuclear stocks are.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Ultimate source of energy stored in fossil fuels:

A Earth interior only

B Sun

C Sea

D Moon

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Ancient photosynthesis. Geothermal heat itself is **not** “from the Sun” in MCQ sense.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Maize is primarily cultivated among energy crops for:

A Biodiesel only

B Ethanol

C Nuclear fuel

D Tidal power

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Jatropha / Pongamia / sunflower → biodiesel; maize → ethanol.

Chapter 28: Environmental Research & Institutions — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

ISFR 2023 — Uttar Pradesh districts with forest over more than 20% of geographical area:

1. Bahraich
2. Chandauli
3. Shravasti

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR 2023 UP district trap — Terai Bahraich is not automatically above 20% cover. **Ans: C.** Chandauli and Shravasti crossed 20%; Bahraich stays near ~10% despite Terai location. **Trap:** Listing every Terai border district as high-cover.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

As per the India State of Forest Report–2021, which State registered the maximum increase in forest cover during the last two years?

A Kerala
B Assam
C Arunachal Pradesh
D Andhra Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR 2021 absolute gain leader among the four options — Andhra Pradesh, not percentage-leader Mizoram. **Ans: D.** Andhra Pradesh led absolute gain in that ISFR cycle (~647 km^2 class), with Telangana and Odisha also high. **Trap:** Picking Mizoram or Madhya Pradesh because they lead on percentage or total area respectively.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which pair is correctly matched?

A Botanical Survey of India — national animal survey, Kolkata

B Zoological Survey of India — national plant survey, Kolkata

C Botanical Survey of India — national plant survey, Kolkata

D Zoological Survey of India — forest cover mapping, Dehradun

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** BSI/ZSI split — plants vs animals; both Kolkata, not Dehradun. **Ans: C.** BSI (1890) documents plants; ZSI (1916) documents animals — both HQ Kolkata. **Trap:** Swapping plant/animal mandates or placing survey institutes in Dehradun with FSI/FRI/WII.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

India State of Forest Report (ISFR) is published by:

A Forest Survey of India, Dehradun, every two years

B Forest Research Institute, Dehradun, annually

C Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata, every two years

D CPCB, New Delhi, annually

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISFR publisher, city, and frequency — FSI Dehradun, every two years. **Ans: A.** FSI (1981, Dehradun) maps forest and tree cover and releases ISFR biennially. **Trap:** FRI publishes ISFR, or ISFR is annual/CPCB product.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Assertion (A): Forest Research Institute publishes the India State of Forest Report.
Reason (R): Both FRI and Forest Survey of India are headquartered at Dehradun.

A Both true; R explains A

B Both true; R does not explain A

C A false; R true

D Both false

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dehradun duo — FRI researches forestry; FSI maps cover; same city, different output. **A/R logic:** A tests ISFR publisher; R tests shared Dehradun HQ — same city does not mean same mandate. **Ans: C.** A is false — **FSI** publishes ISFR; FRI (1906) does silviculture/forestry research under ICFRE. R is true. **Trap:** "Both in Dehradun → same body."

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Wildlife Institute of India was established in:

A 1982 at Dehradun

B 1890 at Kolkata

C 2002 at Chennai

D 1978 at New Delhi

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** WII founding year and wildlife-science role. **Ans: A.** WII (1982, Dehradun) trains IFS officers and designs tiger-estimation protocols — not BSI/ZSI taxonomy or ISFR mapping. **Trap:** Confusing WII with ZSI (1916) or NBA (BDA 2002).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

National Biodiversity Authority under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002 is headquartered at:

A New Delhi
B Chennai
C Kolkata
D Lucknow

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NBA seat under Biological Diversity Act 2002 — Chennai, not Delhi. **Ans: B.** NBA regulates foreign access and ABS from **Chennai**. **Trap:** Placing NBA in Delhi with MoEFCC, or in Kolkata with BSI/ZSI.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

People's Biodiversity Register (PBR) is prepared by:

A Biodiversity Management Committee at local level
B National Biodiversity Authority, Chennai
C Forest Survey of India
D State Pollution Control Board

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** PBR is a local BMC duty under BDA — not NBA headquarters work. **Ans: A.** BMCs at panchayat/municipality level document local species and traditional knowledge in the PBR. **Trap:** "Biodiversity authority → national register."

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR) is located at:

A New Delhi (Pusa Campus)
B Kolkata
C Karnal
D Chennai

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NBPGR = ICAR plant gene bank, New Delhi (Pusa) — ex-situ germplasm. **Ans: A.** NBPGR (1978, ICAR) conserves crop genetic resources ex-situ. **Trap:** Kolkata because BSI is there, or Karnal because that is the animal gene bank.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which statement is correct?

A NBPGR at New Delhi stores plant germplasm; NBAGR at Karnal stores animal/livestock germplasm
B Both NBPGR and NBAGR are headquartered at Kolkata
C NBPGR surveys wild fauna for Red Data Book
D NBAGR publishes ISFR

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Plant gene bank (NBPGR Delhi) vs livestock gene bank (NBAGR Karnal). **Ans: A.** NBPGR = plants, Delhi; NBAGR = animals/livestock, Karnal — do not interchange. **Trap:** Treating any "gene bank" as one Kolkata institute.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to HQ map, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Kolkata — BSI and ZSI.
2. Dehradun — FSI, FRI and WII.
3. NBA — New Delhi.

A Only 3	B Only 1
C 1 and 2	D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2 are correct. **Logic:** Statements 1–2 match the HQ map (Kolkata BSI/ZSI; Dehradun FSI/FRI/WII). Statement 3 is false — NBA HQ is Chennai, not New Delhi.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A BSI	1 Animals / Fauna
B ZSI	2 Plants / Flora
C NBPGR	3 New Delhi plant gene bank

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Plants/animals/gene bank.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. FSI — ISFR every two years
2. FSI — forestry research (ICFRE neighbourhood)
3. FRI — publishes ISFR

A 1 and 2	B Only 3
C 2 and 3	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): NBA sits in Chennai under the Biological Diversity Act.

Reason (R): NBA headquarters is New Delhi like NBPGR.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Chennai — not Delhi.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to biodiversity pyramid, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. NBA → SBB → BMC.
2. BMCs prepare People's Biodiversity Register.
3. PBR is an NBA HQ publication series only.

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** PBR is local BMC work.

Chapter 29: Indian Environmental Movements — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Appiko Movement is associated with:

1. Uttarakhand
2. Uttar Pradesh
3. Kerala
4. Karnataka

A 1 and 2
B Only 4
C 3 and 4
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Appiko state trap — Karnataka only; UK/UP = Chipko; Kerala = Silent Valley. **Ans: B.** Appiko (1983, Sirsi/Uttara Kannada) is **Karnataka only**. **Trap:** Pairing Appiko with Garhwal because both used tree-embrace methods.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Chipko Movement and Dandi March are both examples of:

A Passive resistance / non-violent protest
B Armed rebellion against the State
C International treaty negotiations
D Judicial public-interest litigation only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chipko and Dandi March grouped as non-violent passive resistance in UPSC stems. **Ans: A.** Chipko villagers hugged trees; Dandi March broke the salt law — both are classic **passive resistance**. **Trap:** Calling Chipko armed or purely legal petitioning.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Chipko Movement began in:

A 1973 at Reni, Garhwal Himalaya (then Uttar Pradesh, now Uttarakhand)
B 1983 in Sirsi, Karnataka
C 1730 at Khejarli, Rajasthan
D 1970s in Silent Valley, Kerala

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chipko origin — 1973 Reni, Garhwal; Gaura Devi and Bahuguna are anchor names. **Ans: A.** Chipko = **1973**, Reni, leaders include **Gaura Devi**, **Bahuguna**, **Bhatt**. **Trap:** 1983 Appiko year or 1730 Bishnoi date applied to Chipko.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Silent Valley Movement was primarily:

A Anti-hydroelectric dam struggle to save tropical evergreen forest in Kerala

B Anti-logging tree-hug in Uttarakhand

C Mining protest only in Jharkhand Singhbhum

D Western Ghats policy report movement of 2011

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Silent Valley = Kerala rainforest anti-dam; Kunthipuzha river; KSSP science campaign. **Ans: A.** Silent Valley (Palakkad, Kerala) opposed KSEB dam on **Kunthipuzha**; KSSP led science-based advocacy. **Trap:** Tamil Nadu or Karnataka placement.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Narmada Bachao Andolan is most closely linked to:

A Medha Patkar and anti-large-dam displacement in the Narmada valley (MP, Gujarat, Maharashtra)

B Panduranga Hegde and Karnataka logging

C Amrita Devi and 1730 khejri martyrdom

D Gadgil Committee report on Western Ghats mining

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Narmada Bachao = Medha Patkar; multi-state Narmada valley anti-large-dam displacement. **Ans: A.** NBA (movement) spans **MP–GJ–MH** with **Medha Patkar** and **Baba Amte** as leader facts — not the National Biodiversity Authority. **Trap:** Medha Patkar = Chipko.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Amrita Devi and the Khejarli martyrdom (363 lives) are associated with:

A Bishnoi Movement, Rajasthan, 1730

B Chipko Movement, 1973

C Appiko Movement, 1983

D Save Western Ghats, 2011

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bishnoi 1730 Khejarli — centuries before Chipko; Amrita Devi memory. **Ans: A.** Bishnoi resistance at **Khejarli (1730)** protected **khejri** trees — oldest movement in the syllabus set. **Trap:** 1973 Chipko date or Amrita Devi Smriti Award confused with Chipko itself.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Appiko Movement (1983) was led by:

A Panduranga Hegde in Karnataka

B Sunderlal Bahuguna in Garhwal

C Medha Patkar on the Narmada

D Gaura Devi at Reni

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Appiko leader Hegde, year 1983, Kannada "embrace" — southern Chipko. **Ans: A.** **Hegde** launched Appiko in **Sirsi/Kalase, Karnataka** to stop clear-felling. **Trap:** Bahuguna/Hegde swap or Appiko dated 1973.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Jungle Bachao Andolan (1982) originated in:

A Singhbhum, Jharkhand

B Reni, Uttarakhand

C Palakkad, Kerala

D Sirsi, Karnataka

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Jungle Bachao = Singhbhum tribal forest rights, 1982 — not Garhwal. **Ans: A.** Tribal communities in **Singhbhum** resisted forest exploitation for livelihood rights. **Trap:** Mapping every "Jungle Bachao" slogan to Chipko Garhwal.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Save Western Ghats Movement (from about 2011) centred on:

A Gadgil (2011) and Kasturirangan (2013) expert reports on mining, ESZ, and ecology

B Tree-hugging at Reni village in 1973

C Khejarli martyrdom in Rajasthan

D Floating phumdis of Loktak Lake

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Save Western Ghats ecology politics — Gadgil 2011 vs Kasturirangan 2013 reports. **Ans: A.** Multi-state **policy/ecology** protest around Western Ghats expert committees — distinct from 1983 Appiko tree embrace. **Trap:** Treating Appiko and Save Western Ghats as the same campaign.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which pair is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Silent Valley Movement — Kerala

B Chipko Movement — Uttarakhand (Garhwal)

C Appiko Movement — Karnataka

D Silent Valley Movement — Tamil Nadu

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Silent Valley state — Kerala, not Tamil Nadu. **Ans: D.** Silent Valley is in **Kerala (Palakkad)**; A, B, C are correct. **Trap:** Palakkad proximity to TN border used to push Tamil Nadu as the state.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to Bishnoi, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Khejarli, Kerala, 1730.
2. Amrita Devi and 363 martyrs memory.
3. It began at Reni, Uttarakhand in 1973.

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C Only 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 2 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is true. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Chipko	1 Sirsi, Karnataka 1983
B Appiko	2 Reni 1973
C Jungle Bachao	3 Singhbhum 1982

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3
D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Chipko/Appiko/Jungle Bachao.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Silent Valley — Kerala Palakkad rainforest–dam
2. Narmada Bachao Andolan has no base in Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat or Maharashtra.
3. Appiko — Uttarakhand only

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false — Narmada Bachao spans Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat and Maharashtra. Statement 3 is false — Appiko is Karnataka (Western Ghats), not Uttarakhand-only.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Chipko began at Reni in then Uttar Pradesh (now Uttarakhand).

Reason (R): Appiko and Silent Valley are UP movements.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Appiko Karnataka; Silent Valley Kerala.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to method families, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Chipko, Appiko, Bishnoi — forest/tree protection.
2. Silent Valley, Narmada Bachao — anti-dam.
3. Save Western Ghats — Gadgil/Kasturirangan ESZ politics neighbourhood.

- **A** 1, 2 and 3
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Method family map.

Chapter 30: Environmental Literature & Awareness — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Assertion (A): Sustainable Development was popularised by the Brundtland Report.
Reason (R): The Brundtland Report is also known as "The Limits to Growth".

- **A** Both true; R does not explain A
- **B** A false; R true
- **C** Both true; R explains A
- **D** A true; R false

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests Brundtland → SD popularisation; R wrongly names Limits to Growth as Brundtland Report. **Ans: D.** A is true — *Our Common Future* (1987) popularised SD. R is false — *Limits to Growth* (1972) is **Club of Rome**, not Brundtland. **Trap:** Club of Rome title glued to Brundtland name.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

***Silent Spring* (1962) was written by:**

- **A** Carolyn Merchant
- **B** Karl Marx
- **C** Rachel Carson
- **D** Rajgopalan

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Silent Spring authorship — Rachel Carson 1962, not Hardin or Club of Rome. **Ans: C.** Carson exposed pesticide harm (especially DDT) and catalysed modern environmental awareness. **Trap:** Garrett Hardin (*Tragedy of the Commons*, 1968) or Brundtland for Carson works.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The 1987 UN report that defined and popularised sustainable development is:

- **A** Silent Spring
- **B** Our Common Future
- **C** Limits to Growth
- **D** Hind Swaraj

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 1987 WCED report title — Our Common Future = Brundtland Report. **Ans: B.** Brundtland Commission / WCED produced ***Our Common Future* (1987)**. **Trap:** Limits to Growth (1972) or Silent Spring (1962) year-title swap.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Agenda-21 of Rio Summit (1992) is related to—

A Sustainable Development
B Polluter Pays
C Environmental Education alone
D Ozone Layer

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Agenda 21 primary frame — Rio 1992 sustainable-development action plan (Chapter 36 covers EE as one part). **Ans: A.** Agenda 21 is Rio's non-binding **SD** action plan; EE appears inside it but is not the sole headline. **Trap:** Picking "Environmental Education only" because Tbilisi/EE syllabus overlap.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

With reference to Mission LiFE:

1. It was launched in June 2022.
2. The idea was first proposed at COP-25 Madrid.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** LiFE launch June 2022 true; COP-25 Madrid idea false — idea at COP-26 Glasgow 2021. **Ans: D.** Launch **June 2022** is correct; the idea came at **COP-26 Glasgow (2021)**, not COP-25 Madrid. **Trap:** Any "COP-25 LiFE" distractor.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

"The Tragedy of the Commons" (1968) was written by:

A Garrett Hardin
B Rachel Carson
C Brundtland Commission
D Club of Rome

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tragedy of the Commons essay — Garrett Hardin 1968. **Ans: A.** Hardin's essay on overuse of shared resources — distinct from Carson (1962) and Club of Rome *Limits* (1972). **Trap:** Hardin credited with *Silent Spring*.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Tbilisi Declaration (1977) is chiefly associated with:

A Environmental Education
B Ozone layer protection
C Wetlands wise use
D Carbon credit trading

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tbilisi 1977 — landmark Environmental Education declaration; not Stockholm UNEP birth (1972). **Ans: A.** **Tbilisi (1977)** formalised global EE principles after Stockholm (1972) put EE on the agenda. **Trap:** Stockholm 1972 = UNEP creation, not Tbilisi EE milestone.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Protection of the natural environment is a duty of every citizen under:

- **A** Article 51A(g) of the Constitution
- **B** Article 368 only
- **C** Schedule 7 List I alone
- **D** Wildlife Protection Act 1972 Section 35

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Art 51A(g) — Fundamental Duty to protect environment; distinct from Art 48A State policy. **Ans: A.** **Art 51A(g)** is the citizen's fundamental duty; **Art 48A** is the State's directive principle. **Trap:** Mixing fundamental duty with DPSP or WPA sections.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

ECO Clubs under the National Green Corps programme are run by:

- **A** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- **B** Central Pollution Control Board alone
- **C** Reserve Bank of India
- **D** International Solar Alliance secretariat only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ECO Club / National Green Corps under MoEFCC — not CPCB pollution enforcement. **Ans: A.** NGC/ECO Club is MoEFCC's school EE network (~2001-02 national push). **Trap:** CPCB because "environment" appears in both names.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Van Mahotsav, the tree-plantation campaign associated with K.M. Munshi, is observed in:

- **A** July
- **B** February
- **C** 5 June
- **D** 22 April

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Van Mahotsav — July plantation week; K.M. Munshi; not February or WED June. **Ans: A.** **Van Mahotsav = July** mass planting drive in India. **Trap:** 5 June (WED), 22 April (Earth Day), or 21 March (International Day of Forests).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to the four pillars, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The four pillars are only IUCN Red List categories, not literature/education/awareness/communication.
2. Keep pillar → flagship distinct.
3. All four are identical to IUCN categories.

A Only 1	B 1 and 2
C Only 3	D Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 keeps pillar distinct from flagship. Statement 1 mislabels the four pillars. Statement 3 wrongly equates them with IUCN categories.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Silent Spring	1 Garrett Hardin 1968
B Tragedy of the Commons	2 Rachel Carson 1962
C Limits to Growth	3 Club of Rome 1972

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Carson/Hardin/Club of Rome.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Our Common Future — Brundtland 1997
2. Limits to Growth — Club of Rome 1972
3. Brundtland — identical to Limits to Growth

A Only 2	B Only 1
C 1 and 2	D Only 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 2 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is true. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Silent Spring exposed pesticide/DDT harms.

Reason (R): It is Hardin's commons essay.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Carson ≠ Hardin.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to EE landmarks, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tbilisi 1977.
2. MoEFCC NGC/ECO Clubs.
3. GSDP 2017 and NEP 2020 ESD language.

- **A** 1, 2 and 3
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** EE spine.

Chapter 31: Environmental Days — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following pair(s) is/are **NOT correctly matched?**

1. International Ozone Day — 16 September
2. World Environment Day — 5 June
3. World Wildlife Day — 22 March

A 1 and 2	B Only 3
C 2 and 3	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Wildlife Day on 22 March is the classic wrong pair — correct date is 3 March (CITES); Water Day is 22 March. **Ans: B.** Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. **World Wildlife Day = 3 March** (CITES 1973); **22 March = World Water Day**. **Trap:** Same "22" number chain — Wildlife vs Water vs Biodiversity (22 May).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

World Wetlands Day is observed on—

A 10 January	B 15 January
C 1 February	D 2 February

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ramsar adoption date — World Wetlands Day is 2 February only. **Ans: D.** Marks Ramsar Convention adoption at Ramsar, Iran (**2 February 1971**). **Trap:** 2 March, 3 March (Wildlife), or 22 March (Water).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

On which date is Ozone Day observed?

A October 2	B September 16
C April 29	D January 30

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ozone Day = Montreal signing date, 16 September — not WED 5 June. **Ans: B.** **16 September** — Montreal Protocol signed **1987**; entered into force **1 January 1989**. **Trap:** Gandhi Jayanti (2 Oct), Earth Day (22 Apr), or WED (5 Jun).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

'World Ozone Day' is celebrated on

A 25 December
B 21 April
C 16 September
D 30 January

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Same Ozone Day fact — UPPCS 2021 stem wording variant. **Ans: C.** International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer = **16 September**. **Trap:** 21 April (Earth Day) or 5 June (WED).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

World Population Day is observed on:

A 11 July
B 5 June
C 22 April
D 2 February

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** World Population Day = 11 July — 5 June is WED distractor in 2018-style stems. **Ans: A.** **Population Day = 11 July**. **Trap:** 5 June looks “environmental” but is **World Environment Day (Stockholm 1972)**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

World Environment Day is observed on:

A 5 June (Stockholm Conference 1972)
B 22 April (Earth Day 1970 USA)
C 2 February (Ramsar Wetlands Day)
D 16 September (Montreal Protocol)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** WED anchor — 5 June, Stockholm Conference opening 1972, run by UNEP. **Ans: A.** WED = **5 June** — UNEP-led UN day from Stockholm **1972**. **Trap:** Earth Day (22 Apr) or Ozone Day (16 Sep) as “the” global environment day.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Earth Day is observed every:

A 22 April (first celebrated 1970 in the United States)
B 5 June
C 22 March
D 21 March

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Earth Day civic origin — 22 April 1970 USA teach-ins; not a UN treaty day like WED. **Ans: A.** **Earth Day = 22 April** — global civic movement from 1970 US origin. **Trap:** 22 March (Water), 22 May (Biodiversity), or 5 June (WED).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

International Day for Biological Diversity commemorates CBD adoption on:

A 22 May
B 22 March
C 22 April
D 3 March

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CBD text adoption — Biological Diversity Day = 22 May (not March/April). **Ans: A.** **22 May** marks Nairobi **1992** CBD text adoption (observed from 2000 onward in UN calendar). **Trap:** 22 March (Water) or 3 March (Wildlife/CITES).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

World Water Day falls on:

A 22 March
B 3 March
C 21 March
D 2 February

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UN-Water coordinates World Water Day — 22 March in the March ladder after Wildlife (3) and Forests (21). **Ans: A.** **Water = 22 March** — between International Day of Forests (**21 March**) and Earth Day (**22 April**). **Trap:** 3 March (Wildlife) — the 2025 Q62 killer pair.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

World Wildlife Day (wild fauna and flora) is observed on:

A 3 March (CITES adoption 1973)
B 22 March
C 2–8 October (Wildlife Week India)
D 29 July (International Tiger Day)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CITES anniversary — Wildlife Day 3 March; proclaimed by UN 2013. **Ans: A.** **Wildlife Day = 3 March** — CITES **1973**; UN proclaimed **2013**. **Trap:** 22 March (Water), October Wildlife Week, or 29 July Tiger Day.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to environmental days, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. World Wetlands Day — 2 February (Ramsar 1971).
2. World Wildlife Day — 3 March (CITES adoption anniversary).
3. World Wildlife Day — 22 March.

A 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D Only 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2 are correct. **Logic:** Wetlands Day is 2 February; Wildlife Day is 3 March (CITES). Statement 3 is the Water Day trap (22 March).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A World Water Day	1 22 April
B Earth Day	2 22 March
C Biological Diversity Day	3 22 May

Code:

(A) A-2, B-3, C-1
(B) A-1, B-2, C-3
(C) A-2, B-1, C-3
(D) A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Same-number 22 traps across months.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. International Day of Forests is observed on 22 May.
2. World Environment Day is observed on 22 April.
3. World Ozone Day — 16 September

(A) Only 2
(B) Only 3
(C) Only 1
(D) 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 3 is true (Ozone Day 16 September). Statement 1 is false — Forests Day is 21 March. Statement 2 is false — WED is 5 June (22 April is Earth Day).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The March ladder is Wildlife (3) → Forests (21) → Water (22).

Reason (R): Wildlife Day falls on 22 March.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(B) (A) is false, but (R) is true
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(D) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Never put Wildlife on 22 March.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to treaty anchors, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Stockholm 1972 anchors WED.
2. Montreal 1987 anchors Ozone Day.
3. Ramsar 1971 anchors Wetlands Day.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Treaty → day map.

Chapter 32: National Parks & Protected Areas (Advanced) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Dachigam	1 Madhya Pradesh
B Keoladeo	2 Rajasthan
C Kanha	3 Kerala
D Periyar	4 Jammu and Kashmir

Row order is not the answer code.

A 4 2 3 1

B 2 4 1 3

C 2 4 3 1

D 4 2 1 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Four-NP state match — Dachigam J&K, Keoladeo Rajasthan, Kanha MP, Periyar Kerala. **Ans: D.** Dachigam=J&K (4); Keoladeo=Rajasthan (2); Kanha=MP (1); Periyar=Kerala (3). **Trap:** Swapping Kanha–Periyar states or placing Keoladeo in UP.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which Ramsar sites are **NOT** located in Uttar Pradesh?

1. Sarsai Nawar Jheel
2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

A 1 and 3

B 3 and 4

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP Ramsar trap — Sarsai Nawar and Samaspur are in UP; Rudrasagar Tripura and Sultanpur Haryana are not. **Ans: B.** **Sarsai Nawar** and **Samaspur** are in UP. **Rudrasagar = Tripura**; **Sultanpur NP = Haryana**. **Trap:** Assuming every bird wetland in the Gangetic plain is UP.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

A Sonbhadra
B Chandauli
C Bahraich
D Lakhimpur Kheri

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chandraprabha WLS district — Chandauli, among earliest UP sanctuaries (1957). **Ans: B.** Chandraprabha lies in **Chandauli** district. **Trap:** Sonbhadra (Kaimur forests) or Bahraich (Terai trio with Katarniaghat).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

In National Parks, genetic diversity is maintained through—

A In-situ conservation
B Ex-situ conservation
C Gene pool
D None

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** National Parks conserve wild populations in natural habitat — in-situ genetic diversity maintenance. **Ans: A.** NPs are strict in-situ sites under WPA. **Trap:** "Gene pool" label or botanical garden (ex-situ) distractors.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which Wildlife Sanctuary of Uttar Pradesh was established in 1975?

A Chambal
B Katarniaghat
C Raipur
D Kishanpur

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Katarniaghat establishment year among UP Terai sanctuaries — 1975. **Ans: B.** **Katarniaghat (Bahraich)** was established **1975** in the Dudhwa Terai Arc. **Trap:** Kishanpur (same corridor, different year) or National Chambal (multi-state).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Dudhwa National Park is situated in which district of Uttar Pradesh?

A Bahraich
B Lakhimpur Kheri
C Pilibhit
D Sitapur

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dudhwa NP district — Lakhimpur Kheri, not Pilibhit or Bahraich. **Ans: B.** Dudhwa — UP's only full NP — sits in **Lakhimpur Kheri**. **Trap:** Pilibhit Tiger Reserve (adjacent Terai, not Dudhwa district).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Keibul Lamjao National Park is located in which lake?

A Loktak
B Dal
C Wular
D Kolleru

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Keibul Lamjao — world's only floating NP on Loktak, Manipur (phumdis, Sangai deer). **Ans: A.** Keibul Lamjao floats on **Loktak (Manipur)**. **Trap:** Dal/Wular (J&K) or Kolleru (AP) lake-NP pairs.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Indravati	1 Jharkhand
B Mollem	2 Haryana
C Kalesar	3 Goa
D Betla	4 Chhattisgarh

Row order is not the answer code.

A 4 3 2 1
B 4 2 3 1
C 4 1 3 2
D 3 4 2 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2020 four-NP state code — Indravati CG, Mollem Goa, Kalesar Haryana, Betla Jharkhand. **Ans: A.** Indravati=Chhattisgarh (4); Mollem=Goa (3); Kalesar=Haryana (2); Betla=Jharkhand (1). **Trap:** Betla/Betva OCR confusion or Mollem placed in Karnataka.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Dachigam National Park is associated with which of the following?

A Musk Deer
B Golden Oriole
C Yellow-throated Marten
D Hangul or Kashmir Stag

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dachigam flagship species — Hangul (Kashmir stag), not musk deer or Gir lion. **Ans: D.** **Hangul** is the Kashmir stag of **Dachigam (J&K)**. **Trap:** Musk deer (Himalayan sanctuaries) or Sangai (Loktak).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following pairs is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Bandipur National Park — Karnataka

B Manas Wildlife Sanctuary — Assam

C Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary — Kerala

D Simlipal National Park — Madhya Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Simlipal state trap — Odisha, not Madhya Pradesh (Bandipur/Kanha are MP/Karnataka). **Ans: D.** **Simlipal = Odisha**; A, B, C are correct. **Trap:** Simlipal grouped with central-Indian tiger landscapes (MP).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which river–park pair is correct?

A Corbett — Ganga

B Kaziranga — Manas

C Silent Valley — Kunthipuzha

D Corbett — Kaveri

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** River–park, species–park, and state–park mismatches are the densest traps in this chapter. **Ans: C.** Corbett = Ramganga + Kosi; Kaziranga = Brahmaputra / Diphlu system; Silent Valley = Kunthipuzha.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

?

A Jim Corbett — Tiger

B Keoladeo Ghana — Lion

C Kaziranga — Rhinoceros

D Periyar — Elephant

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Ghana / Bharatpur is a bird park — not lion habitat. Gir = Asiatic lion.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Pin Valley National Park is in:

A Jammu and Kashmir

B Himachal Pradesh (Lahaul–Spiti)

C Uttarakhand

D Sikkim

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Great Himalayan NP = Kullu (HP). Van Vihar = Bhopal (MP).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which statements about National Park vs Sanctuary / BR are correct?
1. NP boundaries are defined by legislation; alteration needs State Legislature.
2. Biosphere Reserves exist only to conserve a few specific species.
3. Limited biotic interference may be permitted in a Wildlife Sanctuary.

A 1 only
B 2 and 3
C 1 and 3
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Statement 2 is false — BRs conserve all forms of life with support systems and sustainable use.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Rajaji National Park is correctly described as:

A Only in Dehradun district; never a tiger reserve
B Merger of Rajaji–Motichur–Chilla (1983); TR in 2015; three UK districts
C Located in Rajasthan like Sariska
D Same as Corbett Tiger Reserve

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Named after C. Rajagopalachari. Corbett remains India's first NP (1936).

Chapter 33: Biosphere Reserves (जैवमंडल आरक्षित क्षेत्र) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following pair(s) is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

1. Nokrek — Manipur
2. Manas — Assam
3. Agasthyamalai — Kerala

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Nokrek–Manipur is the sole wrong pair — Nokrek is in Meghalaya (smallest Indian BR). **Ans: D.** Only statement 1 is wrong — **Nokrek = Meghalaya**. Manas–Assam and Agasthyamalai–Kerala are correct. **Trap:** Nokrek confused with North-East state names (Manipur/Nagaland).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Simlipal	1 Kerala
B Nokrek	2 Odisha
C Agasthyamalai	3 Assam
D Manas	4 Meghalaya

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1 2 4 3
B 3 1 4 2
C 2 4 3 1
D 2 4 1 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Four-BR match code 2-4-1-3 — Simlipal Odisha, Nokrek Meghalaya, Agasthyamalai Kerala, Manas Assam. **Ans: D.** Simlipal=Odisha (2); Nokrek=Meghalaya (4); Agasthyamalai=Kerala (1); Manas=Assam (3). **Trap:** Simlipal in MP or Agasthyamalai only in Tamil Nadu (it spans KL–TN but Kerala is the keyed match).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Manas	1 Madhya Pradesh
B Sundarbans	2 Uttar Pradesh
C Nanda Devi	3 Assam
D Pachmarhi	4 West Bengal

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

B. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

C. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

D. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2022 paper keyed Nanda Devi to Uttar Pradesh in List-II — geography fact is Uttarakhand; UP has zero BRs. **Ans: D (paper code).** Manas=Assam (3); Sundarbans=WB (4); Pachmarhi=MP (1); Nanda Devi paired with UP (2) in the paper. **Geography fact:** Nanda Devi BR is in **Uttarakhand**; **UP has no BR**. **Trap:** Post-2000 statehood — never mark Nanda Devi as UP on a fact card.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Similipal	1 Uttarakhand
B Pachmarhi	2 Meghalaya
C Nandadevi	3 Madhya Pradesh
D Nokrek	4 Odisha

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 4 3 2 1

B. 4 3 1 2

C. 1 3 4 2

D. 3 4 1 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2021 four-BR code 4-3-1-2 — Similipal Odisha, Pachmarhi MP, Nanda Devi Uttarakhand, Nokrek Meghalaya. **Ans: B.** Similipal=Odisha (4); Pachmarhi=MP (3); Nanda Devi=Uttarakhand (1); Nokrek=Meghalaya (2). **Trap:** Nanda Devi listed as UP or Nokrek as Manipur.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following is **NOT an example of in-situ conservation?**

A Biosphere reserve
B Botanical garden
C National Park
D Sacred groves

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** In-situ vs ex-situ — botanical garden is ex-situ; BR/NP/sacred groves are in-situ. **Ans: B.** Botanical gardens conserve plants **outside** natural wild habitat (ex-situ). **Trap:** Treating any garden under biodiversity law as in-situ.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

India's first Biosphere Reserve (notified 1986) is:

A Nilgiri (Tamil Nadu–Karnataka–Kerala)
B Nanda Devi (Uttarakhand)
C Nokrek (Meghalaya)
D Sundarbans (West Bengal)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** First notified Indian BR — Nilgiri 1986, not Nanda Devi. **Ans: A.** **Nilgiri (1986)** was India's first BR. **Trap:** Nanda Devi WH fame or Nokrek smallest label used to pick wrong first.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

In a Biosphere Reserve under UNESCO MAB, regulated human settlements and livelihoods belong mainly to the:

A Core zone
B Buffer zone
C Transition (manipulation) zone
D Exosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** MAB zonation — core strict protection; transition sustainable human use. **Ans: C.** **Transition zone** supports sustainable use and settlements; **core** bans exploitative activity. **Trap:** No people anywhere in a BR or farming allowed in core.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Manas Biosphere Reserve (Assam):

A Was removed from UNESCO World Network of Biosphere Reserves in 2011 but remains a national BR
B Is no longer any kind of Biosphere Reserve in India
C Was never part of the World Network
D Is located in Manipur

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Manas UNESCO delisting 2011 — remains national BR. **Ans: A.** UNESCO **delisted Manas in 2011**; it is still a **national BR** in Assam. **Trap:** Removed from UNESCO means ceased to be a BR entirely.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which statement about Biosphere Reserves in Uttar Pradesh is correct?

A. Uttar Pradesh has no notified Biosphere Reserve
B. Dudhwa is UP's only Biosphere Reserve
C. Valmiki is a UP Biosphere Reserve
D. Nanda Devi lies in Uttar Pradesh

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Uttar Pradesh has zero notified Biosphere Reserves. **Ans: A.** **UP = zero BRs**. Dudhwa is an NP; Valmiki is Bihar; Nanda Devi is Uttarakhand. **Trap:** Any UP Terai name assumed to carry a BR tag.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which pair is correctly matched?

A. Largest Biosphere Reserve of India — Great Rann of Kutch
B. Largest Biosphere Reserve of India — Nokrek
C. Smallest Biosphere Reserve — Great Rann of Kutch
D. Smallest Biosphere Reserve — Nilgiri

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Great Rann largest national BR; Nokrek smallest. **Ans: A.** **Great Rann of Kutch** is the largest national BR; **Nokrek (Meghalaya)** is the smallest. **Trap:** Gulf of Mannar largest marine confused with overall largest.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Correct zone match for a Biosphere Reserve:

A. Core — crop cultivation and settlements
B. Buffer — no human activity of any kind forever
C. Transition — settlements and livelihood use allowed
D. Core — industrial mining encouraged

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Zone purposes, largest/smallest, and state–BR mismatches dominate BR stems. **Ans: C.** Core = no exploitation; Buffer = research/tourism/regulated use; Transition = settlements/cultivation.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

a UNESCO WNBR site among common options historically?

A. Nilgiri
B. Gulf of Mannar
C. Rann of Kutch (often national-only in older stems)
D. Nanda Devi

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Great Rann of Kutch is India's largest **national** BR; older stems treat it as outside UNESCO network. Nilgiri/Mannar/Nanda Devi are classic WNBR sites.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve includes:

A Kawal and Srisailam only

B Neyyar, Peppara, Shendurney WLS and Kalakad–Mundanthurai TR

C Mudumalai and Silent Valley only

D Only Andhra Papikonda

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Kerala–Tamil Nadu Western Ghats landscape.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Decreasing area order (common set):

A Pachmarhi > Nanda Devi > Agasthyamalai > Panna > Khangchendzonga

B Nanda Devi > Pachmarhi > Agasthyamalai > Panna > Khangchendzonga

C Khangchendzonga > Panna > Nanda Devi

D Panna > Gulf of Mannar > Sundarbans

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Among UNESCO area comparisons, Gulf of Mannar > Sundarbans > Pachmarhi > Khangchendzonga.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Bundala Biosphere Reserve is in:

A India

B Bangladesh

C Sri Lanka

D Nepal

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Southeast coast of Sri Lanka — migratory bird wintering ground.

Chapter 34: Climate Change (जलवायु परिवर्तन) (Advanced) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Human Development Report	1 IMF
B World Economic Outlook	2 UNEP
C World Investment Report	3 UNDP
D Emissions Gap Report	4 UNCTAD

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 1 4 2

B 3 4 1 2

C 1 2 3 4

D 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Report–agency match — Emissions Gap = UNEP; HDR = UNDP; WEO = IMF; WIR = UNCTAD. **Ans: A.** HDR=UNDP (3); WEO=IMF (1); WIR=UNCTAD (4); Emissions Gap=**UNEP (2)**. **Trap:** Emissions Gap credited to IPCC or UNDP.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which international agreement is related to climate change mitigation?

A Montreal Protocol

B Ramsar Convention

C Kyoto Protocol

D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Kyoto = climate mitigation; Montreal = ozone/ODS — never swap treaty families. **Ans: C.** **Kyoto Protocol (1997)** sets GHG mitigation for developed parties. **Trap:** Montreal (ozone) or Ramsar (wetlands) as climate treaties.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

What was India's rank in the world in greenhouse gas emissions in 2022?

A 9th
B 10th
C 11th
D 12th

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2023 Q109 keyed 10th — distinct from absolute total-emissions rank (~3rd). **Ans: B.** Paper answer **10th** (performance-index framing). India is ~**3rd** in **absolute** total emissions — do not mix frames. **Trap:** Picking 3rd when options stop at 12th without reading the stem metric.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which is **NOT** a greenhouse gas?

A Argon
B CFC
C Methane
D Carbon dioxide

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Noble gases — argon is not a greenhouse gas; CO2, CH4, CFCs are. **Ans: A.** **Argon** is inert air (~0.93%) and not a GHG. **Trap:** Confusing N2 or Ar with N2O (which is a GHG).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The concept of 'carbon credit' originated from

A Earth Summit Rio
B Kyoto Protocol
C Montreal Protocol
D G-8 Summit

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Carbon credit market origin — Kyoto CDM/JI/ET, not Montreal or Rio alone. **Ans: B.** Kyoto (1997) created **CDM/JI/Emissions Trading** — **1 credit ≈ 1 tCO2e**. **Trap:** Montreal (ozone) or Green Credit Programme (2023) as Kyoto twin.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Largest CO2 emitter in 2015:

A China
B USA
C India
D France

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2015 largest CO2 emitter — China ahead of USA and India. **Ans: A.** **China** led absolute CO2 emissions in 2015. **Trap:** India because of recent growth narrative, or USA historical cumulative confusion in a single-year stem.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Mission LiFE:

1. It was launched in June 2022.
2. The idea was first proposed at COP-25 Madrid.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** LiFE June 2022 launch true; COP-25 Madrid idea false — COP-26 Glasgow 2021. **Ans: D.** Launch **June 2022** correct; idea at **COP-26 Glasgow (2021)**, not COP-25. **Trap:** Any Madrid COP-25 LiFE distractor.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which statement is correct?

A IPCC publishes scientific assessment reports; UNFCCC is the climate treaty framework
B IPCC sets legally binding national emission targets for all parties
C UNFCCC publishes the Emissions Gap Report annually
D IPCC and UNEP Emissions Gap Report are the same document

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** IPCC assesses science; UNFCCC hosts treaty/NDC negotiations — different mandates. **Ans: A.** **IPCC = science (WMO+UNEP parents)**; **UNFCCC = treaty/COP/NDCs**. **Trap:** IPCC sets targets or publishes Emissions Gap (that is **UNEP**).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Under Kyoto-era carbon markets, one carbon credit generally represents:

A One tonne of CO2 equivalent reduced or avoided
B One kilogram of ozone-depleting substance
C One hectare of forest cover on a map
D One megawatt of solar capacity only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** One carbon credit = one tonne CO2 equivalent under Kyoto market tools. **Ans: A.** Standard unit = **1 tCO2e**. **Trap:** Confusing with PAT **ESCerts** (energy efficiency) or green credits (2023).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

India's net-zero target year and NAPCC launch year are:

A Net zero 2070; NAPCC 2008
B Net zero 2050; NAPCC 1997
C Net zero 2030; NAPCC 2015 only
D Net zero 2070; NAPCC 2023

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** India net-zero year 2070 announced at COP-26; NAPCC launched 2008. **Ans: A.** **Net zero = 2070** (COP-26, 2021); **NAPCC = 2008** with eight missions. **Trap:** 2050 net-zero or Paris 2015 mistaken as NAPCC birth year.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to climate change vs warming, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Climate change means only a one-day weather anomaly.
2. Global warming = temperature-rise part only.
3. Both terms are identical always.

A Only 1	B 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	D Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 correctly narrows global warming to the temperature-rise component. Statement 1 is false — climate change is a long-term shift in temperature, rainfall, and extremes. Statement 3 wrongly treats the terms as always identical.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Keeling Curve	1 Annual UNEP
B Emissions Gap Report	2 Mauna Loa CO_2 since 1958
C IPCC	3 Science assessment; WMO+UNEP parents

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Keeling / Gap / IPCC.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. The main GHGs exclude CO_2, CH_4, N_2O and F-gases.
2. Argon — greenhouse gas
3. N_2 gas — not a greenhouse gas; N_2O is

A 1 and 2	B Only 3
C 2 and 3	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 3 is true (N_2 ≠ GHG; N_2O is). Statement 1 wrongly excludes the main GHGs. Statement 2 is false — argon is not a GHG.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Emissions Gap Report is an annual UNEP product.

Reason (R): It is published by the IPCC.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** UNEP — not IPCC.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to relative GHG shares (WMO-style), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CO_2 ~64% > CH_4 ~19% > CFCs+others ~11% > N_2O ~6%.
2. Water vapour dominates the natural greenhouse effect.
3. Solar flares are the primary recent warming driver.

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Primary drivers = fossils/autos/deforestation.

Chapter 35: Atmosphere — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

The ozone layer, which absorbs ultraviolet radiation, exists in which layer of the atmosphere?

- **A** Troposphere
- **B** Mesosphere
- **C** Stratosphere
- **D** Thermosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ozone layer location — ~90% of atmospheric ozone sits in the stratosphere, not troposphere. **Ans: C.** Protective ozone maximum is in the **stratosphere** (~15–35 km). **Trap:** Troposphere because of ground-level photochemical ozone pollution.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

The Earth's atmosphere is mainly heated by which one of the following?

- **A** Long-wave terrestrial radiation
- **B** Scattered solar radiation
- **C** Reflected solar radiation
- **D** Short-wave solar radiation

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Atmospheric heating — surface emits longwave IR that warms the lower atmosphere from below. **Ans: A.** The surface absorbs shortwave solar energy and re-emits **longwave terrestrial radiation** that heats the troposphere. **Trap:** Direct shortwave heats the ground first, not the main lower-air heating mechanism.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The maximum concentration of Ozone is found in which of the following?

- **A** Troposphere
- **B** Mesosphere
- **C** Stratosphere
- **D** Exosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Maximum ozone concentration layer — stratosphere in both 2018 and 2023 stems. **Ans: C.** **Stratosphere** holds peak ozone column. **Trap:** Mesosphere (meteors) or exosphere (satellites).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following pairs is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Renneting — Cheese
B Genetic Engineering — Plasmids
C Golden rice — Vitamin A
D Ozone layer — Troposphere

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Wrong pair trap — ozone layer is never in troposphere on match lists. **Ans: D.** Ozone layer = **stratosphere**. A, B, C are correctly matched distractors. **Trap:** Accepting ozone anywhere in the atmosphere as the protective layer location.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

With reference to the ozone layer:

1. It protects Earth's surface from solar ultraviolet radiation.
2. Ozone depletion has been linked to CFCs.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Stratospheric ozone protects from UV; CFCs linked to depletion — both statements true. **Ans: C.** Good stratospheric ozone shields **UV**; **CFCs/ODS** drive anthropogenic depletion. **Trap:** Denying CFC link or treating all ozone as harmful ground pollutant.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Diffusion of light in the atmosphere takes place due to

A Carbon dioxide
B Dust particles
C Helium
D Water vapours

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Light scattering — dust aerosols scatter sunlight (blue sky, red sunset). **Ans: B.** **Dust/aerosols** scatter visible light. **Trap:** CO2 (GHG IR trapping) or water vapour alone without aerosol context.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which is **NOT a greenhouse gas found naturally in the atmosphere?**

A Nitrogen oxide
B Carbon dioxide
C Methane
D Ozone

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Natural GHG set — CO2, CH4, O3 yes; nitrogen oxides not in the classic natural GHG list tested here. **Ans: A.** **CO2, CH4, O3** are natural GHGs in this stem set; **NOx** is not treated as that major natural GHG basket. **Trap:** Confusing N2 (not GHG) with N2O (is GHG).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Weather (clouds, storms, rainfall) occurs mainly in the:

A Troposphere
B Stratosphere
C Mesosphere
D Thermosphere

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Weather phenomena — confined to troposphere where water vapour and convection dominate. **Ans: A.** **Troposphere** alone has day-to-day weather. **Trap:** Stratosphere because ozone or jet streams are taught nearby.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which pair is correctly matched?

A Meteors burning up — Mesosphere
B Meteors burning up — Troposphere
C Aurora borealis — Troposphere only
D International Space Station orbit — Exosphere only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Meteors burn in mesosphere; aurora/ISS in thermosphere — layer-function pairing. **Ans: A.** **Meteors ~50–85 km (mesosphere)**; aurora/ISS sit in **thermosphere** band. **Trap:** Putting meteors in troposphere because shooting stars appear in the sky below.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Near-surface dry air composition includes:

A Nitrogen ~78%, Oxygen ~21%, Argon ~0.93%
B Oxygen ~78%, Nitrogen ~21%, CO2 ~21%
C Argon ~21%, Nitrogen ~0.04%, CO2 ~78%
D Nitrogen and oxygen both major greenhouse gases

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dry air composition — N2 ~78%, O2 ~21%, Ar ~0.93%; N2 is not a GHG. **Ans: A.** Permanent gases **N2/O2/Ar** dominate by volume; trace **CO2 ~0.04%** still drives enhanced greenhouse effect. **Trap:** Percentage dominance mistaken for radiative importance, or argon listed as GHG.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to atmospheric layers (bottom to top), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Troposphere → Stratosphere → Mesosphere → Thermosphere → Exosphere.
2. Weather lives in the stratosphere.
3. Ozone layer maximum is in the troposphere.

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Troposphere	1 Ozone layer; T rises with height
B Stratosphere	2 Weather; T falls with height
C Mesosphere	3 Coldest; most meteors burn

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1

B A-1, B-2, C-3

C A-2, B-1, C-3

D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Tropo/strato/meso.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Thermosphere is a cold dense weather layer with no link to auroras or the ionosphere.
2. Exosphere — outermost fringe merges into space
3. Exosphere — main weather layer

A Only 1

B Only 2

C 1 and 2

D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (exosphere = outermost fringe). Statement 1 is false — thermosphere is hot but thin and hosts aurora/ISS/ionosphere neighbourhood facts. Statement 3 is false — weather is tropospheric.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Dry air is about N_2 78%, O_2 21%, argon ~0.93%, CO_2 ~0.04%.

Reason (R): Argon is a major greenhouse gas.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Argon is not a GHG.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to N_2 vs N_2O, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Nitrogen gas (N_2) is not a greenhouse gas.
2. Nitrous oxide (N_2O) is a greenhouse gas.
3. N_2 and N_2O are identical greenhouse gases.

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Do not confuse N_2 with N_2O.

Chapter 36: Ozone Layer — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to the ozone layer:

1. It protects Earth's surface from solar ultraviolet radiation.
2. Ozone depletion has been linked to CFCs.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Both UV-shield role and CFC–depletion link are standard facts — answer both statements. **Ans: C.** Stratospheric ozone absorbs **UV-B/C**; **CFCs** release stratospheric chlorine radicals. **Trap:** Treating ground-level O3 smog as the protective layer.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer is observed on:

A 5 June
B 16 September
C 22 March
D 2 February

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** International Ozone Day = Montreal signing date, 16 September. **Ans: B.** **16 September** marks Montreal Protocol signature (**1987**). **Trap:** 5 June (WED) or 22 March (Water Day).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which international agreement is related to climate change mitigation?

A Montreal Protocol
B Ramsar Convention
C Kyoto Protocol
D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Montreal = ozone/ODS; Kyoto = climate — 2024 Q35 mitigation stem. **Ans: C.** **Kyoto** mitigates GHGs; **Montreal** phases out **ODS**. **Trap:** Montreal because it is the headline ozone treaty in this chapter.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The ozone layer exists mainly in which atmospheric layer?

A Troposphere
B Mesosphere
C Stratosphere
D Thermosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ozone layer stratosphere location — overlaps Topic 35 but anchored here for ozone science. **Ans: C.** ~**90%** of ozone is stratospheric. **Trap:** Troposphere pair in NOT-matched lists.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

On which date is Ozone Day observed?

A October 2
B September 16
C April 29
D January 30

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ozone Day date recurrence — 2022 wording variant. **Ans: B.** **16 September** — Montreal Protocol date. **Trap:** Gandhi Jayanti or Earth Day month swaps.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Photochemical smog always contains—

A Phosphorus
B Ozone
C Methane
D Aluminium ion

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Photochemical smog always contains tropospheric ozone — secondary pollutant, distinct from stratospheric shield. **Ans: B.** **NOx + VOCs + sunlight → O3 + PAN** in photochemical smog. **Trap:** Confusing this bad ground O3 with stratospheric good ozone location.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

'World Ozone Day' is celebrated on

A 25 December
B 21 April
C 16 September
D 30 January

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** 2021 Ozone Day stem — same 16 September key. **Ans: C.** **16 September** worldwide. **Trap:** 21 April (Earth Day).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Cartagena — Biosafety

B Stockholm — POPs

C Montreal — Ozone layer

D Kyoto — Save water

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty match trap — Kyoto is climate/GHG, not save water; Montreal–ozone is correct. **Ans: D.** **Kyoto = climate/GHG mitigation**, not a water treaty. Montreal–ozone is correct. **Trap:** Kyoto paired with ozone or water because of generic environment label.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Consider the following:

1. Ultra-violet radiation from sunlight helps produce ozone (O3).
2. The ozone layer is located in the troposphere.

A Only 1

B Only 2

C Both 1 and 2

D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UV radiation produces ozone photochemically; wrong pair = ozone layer in troposphere. **Ans: A.** Statement 1 is true (UV-driven O3 chemistry). Statement 2 is false — ozone **layer = stratosphere**. **Trap:** Accepting pair ozone layer — troposphere on match lists (2018 Q57).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

The global ozone treaty sequence is:

A Vienna Convention 1985 (framework) → Montreal Protocol 1987 (ODS phase-out; in force 1 January 1989)

B Montreal 1985 → Vienna 1987

C Kyoto 1987 → Montreal 1992

D Vienna alone banned all CFCs without Montreal schedules

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Vienna 1985 framework → Montreal 1987 binding ODS phase-out; force date 1 Jan 1989. **Ans: A.** **Vienna = framework/cooperation**; **Montreal = binding ODS cuts** (signed 16 Sep 1987, force **1 Jan 1989**). **Trap:** Vienna alone as full CFC ban, or reversing treaty order.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Ozone layer absorbing UV exists mainly in the:

A Mesosphere

B Troposphere

C Stratosphere

D Thermosphere

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: About **90%** of ozone is stratospheric.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Stratospheric ozone is naturally regulated in large part by:

A Nitrous oxide only
B Nitrogen dioxide
C CFC alone as a natural regulator
D Water vapour alone

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: NO_2** helps regulate stratospheric ozone chemically.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which statement about Dobson Unit is correct?

A It measures ground-level ppm of ozone pollution only
B 1 DU ≈ 0.01 mm pure ozone at 0°C and 1 atm
C Hole threshold is always 500 DU
D It measures only UV-A

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Column measure; hole often **< 220 DU**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

correctly matched?

A Renneting — Cheese
B Golden rice — Vitamin A
C Genetic engineering — Plasmids
D Ozone layer — Troposphere

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Ozone layer = **stratosphere**.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Antarctic ozone-hole chemistry is best linked to:

A Tropospheric turbulence only
B Polar front + stratospheric clouds + CFCs
C Absence of polar front and PSCs
D Warm polar midsummer only

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: PSC chlorine activation + vortex isolation.

Chapter 37: Greenhouse Gases — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Major constituents of biogas:

1. Methane
2. Butane
3. Carbon dioxide
4. Carbon monoxide

A 1 and 3

B 3 and 4

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests biogas composition — methane plus carbon dioxide, not butane or CO alone. **Ans: A.** Biogas is mainly **CH_4 + CO_2** from anaerobic digestion. **Trap:** Butane and carbon monoxide are distractors; paddy gas is methane, not CO.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements:

1. Chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) are linked to stratospheric ozone depletion.
2. CFCs have no role in the greenhouse effect.

A Only 1

B Only 2

C Both 1 and 2

D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CFC dual role — greenhouse gas and ozone-depleting substance under Montreal. **Ans: A (Only 1).** CFCs destroy stratospheric ozone **and** are potent GHGs — statement 2 is false. **Trap:** Treating CFC as ODS-only or as "not a GHG."

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which is known as Laughing Gas?

A Ammonia
B Nitrous Oxide
C Carbon Monoxide
D Chlorofluorocarbon

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Common-name recall — laughing gas is nitrous oxide, not ammonia or CO. **Ans: B.** **N_2O** is laughing gas (GWP ~265; fertiliser soils). **Trap:** Ammonia (NH_3) or CFC as distractors.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which is NOT a greenhouse gas?

A Argon
B CFC
C Methane
D Carbon dioxide

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Noble gases and dry-air major components are not greenhouse gases; CFC is a GHG. **Ans: A.** **Argon** does not absorb outgoing infrared; CFC, CH_4, and CO_2 are GHGs. **Trap:** Picking CFC because it is "synthetic/industrial."

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Photochemical smog always contains—

A Phosphorus
B Ozone
C Methane
D Aluminium ion

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Photochemical smog chemistry always yields tropospheric ozone as a secondary product. **Ans: B.** NOx + VOCs + sunlight → **O_3** (and PAN). **Trap:** Confusing with London SO_2 smog or stratospheric ozone shield.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

CNG is mainly composed of—

A Methane
B Propane
C Ethane
D Butane

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CNG fuel composition — compressed natural gas is mainly methane. **Ans: A.** **CNG ≈ 90% methane.** **Trap:** Propane/butane as LPG distractors.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Gas emitted in paddy fields that increases Earth's temperature:

A Nitrogen
B Carbon dioxide
C Carbon monoxide
D Methane

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Flooded paddy fields emit marsh gas (methane) under anaerobic soils. **Ans: D.** Anaerobic rice paddies release **CH_4**. **Trap:** CO_2 or CO — paddies are classic methane stems.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Methane is emitted from:

A Paddy fields only
B Termitary only
C Both
D None

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Methane sources include wetlands, paddies, and termite mounds — not "paddy only." **Ans: C.** **Both** paddies and termites emit CH_4 (also landfills, cattle, wetlands). **Trap:** "Only one source" options.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Largest CO_2 emitter in 2015:

A China
B USA
C India
D France

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Absolute CO_2 emissions ranking — China was largest emitter in 2015 framing. **Ans: A.** **China** #1 by absolute CO_2; India ~3rd with low per capita. **Trap:** Picking India because of population alone.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which is NOT a greenhouse gas found naturally (among the options)?

A Nitrogen oxide
B Carbon dioxide
C Methane
D Ozone

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Among listed options, nitrogen oxides are pollutants — CO_2, CH_4, and O_3 are treated as natural GHGs in the stem. **Ans: A.** **NO/NO_2** are air pollutants, not classic GHGs in this list; CO_2, CH_4, and tropospheric O_3 qualify. **Trap:** Confusing N_2O (GHG) with nitrogen oxide.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to the greenhouse effect, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. GHGs absorb outgoing IR and trap heat.
2. Without the natural greenhouse effect Earth would be about +15°C; with it about −18°C.
3. Argon is the main greenhouse gas.

A 2 and 3	**B** Only 1
C 1 and 2	**D** Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is the GHG heat-trap mechanism. Statement 2 reverses the −18°C / +15°C teaching pair. Statement 3 is false — argon is not a main GHG.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A CO_2 GWP	**1** ~28–36; lifetime ~12 yr
B CH_4 GWP	**2** 1
C N_2O	**3** Very high GWP (~265); fertiliser link

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	**B** A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	**D** A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** GWP ladder.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Pre-industrial CO_2 was about 415–420 ppm.
2. Present >415–420 ppm teaching
3. WMO-style share order is N_2O > CFCs > CH_4 > CO_2.

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 3
C Only 1	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is the present >415–420 ppm teaching. Statement 1 swaps pre-industrial (~280 ppm) with present levels. Statement 3 reverses the usual CO_2 > CH_4 > CFCs > N_2O share order.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Water vapour is the most abundant natural GHG (~half of natural effect).

Reason (R): It mainly acts as a feedback, not the primary anthropogenic driver.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both true and R clarifies its role vs fossil CO_2. **A/R logic:** Feedback ≠ primary driver.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to CFC vs HFC, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CFCs = ODS + GHG (Montreal).
2. HFCs = GHG only; Kigali phase-down.
3. HFCs are classic ODS identical to CFCs.

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** HFC ≠ classic ODS.

Chapter 38: Pollution (Advanced) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements:

1. Lichens are very good indicators of pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Lichens are sensitive bio-indicators — they die back in polluted air; they do not thrive in it. **Ans: D (Only 1).** Statement 1 true; statement 2 false — lichens are **sensitive**, not pollution-tolerant. **Trap:** "Indicator" mistaken for "thrives in dirty air."

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024 was prepared by:

1. Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
2. Central Water Commission (CWC)
3. Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Groundwater quality reporting is CGWB's mandate — not CPCB or CWC. **Ans: B (Only 3).** **CGWB** publishes the annual groundwater quality report. **Trap:** Swapping CPCB (air/surface water) with CGWB.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD) is a standard criterion for—

A Pollution assay in aquatic ecosystems
B High-altitude O_2
C Blood O_2
D Forest O_2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** BOD measures microbial oxygen demand in water — an aquatic pollution assay, not blood oxygen. **Ans: A.** **BOD** assays organic pollution in rivers/lakes. **Trap:** "Oxygen" in the name → blood or altitude distractors.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which is not a biodegradable pollutant?

A Domestic waste	B Urine
C Faecal matter	D Pesticide

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Pesticides persist and are not readily biodegradable unlike domestic organic waste. **Ans: D.** **Pesticides** are persistent; domestic waste, urine, and faecal matter biodegrade. **Trap:** Assuming all "natural" chemicals biodegrade quickly.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Photochemical smog always contains—

A Phosphorus	B Ozone
C Methane	D Aluminium ion

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Photochemical smog always contains ozone as a key secondary product. **Ans: B.** NOx + VOCs + sunlight → **O_3** (+ PAN). **Trap:** London SO_2 smog without ozone chemistry.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

According to UNEP Frontier Report 2022, the second most noise-polluted city was:

A Kota	B Moradabad
C Indore	D Patna

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UNEP Frontier Report 2022 ranked Moradabad among the world's noisiest cities. **Ans: B.** **Moradabad** (UP brassware hub) was #2 in that report. **Trap:** Kota/Indore as generic UP/North India distractors.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which country has natural arsenic water contamination?

A Sri Lanka	B Bangladesh
C Bhutan	D Pakistan

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Natural arsenic in groundwater is classically associated with Bangladesh / lower Gangetic basin. **Ans: B.** **Bangladesh** is the textbook arsenic hotspot (Gangetic plains geology). **Trap:** Assuming arsenic is India-exclusive only.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Match the area with permissible noise level (daytime, as in paper):

Area	Level (dB)
Residential	55
Silence zone	50
Industrial	70
Commercial	65

Row order is not the answer code.

A Residential–50; Silence–55; Industrial–65; Commercial–70

B Residential–65; Silence–75; Industrial–50; Commercial–55

C Residential–55; Silence–50; Industrial–70; Commercial–65

D All zones at 75 dB

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CPCB daytime noise limits — silence zone lowest, then residential, commercial, industrial highest. **Ans: C.** Residential **55**, Silence **50**, Industrial **70**, Commercial **65** — silence < residential < commercial < industrial (paper industrial **70**; teach CPCB day industrial **75 dB** in notes). **Trap:** Reversing silence vs residential or using one dB for all zones.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Flyash pollution is caused by

A Oil refining

B Fertilizer industry

C Thermal power plant

D Mining

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Fly ash is a primary pollutant from coal thermal power plants — usable in bricks/cement. **Ans: C.** **Thermal power plants** emit fly ash (SiO_2/Al_2O_3/CaO plus toxic metals). **Trap:** Calling fly ash a secondary pollutant like smog.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to smog, consider the following:

1. Smog is essentially caused by oxides of nitrogen and sulphur in the atmosphere.
2. Among CO, CO_2, and fly ash, smog is the secondary pollutant.

A Only 1

B Only 2

C Both 1 and 2

D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Smog is a secondary pollutant; classical smog links to oxides of nitrogen and sulphur. **Ans: C.** Statement 1 matches **2019 Q136** (oxides of N and S); statement 2 matches **2018 Q121** (smog secondary; fly ash/CO primary). **Trap:** Treating fly ash or stack SO_2 alone as “smog” without atmospheric formation.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Human-made pollutants / human-modified environment are called—

A Natural only
B Anthropogenic
C Xenobiotic antibiotics only
D Humalins

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** These stems recycle bank traps on anthropogenic pollution, AQI gases, control devices, diseases, and remediation. **Ans: B.** Anthropogenic means caused or influenced by humans.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which is biodegradable among typical options?

A Mercury
B Plastic / asbestos
C Sewage
D Pesticide

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Sewage/domestic organic waste biodegrades; pesticide/plastic/Hg/asbestos do not (or only very slowly).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

India's AQI includes which set?

A CO_2 and CH_4 only
B PM10, PM2.5, NO_2, CO, O_3, SO_2, NH_3, Pb
C Only methane and CFC
D Only radon and neon

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Eight criteria pollutants — not CO_2/CH_4.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Powerful eye irritant in photochemical smog—

A Argon
B Peroxyacetyl nitrate (PAN)
C Pure nitrogen
D Helium

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: PAN is a secondary lachrymator in photochemical smog.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Most important classic indoor air pollutant gas—

A Outdoor ozone only

B Radon

C Stratospheric CFCs only

D Pure oxygen

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Radon from soil/radium accumulates indoors and raises lung-cancer risk.

Chapter 39: Acid Rain (अम्ल वर्षा) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements:

1. Acidic solutions have pH more than 7.
2. Basic solutions have pH less than 7.

A Only 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** pH scale basics — acidic < 7, basic > 7; both statements in the stem are reversed. **Ans: B (Neither).** Acidic **< 7**; basic **> 7** — both statements are wrong. **Trap:** Normal rain ~5.6 confused with "neutral = 7."

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Assertion (A): CO_2, SO_2, and NO_2 dissolve in rainwater and produce acid rain.

Reason (R): Air is polluted due to high CO_2, SO_2, and oxides of nitrogen.

A Both true; R explains A
B A false, R true
C Both true; R does not explain A
D A true, R false

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests whether CO_2/SO_2/NO_2 dissolve in rain; R tests air pollution — CO_2 gives only weak acid, so R does not explain strong acid rain. **Ans: C.** All three dissolve (A true); R true about pollution but **does not explain** why **CO_2 = weak H_2CO_3** while **SO_2/NOx → strong H_2SO_4/HNO_3**. **Trap:** Treating CO_2 as main severe acid-rain driver.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following gases is lighter than air?

A Sulphur dioxide
B Only helium
C Hydrogen chloride
D All of the above

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Gas density relative to air — SO_2 and HCl are heavier; helium is lighter. **Ans: B (Only helium).** **SO_2** and **HCl** are denser than air; helium rises. **Trap:** Assuming all pollutant gases sink — only SO_2 density is tested here.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Consider the following statements:

1. Lichens are very good indicators of pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A Only 2	**B** Neither
C Both	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Lichens are SO_2-sensitive bio-indicators — they indicate pollution but do not thrive in it. **Ans: D (Only 1).** Lichens die in high-SO_2 air — indicator ≠ thrives in pollution. **Trap:** Same lichen stem as Topic 38; answer is **Only 1**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Acid rain damage to the Taj Mahal mainly involves conversion of marble to:

A Gypsum ($CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$)	**B** Pure gold plating
C Ozone layer depletion	**D** Biogas methane

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Taj marble damage — acid reacts with $CaCO_3$ to form gypsum crust; SO_2 from nearby industry is the classic Indian fact. **Ans: A.** **$CaCO_3$ + acid → gypsum crust** (yellowing/spalling); Mathura refinery SO_2 corridor. **Trap:** Blaming CO_2 alone or ozone hole for marble damage.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Normal unpolluted rain has a pH of about:

A 5.6	**B** 7.0 exactly
C 14	**D** 2.0

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Acid rain threshold pH < 5.6; normal rain ~5.6 from weak carbonic acid — not pH 7. **Ans: A.** **~5.6** from $CO_2 \rightarrow H_2CO_3$; acid rain is **< 5.6**. **Trap:** "Natural = neutral 7."

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which international agreement primarily targets acidifying air pollutants (SO_2, NOx)?

A Montreal Protocol	**B** Gothenburg Protocol under CLRTAP
C CITES	**D** Minamata Convention

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Treaty pairing — Montreal = ozone ODS; Gothenburg/CLRTAP = acidifying pollutants. **Ans: B.** **Gothenburg/CLRTAP** cuts acidification; **Montreal** is ozone. **Trap:** Montreal as catch-all "environment" treaty.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Flue Gas Desulphurisation (FGD) is mainly installed to reduce:

A SO_2 from thermal power plants

B Noise in silence zones

C Microplastics in oceans

D Groundwater fluoride only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** FGD scrubbers remove SO_2 from power-plant stacks; catalytic converters cut vehicle NOx. **Ans: A.** **FGD** uses lime/limestone to trap **SO_2**. **Trap:** FGD for NOx only, or confusing with catalytic converters (mainly NOx/CO/HC).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Dry deposition in acid rain refers to:

A Acidic gases and particles settling without precipitation

B Only rainfall with pH below 5.6

C Only ocean MARPOL oil spills

D Only indoor chulha smoke

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Acid deposition includes dry deposition — acidic gases/particles settling without rain. **Ans: A.** **Dry deposition** = acids settle without rain; **wet** = with rain/snow/fog. **Trap:** "Acid rain = only liquid rain."

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

The main strong acids in damaging acid rain are formed in the atmosphere from:

A SO_2 and NOx emissions

B Only argon and helium

C Only methane from paddies

D Only carbon dioxide alone

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** H_2SO_4 and HNO_3 form in the atmosphere from primary SO_2 and NOx — a secondary-pollutant pathway. **Ans: A.** **SO_2 → H_2SO_4**; **NOx → HNO_3** in air; CO_2 gives only weak baseline. **Trap:** CO_2 as "main acid rain gas."

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to acid rain, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Acid rain is defined as deposition with pH above 7.0.
2. Normal rain ~pH 5.6 from CO_2 → weak H_2CO_3 — not pH 7.
3. Normal rain is alkaline (pH >7).

A 1 and 3

B Only 2

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is the normal-rain ~pH 5.6 fact. Statement 1 is false — acid rain is below ~5.6, not above 7. Statement 3 is false — normal rain is slightly acidic, not alkaline.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Wet deposition	1 Acidic gases/particles without rain
B Dry deposition	2 Rain/snow/fog
C Main strong path	3 $SO_2 \rightarrow H_2SO_4$ (and NOx → HNO_3)

Code:

A. A-2, B-3, C-1
B. A-1, B-2, C-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Wet/dry/chemistry.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. $CO_2 \rightarrow H_2CO_3$ sets weak baseline
2. CO_2 alone is the main culprit of severe acid rain
3. Acid rain is secondary-pollutant story from secondary SO_2/NOx

A. Only 3
B. Only 1
C. 1 and 2
D. 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Lake waters below about pH 5 can kill fish.

Reason (R): Acid soils can release toxic Al^{3+}.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B. (A) is false, but (R) is true
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; Al^{3+} release does not itself state the lake fish pH threshold. **A/R logic:** Aquatic vs soil effects.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Taj / materials, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Acid deposition weathers marble/limestone.
2. Taj marble → gypsum is the classic Indian fact.
3. Taj Trapezium is the protection belt.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Taj set.

Chapter 40: Desertification (मरुस्थलीकरण) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

India aims to achieve land degradation neutrality by the year

A 2025	B 2030
C 2035	D 2040

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SDG 15.3 Land Degradation Neutrality target year for India is 2030. **Ans: B.** **LDN by 2030** under SDG 15.3 / UNCCD framing. **Trap:** 2025 or 2040 as round-number distractors.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Arrange the following chronologically:

1. Food for Work Programme
2. Community Development Programme
3. Training of Rural Youth for Self-Employment (TRYSEM)
4. Drought Prone Areas Programme (DPAP)

A 4, 2, 3, 1	B 2, 4, 1, 3
C 2, 4, 3, 1	D 4, 2, 1, 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chronology of rural employment/welfare programmes — CDP 1952 → DPAP 1973 → Food for Work 1977 → TRYSEM 1979. **Ans: B.** Order: **CDP (1952) → DPAP (1973) → Food for Work (1977) → TRYSEM (1979)**. **Trap:** Placing DPAP before CDP or TRYSEM before Food for Work.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Thar / Rajasthan desert expanse is mainly of:

A Pliocene	B Paleocene
C Pleistocene and recent deposits	D Oligocene

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Thar desert surficial deposits — Pleistocene and recent, not Paleocene/Oligocene alone. **Ans: C.** Thar cover is **Pleistocene + recent** aeolian/alluvial material. **Trap:** Picking older Tertiary epochs as "desert = ancient only."

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The UN Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) was adopted in:

- **A** 1994
- **B** 1972
- **C** 1987
- **D** 2015

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UNCCD adopted 1994; Desertification and Drought Day is 17 June. **Ans: A.** **UNCCD adopted 17 June 1994** (Paris); in force 1996. **Trap:** Confusing with Rio 1992 or UNFCCC alone.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Desertification, under UN definition, means:

- **A** Land degradation in arid, semi-arid, and dry sub-humid areas
- **B** Only physical expansion of the Thar sand sea eastward
- **C** Any bare patch in a humid rainforest
- **D** Permanent ocean acidification

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Desertification is productivity loss in ASDM drylands — not merely sand-dune expansion. **Ans: A.** **ASDM dryland** productivity loss from climate + human pressure. **Trap:** "Desertification = dunes moving only."

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

The correct sequence of water erosion stages is:

- **A** Sheet → rill → gully → ravine
- **B** Ravine → sheet → gully → rill
- **C** Gully → sheet only
- **D** Wind abrasion → BOD assay

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Water erosion stages — sheet → rill → gully → ravine; Chambal is the classic ravine belt. **Ans: A.** Thin **sheet** loss → **rill** channels → **gullies** → deep **ravines** (Chambal badlands). **Trap:** Reversing ravine and sheet.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following helps **prevent land degradation?**

- **A** Afforestation and shelter belts
- **B** Overgrazing
- **C** Unchecked clear-felling
- **D** Improper irrigation without drainage (salinization)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Afforestation and shelter belts prevent erosion — they are mitigation, not causes of degradation. **Ans: A.** **Afforestation** stabilises soil; overgrazing and salinization **cause** degradation. **Trap:** Statement stems that list afforestation as a "cause."

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The leading human cause of desertification in drylands is often:

A Overgrazing	B Contour bunding
C Check dams	D Watershed management

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Overgrazing is the leading human driver of dryland desertification in standard teaching. **Ans: A.** **Overgrazing** removes cover → erosion; conservation structures are responses. **Trap:** Picking a conservation measure as the "cause."

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Bundelkhand in Uttar Pradesh, often cited for drought stress, includes about how many UP districts in standard lists?

A Seven	B Seventy
C Two	D Zero

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Bundelkhand spans seven UP districts — drought and degradation hotspot linked to desertification risk. **Ans: A.** **Seven districts** — Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot. **Trap:** Treating Bundelkhand as only Rajasthan.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Meteorological drought is commonly indicated when rainfall falls to about:

A Less than 75% of the long-period average	B More than 150% of LPA always
C Exactly 100% of LPA only	D Zero rainfall for one hour

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Meteorological drought — rainfall well below long-period average (IMD often uses <75% LPA as severe marker). **Ans: A.** **<75% LPA** is a standard severe meteorological drought marker. **Trap:** Confusing meteorological with agricultural soil-moisture drought only.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to desertification, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Desertification means land degradation only in humid equatorial forests.
2. Not merely “the desert expanding.”
3. Identical to any bare land in a humid forest belt.

A Only 3
B Only 2
C Only 1
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is the teaching point (not merely desert expansion). Statement 1 is false — desertification is ASDM dryland degradation. Statement 3 wrongly equates it with any bare humid-forest land.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A UNCCD	1 17 June
B Desertification Day	2 Adopted 1994
C LDN	3 No net loss healthy land by 2030 (SDG 15.3)

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3
D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** UNCCD / Day / LDN.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Desertification drivers exclude climate variation, overgrazing, deforestation and bad irrigation.
2. Land degradation — broader; any climate zone
3. UNCCD identical to UNFCCC

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C Only 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (land degradation is broader / any climate zone). Statement 1 denies the standard drivers. Statement 3 is false — UNCCD ≠ UNFCCC.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): India's degraded land share often taught ~29–30% (ISRO Atlas 2016 ~96.4 Mha).

Reason (R): Rajasthan is the worst state neighbourhood teaching.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; Rajasthan rank does not itself prove the national % figure. **A/R logic:** National % vs state worst.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to drought ladder, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Meteorological → hydrological → agricultural teaching order variants exist; met often first.
2. DPAP began in 1973.
3. Drought and desertification reinforce each other.

- **A** 1, 2 and 3
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Drought–desertification link.

Chapter 41: Environmental Monitoring (पर्यावरणीय निगरानी) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD) is a standard criterion for—

A Pollution assay in aquatic ecosystems
B High-altitude O_2
C Blood O_2
D Forest O_2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** BOD assays organic pollution in aquatic ecosystems — not blood or altitude oxygen. **Ans: A.** **BOD** = microbial oxygen demand in water; higher BOD = dirtier water. **Trap:** "Oxygen" in name → medical/altitude options.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Ringelmann scale is used to measure density of

A Smoke
B Polluted water
C Fog
D Noise

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ringelmann scale grades smoke plume opacity 0–5 — not water, fog, or noise. **Ans: A.** **Ringelmann 0–5** = visible **smoke** density from stacks. **Trap:** Fog meter or BOD/water quality distractors.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Annual Groundwater Quality Report 2024 was prepared by:

1. CPCB
2. CWC
3. CGWB

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Annual Groundwater Quality Report is CGWB's product — CPCB handles air/surface water, not this report. **Ans: B (Only 3).** **CGWB** monitors groundwater quality/levels. **Trap:** CPCB name sounds like "all pollution."

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Consider the following statements:

1. Lichens are very good indicators of pollution.
2. Lichens grow well in polluted areas.

A Only 2	**B** Neither
C Both	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Lichens are sensitive SO_2 indicators — they do not grow well in polluted air. **Ans: D (Only 1).** Indicators **die back** in dirty air — statement 2 is false. **Trap:** "Good indicator" read as "likes pollution."

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

SAFAR (System of Air Quality and Weather Forecasting and Research) was inaugurated in July 2018 by:

A Dr. Harsh Vardhan	**B** Governor of RBI
C Director-General of WTO	**D** Secretary, UNFCCC alone

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** SAFAR is IITM's air-quality and weather forecast system — inaugurated by Dr. Harsh Vardhan in July 2018. **Ans: A.** **Dr. Harsh Vardhan** launched SAFAR (IITM-backed). **Trap:** Attributing SAFAR to IMD alone or CPCB alone.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) was launched in:

A 2019	**B** 1974
C 1987	**D** 1730

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** NCAP (2019) expanded monitoring and city action plans for non-attainment cities — complements CPCB networks. **Ans: A.** **NCAP 2019** targets ~20–30% PM cut in 122 cities. **Trap:** Water Act 1974 or Montreal 1987 year swaps.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Stations (CAAQMS) primarily provide:

A Real-time ambient air quality data	**B** Only annual groundwater atlases
C Only Form V filing receipts	**D** Only noise silence-zone maps

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CAAQMS gives continuous real-time ambient air data; NAMP is mainly manual long-term trend stations. **Ans: A.** **CAAQMS** = continuous feeds for AQI boards; **NAMP** = manual trend network. **Trap:** Calling NAMP "real-time only."

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Under the Environment (Protection) Rules, the annual **Environmental Statement (Form V) is filed with:**

A State Pollution Control Board (SPCB)

B Montreal Protocol Secretariat only

C CITES Management Authority only

D Ramsar Bureau only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Form V Environmental Statement under EPA Rule 14 is the annual statutory disclosure to SPCB. **Ans: A.** **Form V** goes to **SPCB** yearly (Rule 14). **Trap:** Confusing with ISO 14001 certificate or EC portal alone.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

ISO 14001 standard relates to:

A Environmental Management Systems

B Carbon credit issuance under Kyoto only

C CITES Appendix listing

D Ringelmann smoke photography only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** ISO 14001 is the voluntary Environmental Management System standard — not a treaty or AQI tool. **Ans: A.** **ISO 14001** = voluntary **EMS** certification. **Trap:** Equating ISO certificate with Form V statutory filing.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Environmental **audit differs from **monitoring** because audit:**

A Verifies compliance with laws, consents, and management systems

B Only publishes one daily AQI colour

C Only measures smoke once without standards

D Replaces all groundwater monitoring by CGWB

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Monitoring collects data; environmental audit verifies legal/EC compliance using that data. **Ans: A.** **Monitoring** = repeated measurement; **audit** = documented compliance check (Form V, EC reports, inspections). **Trap:** "We have AQI data, so audit is done."

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to PSR, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Pressure → State → Response.
2. Indicators are identical to raw instrument readings and never support decisions.
3. PSR means only Ringelmann smoke shade.

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is the PSR chain. Statement 2 is false — indicators convert raw numbers into decision signals. Statement 3 confuses PSR with Ringelmann smoke shade.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A NAMP	1 Real-time air
B CAAQMS	2 Manual air trends
C NWMP	3 Surface water

Code:

(A) A-2, B-3, C-1
(B) A-1, B-2, C-3
(C) A-2, B-1, C-3
(D) A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** CPCB network trio.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Standard air indicators exclude PM2.5, PM10, SO_2, NOx and AQI.
2. Water indicators — BOD, COD, DO, pH, coliform
3. CGWB — surface-water NWMP identical to CPCB

(A) Only 1
(B) 1 and 2
(C) Only 3
(D) Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (BOD/COD/DO/pH/coliform). Statement 1 wrongly excludes the usual air indicators. Statement 3 confuses CGWB groundwater with CPCB surface-water NWMP.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Monitoring is systematic repeated measurement against standards.

Reason (R): An audit is identical to an AQI reading.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(B) (A) is false, but (R) is true
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(D) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Audit checks legal conformity — not just another AQI reading.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to bio-indicators, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Lichens indicate SO_2 stress.
2. Living organisms can reveal chronic pollution stress.
3. Ringelmann is a water-quality number.

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Ringelmann = smoke shade 0–5.

Chapter 42: International Environmental Organizations — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I (Organisation) with List-II (Report):

List-I	List-II
1 UNDP	A Emissions Gap Report
2 IMF	B Human Development Report
3 UNEP	C World Economic Outlook
4 UNCTAD	D World Investment Report

Row order is not the answer code.

A 3 1 4 2

B 1 3 2 4

C 2 4 1 3

D 4 2 3 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Org–report match — Emissions Gap Report is UNEP's; HDR is UNDP's; WEO is IMF's; WIR is UNCTAD's. **Ans: A (3 1 4 2).** HDR→**UNDP**; WEO→**IMF**; WIR→**UNCTAD**; Emissions Gap→**UNEP**. **Trap:** Crediting IPCC or UNDP with Emissions Gap Report.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements:

1. UNDP published the first Human Development Report in 1990 with the HDI.
2. The first HDI team was led by Mahbub-ul-Haq and S. Priesner.

A Only 2

B Neither

C Both

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** HDR/HDI started 1990 under UNDP with Mahbub ul Haq and Amartya Sen — not "Priesner-led" team. **Ans: D (Only 1).** Stmt 1 true; stmt 2 false — **Haq–Sen** lineage, not Priesner. **Trap:** Accepting any plausible Western name on stmt 2.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Global Environment Facility (GEF):

1. It was established in 1991.
2. Only developed countries are donors to the GEF.

A Only 2
B Neither
C Both
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** GEF established 1991; donors are not "developed countries only." **Ans: D (Only 1).** **1991** true; donor statement **false** — developing countries also contribute. **Trap:** Treating GEF as Annex-I-only club.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

HDI was first developed by:

A UNDP
B IMF
C UNICEF
D UNCTAD

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** HDI is UNDP's flagship index — not IMF, UNICEF, or UNCTAD. **Ans: A.** **UNDP** publishes HDR/HDI from **1990**. **Trap:** UNEP because "environment" sounds related.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Jaipur was listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site at the 43rd session held in:

A Baku
B Bishkek
C Istanbul
D Marrakesh

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Jaipur inscribed as UNESCO World Heritage Site at the 43rd session in Baku (2019). **Ans: A (Baku).** **43rd WHC session — Baku, 2019.** **Trap:** Marrakesh/Istanbul as other recent host cities.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

"Limits to Growth" was propounded by:

A Club of Rome
B UNESCO
C Brundtland Commission
D Agenda 21

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Limits to Growth (1972) was Club of Rome — not UNESCO, Brundtland, or Agenda 21. **Ans: A.** **Club of Rome** (1972); Brundtland = Our Common Future; Agenda 21 = Rio 1992. **Trap:** UNESCO because of "education/science" label.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) was established in 1988 by:

- **A** World Meteorological Organization (WMO) and UNEP
- **B** FAO and WHO alone
- **C** IUCN and WWF alone
- **D** UNDP and UNESCO alone

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** IPCC created 1988 by WMO + UNEP; shared Nobel Peace Prize 2007 — does not set NDCs. **Ans: A.** **WMO + UNEP → IPCC (1988)**; Nobel **2007**. **Trap:** IPCC = UNFCCC treaty body (policy is UNFCCC/COP).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which statement is correct?

- **A** IUCN Red List assesses extinction risk; CITES regulates international trade in listed species
- **B** IUCN bans all wildlife trade globally
- **C** CITES publishes the Living Planet Report
- **D** Red List Appendix I–III sets trade permits

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** IUCN Red List assesses extinction risk; CITES regulates international wildlife trade — different jobs. **Ans: A.** **IUCN** = risk assessment; **CITES** = trade regulation (Appendices I–III). **Trap:** "IUCN bans trade" or WWF authorship of Red List.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

The **Living Planet Report is published by:**

- **A** WWF
- **B** IUCN
- **C** IPCC
- **D** FAO

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** WWF publishes Living Planet Report/LPI; IUCN publishes Red List — both HQ in Gland but different roles. **Ans: A.** **WWF** = Living Planet / LPI; **IUCN** = Red List. **Trap:** Same city (Gland) → same organisation.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which pairing of organisation and headquarters is **correct?**

- **A** UNEP — Nairobi; FAO — Rome; UNESCO — Paris
- **B** UNEP — Geneva; FAO — Nairobi; UNESCO — New York
- **C** UNEP — Rome; FAO — Paris; UNESCO — Nairobi
- **D** UNEP — New York; FAO — Gland; UNESCO — Geneva

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** HQ ladder — UNEP Nairobi; FAO Rome; UNESCO Paris; IPCC/WMO Geneva; UNDP New York. **Ans: A.** **UNEP Nairobi**, **FAO Rome**, **UNESCO Paris** (IPCC/WMO Geneva; UNDP New York). **Trap:** UNEP in Geneva because "environment = Geneva agencies."

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to UNEP, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Created after Stockholm 1972; HQ Nairobi.
2. UNEP's flagship products are the Human Development Report and World Development Report.
3. UNEP publishes HDI.

A Only 1	B 1 and 2
C Only 3	D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (Stockholm → UNEP Nairobi). Statement 2 confuses UNEP flagships (Emissions Gap, GEO) with UNDP/World Bank reports. Statement 3 is false — HDI is UNDP, not UNEP.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A UNDP	1 Rome; SOFO
B FAO	2 New York; HDR/HDI
C UNESCO	3 Paris; WH + MAB

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** UNDP/FAO/UNESCO.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. IUCN — Gland; Red List
2. IUCN — Gland; Living Planet Report / LPI
3. WWF — Red List author

A 2 and 3	B Only 1
C 1 and 2	D Only 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Emissions Gap Report is by UNEP.

Reason (R): It is published by the IPCC.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Do not credit IPCC with Emissions Gap.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to IPCC, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. HQ Geneva; created by WMO + UNEP 1988.
2. Shared 2007 Nobel Peace Prize.
3. IPCC sets national NDCs.

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Science assessment — not NDC setter.

Chapter 43: International Environmental Agreements — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Climate change mitigation agreement:

A Montreal Protocol
B Ramsar Convention
C Kyoto Protocol
D CITES

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Climate mitigation treaty among options — Kyoto/Paris/UNFCCC family, not Montreal (ozone) or Ramsar/CITES. **Ans: C.** **Kyoto Protocol (1997)** = binding Annex-I GHG cuts; Montreal = **ozone**. **Trap:** Montreal as generic "environment" answer.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A Cartagena Protocol — Biosafety
B Stockholm Convention — Persistent organic pollutants
C Montreal Protocol — Ozone
D Kyoto Protocol — Save water

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Match-list trap — Kyoto ≠ "save water"; Cartagena=biosafety, Stockholm=POPs, Montreal=ozone are correct pairs. **Ans: D.** **Kyoto = climate/GHG mitigation**, not "save water." **Trap:** Accepting any Kyoto label that sounds like sustainable development.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The concept of carbon credit originated from:

A Ramsar Convention
B Kyoto Protocol
C CITES
D Basel Convention

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Carbon credits originated from Kyoto flexible mechanisms (CDM, JI, emissions trading). **Ans: B.** **Kyoto (1997)** created **CDM/JI/ET** credit architecture. **Trap:** Paris 2015 as "origin" — Paris builds on Kyoto market experience.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following Ramsar sites are **NOT located in Uttar Pradesh?**

1. Sarsai Nawar
2. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
3. Rudrasagar Lake
4. Sultanpur National Park

A 1 and 2
B 3 and 4
C 1 and 4
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP Ramsar geography — Rudrasagar (Tripura) and Sultanpur NP (Haryana) are NOT in UP; Sarsai Nawar and Samaspur are in UP. **Ans: B (3 and 4).** **Rudrasagar = Tripura**; **Sultanpur = Haryana**; Sarsai Nawar and Samaspur **are in UP**. **Trap:** Assuming any famous wetland name is in UP.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The Paris Agreement (2015) differs from Kyoto mainly because Paris relies on:

A Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) by all parties
B Binding Annex-I-only targets for developed countries only
C Wetland wise-use principles
D PIC for hazardous chemicals in trade

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Paris Agreement 2015 uses universal NDCs; UNFCCC 1992 is the Rio parent framework. **Ans: A.** **Paris = universal NDCs**; Kyoto = **Annex-I binding** model. **Trap:** Paris as Kyoto clone with same Annex structure.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

The Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) seeks:

A Conservation, sustainable use, and fair benefit-sharing of genetic resources
B Only ozone layer protection
C Only transboundary hazardous waste shipment
D Only mercury phase-down

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CBD three objectives — conservation, sustainable use, fair benefit-sharing; Cartagena = biosafety; Nagoya = ABS. **Ans: A.** **CBD (1992 Rio)** triple objective; **Cartagena** = biosafety; **Nagoya** = ABS. **Trap:** CBD = CITES trade regulation.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

CITES (1973) primarily regulates:

A International trade in endangered wild fauna and flora

B Migratory bird routes only without trade permits

C Wetland wise use only

D POPs elimination globally

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** CITES 1973 Washington regulates wildlife trade; CMS/Bonn 1979 protects migratory species — different tools. **Ans: A.** **CITES = trade** (Appendices I–III); **CMS = migration** routes/habitats. **Trap:** CMS and CITES swapped.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Stockholm Convention (2001) targets:

A Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs)

B Wetlands of international importance

C Annex-I CO_2 quotas only

D Prior Informed Consent for pesticide trade alone

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chemicals/waste cluster — Basel = hazardous waste; Rotterdam = PIC chemicals; Stockholm 2001 = POPs; Minamata = mercury. **Ans: A.** **Stockholm 2001 = POPs** (DDT, PCBs, etc.). **Trap:** **Stockholm Conference 1972** (UNEP birth) confused with **Stockholm Convention 2001**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Montreal Protocol is chiefly concerned with:

A Substances that deplete the stratospheric ozone layer

B Universal NDC climate pledges

C Mercury emissions from gold mining

D Transboundary movement of hazardous wastes

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Montreal Protocol = ozone/ODS — frequent distractor when stem asks for climate treaty. **Ans: A.** **Montreal 1987 = ODS/CFC phase-out**; climate = UNFCCC/Kyoto/Paris. **Trap:** "Montreal = climate mitigation."

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which statement is **correct?**

A The Stockholm Conference (1972) launched UNEP; the Stockholm Convention (2001) controls POPs — they are different instruments

B Both Stockholms are the same treaty on POPs

C Stockholm 1972 banned DDT globally immediately

D Stockholm 2001 created UNEP in Nairobi

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Two Stockholms — 1972 conference created UNEP; 2001 convention controls POPs. **Ans: A.** **1972 conference ≠ 2001 POPs treaty** — highest-frequency treaty year trap. **Trap:** Single "Stockholm" answer for any chemical question.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to the climate ladder, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. UNFCCC 1992 → Montreal 1997 → Paris 2015.
2. Kyoto mainly Annex-I binding; Paris universal NDCs.
3. Montreal is the main climate-mitigation treaty.

A Only 2
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D Only 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 2 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is false. Statement 2 is true. Statement 3 is false.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Ramsar	1 1973 wildlife trade
B CITES	2 1971 wetlands
C CMS/Bonn	3 1979 migratory species

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3
D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Wetlands/trade/migration.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Basel 1989 — hazardous waste
2. Rotterdam 2008 — PIC chemicals
3. Stockholm 2011 — POPs (≠ 1972 Conference)

A Only 2
B 1 and 3
C Only 1
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Only statement 1 remains true among the numbered claims. Statement 1 is true. Statement 2 is false. Statement 3 is false.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Stockholm 1972 created the UNEP moment.

Reason (R): Stockholm 2001 is the same as the 1972 Conference.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Keep two Stockholms apart.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to CBD family, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. CBD 1992 — conservation, sustainable use, fair benefit-sharing.
2. Cartagena — biosafety protocol under CBD.
3. CBD is identical to Kyoto Annex-I targets.

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Biodiversity ≠ Kyoto climate.

Chapter 44: Current Environmental Issues — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to Mission LiFE, consider the following statements:

1. It was launched in June 2022.
2. The idea was proposed at COP-25 in Madrid.

A Only 2	B Neither
C Both	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** LiFE — launch June 2022 true; idea was at COP26 Glasgow 2021, not COP-25 Madrid. **Ans: D (Only 1).** Launch **June 2022** true; idea = **COP26 Glasgow 2021**, not COP-25 Madrid. **Trap:** Madrid 2019 COP number swap.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to MISHTI, consider the following statements:

1. It was initiated in 2019.
2. It aims to restore mangrove forests.

A Only 2	B Neither
C Both	D Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** MISHTI restores mangroves (true) but was announced in Union Budget 2023–24, not 2019. **Ans: A (Only 2).** Mangrove restoration aim true; year is **Budget 2023–24**, not 2019. **Trap:** Any coastal scheme dated to 2019 by habit.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

In the organisation–report match set, Emissions Gap Report corresponds to:

A UNEP	B IPCC
C UNDP	D WWF

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Org–report match — Emissions Gap Report publisher is UNEP, not IPCC or UNDP. **Ans: A.** Full paper code **A (3 1 4 2)** — Gap→**UNEP**; HDR→UNDP; WEO→IMF; WIR→UNCTAD. **Trap:** IPCC because “emissions” sounds like climate science body.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the 'NET-ZERO' goal for 2050:

1. It means emissions are brought down to zero by 2050.
2. Emissions will be compensated by absorption and removal of GHGs.

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Net zero allows balance via removals — not the same as gross zero (all emissions to absolute zero by 2050). **Ans: B (Only 2).** Stmt 1 = **gross zero** wording; net zero **balances** with sinks/removals. **Trap:** Treating net zero as "no emissions at all."

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Ecological footprint is best described as measuring:

A Human demand on biologically productive land and water in global hectares (gha)
B Total GHGs only in tCO_2e
C Noise in decibels around silence zones
D BOD in mg/L only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Ecological footprint measures human pressure on nature in global hectares (gha) — broader than GHG-only carbon accounting. **Ans: A.** **EF in gha** includes cropland, forest, carbon uptake land, etc. **Trap:** Same unit as carbon footprint (tCO_2e).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Carbon footprint is expressed in:

A Tonnes of CO_2 equivalent (tCO_2e)
B Global hectares only
C Decibels (dB)
D Dobson Units

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Carbon footprint unit is tCO_2e; Scope 1 direct, Scope 2 purchased energy, Scope 3 value chain. **Ans: A.** **tCO_2e** for GHG totals; scopes 1/2/3 cover direct, purchased energy, and indirect chain. **Trap:** gha unit from ecological footprint.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

India's net-zero emissions pledge year is:

A 2070
B 2050
C 2030
D 2100

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** India pledged net zero by 2070 at COP26 Glasgow 2021 — not 2050 like EU/UK. **Ans: A.** **Net zero by 2070** (COP26, 2021); NDC 2030 has 45% intensity cut and 50% non-fossil capacity tracks. **Trap:** 2050 EU/UK year applied to India.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Microplastics are plastic particles smaller than:

A 5 mm
B 5 cm
C 5 m
D 50 km

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Microplastics are plastic particles smaller than 5 mm — primary (microbeads) or secondary (fragmentation). **Ans: A.** Threshold **<5 mm**; India's **SUP ban July 2022** cuts primary sources. **Trap:** 5 cm or "biodegrade in weeks" distractors.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Green hydrogen is produced mainly by:

A Water electrolysis using renewable electricity
B Natural gas reforming without carbon capture (grey hydrogen)
C Coal gasification only
D Diesel generator electrolysis

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Green hydrogen from renewable-powered electrolysis; National Green Hydrogen Mission January 2023 targets ~5 MMT/year by 2030. **Ans: A.** **Green H_2** = renewables + electrolysis; **Mission 2023 → ~5 MMT by 2030**. **Trap:** Grey hydrogen labelled "green."

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which set is **correct?**

A. Blue economy → SDG 14; circular economy ⊂ green economy; NbS = protect/manage/restore ecosystems; “climate refugee” is not a formal 1951 Convention category

B. Circular economy = identical to green economy always; microplastics >5 cm; India net zero 2050; LiFE idea at COP-25 Madrid

C. Green hydrogen = grey natural-gas reforming; MISHTI started 2019; Emissions Gap Report by IPCC

D. Ecological footprint in tCO_2e; carbon footprint in gha; NbS = sulphate aerosol injection

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Blue economy = SDG 14 oceans; circular economy = material loops (SDG 12); NbS = ecosystem actions, not geoengineering; climate migrants lack 1951 Refugee Convention status. **Ans: A.** Consolidates syllabus traps: **SDG 14**, **circular ⊂ green**, **NbS ≠ geoengineering**, **no 1951 climate-refugee status**. **Trap:** Any option mixing footprint units or LiFE/MISHTI dates.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to carbon footprint, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Carbon footprint is measured only in global hectares (gha), never in tCO_2e.
2. Scope 1 direct; Scope 2 purchased energy; Scope 3 value chain.
3. Identical unit to ecological footprint (gha).

A. Only 2

B. 1 and 3

C. Only 1

D. 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 correctly states Scopes 1–3. Statement 1 is false — carbon footprint totals GHGs in tCO_2e. Statement 3 confuses carbon footprint with ecological footprint (gha).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A. Grey hydrogen	1. RE electrolysis
B. Blue hydrogen	2. Natural gas reform
C. Green hydrogen	3. Grey + CCS

Code:

A. A-2, B-1, C-3

B. A-1, B-2, C-3

C. A-2, B-3, C-1

D. A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-3, C-1. **Logic:** Grey/blue/green.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. India's per capita ~2 tCO_2e is higher than USA averages in standard teaching.
2. Absolute emissions still high
3. Net zero India — 2050 identical to EU only

A 1 and 3	**B** Only 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (absolute emissions still high). Statement 1 is false — Indian per capita is low vs USA/global high emitters. Statement 3 is false — India net-zero teaching is 2070, not 2050 identical to EU.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Net zero balances remaining emissions with removals.

Reason (R): Net zero is identical to gross zero with no removals allowed.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true, R false. **A/R logic:** Net zero ≠ gross zero.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to NDC-style facts, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. ~45% intensity cut teaching.
2. ~50% non-fossil capacity teaching.
3. Large forest sink goal neighbourhood.

A 1, 2 and 3	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only	**D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** NDC cluster.

Chapter 45: Environment (पर्यावरण) PYQ Trend Analysis — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to recent UPPCS environment weight, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Roughly 15–20 tagged marks most years.
2. Planning for only 8–10 tagged marks is still the current best estimate.
3. Tagged volume fell to zero after 2018.

A 1 and 3	**B** Only 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 1 is true (~15–20 tagged marks most years). Statement 2 is false — 8–10 planning is outdated. Statement 3 is false — tagged volume did not fall to zero after 2018.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A 2018–20 avg tagged	**1** ~17.7
B 2023–25 avg tagged	**2** ~12
C 2023 peak	**3** 25 questions

Code:

A A-2, B-3, C-1	**B** A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-1, C-3	**D** A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Volume ladder.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. The hottest cluster is only Van Mahotsav ceremony dates.
2. Then pollution; then ecology/ecosystem
3. Hottest cluster — only Van Mahotsav dates

A Only 1	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Statement 2 is true (pollution then ecology/ecosystem after the hottest SDG cluster). Statement 1 is false — SDGs/sustainable development is the hottest cluster. Statement 3 repeats the Van Mahotsav trap.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): 2025 environment paper shifted toward multi-statement, A/R, Match, and NOT-matched.

Reason (R): About two-thirds multi-format teaching — practice must include two-statement and A/R drills.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Both true and R explains the practice implication. **A/R logic:** Format shift → drill mix.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

With reference to scheme year traps, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. LiFE idea COP26 2021 / launch June 2022 — not COP25.
2. MISHTI = 2023 Budget — not 2019.
3. DPAP = 1973; India net zero = 2070; GEF = 1991.

A 1, 2 and 3	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only	**D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Year trap set.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Arrange Montreal vs Kyoto in trend checklist:

- **A** Montreal = climate; Kyoto = ozone
- **B** Montreal = ozone; Kyoto/Paris = climate
- **C** Both identical Ramsar
- **D** Both identical noise dB

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Ozone vs climate. **Logic:** Recurring trap.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Rudrasagar — Tripura
2. Sultanpur — Haryana
3. Nokrek — Manipur

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only pair 3 is not correctly matched. **Logic:** Nokrek = Meghalaya — not Manipur.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): True environment ROI is higher than tagged count.

Reason (R): Reports and protected-area facts leak into other GS subjects.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Both true and R explains A. **A/R logic:** Cross-subject leakage.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to 2020/2024 dips, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tagged count dipped.
2. Cross-subject environment leakage in Economy and Geography still hides weight.
3. Dips mean environment can be skipped entirely.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Do not skip.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Emissions Gap	1 2070
B India net zero	2 UNEP
C DPAP	3 1973

Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3
B A-1, B-2, C-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1
D A-3, B-1, C-2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: A-2, B-1, C-3. **Logic:** Report / NZ / DPAP.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange study ROI priority teaching:

A Only Tier-4 rare topics first
B SDGs + UP protected-area traps near top; then current issues, ecology, climate/pollution, treaties/orgs
C Only Earth Hour
D Only Ringelmann

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: ROI order from heat map. **Logic:** Priority spine.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to rising 2023–25 lines, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. SDGs, wildlife, biodiversity, biosphere, forests.
2. Current schemes such as LiFE and MISHTI.
3. Only tubeless-tyre CFC stems.

A 1 and 3 only	**B** 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 2 only	**D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 and 2. **Logic:** Rising cluster.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Many "UP BR" claims are false.

Reason (R): Uttar Pradesh has zero Biosphere Reserves in standard teaching.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Both true and R explains A. **A/R logic:** UP BR trap.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following correctly states 2025 tagged count neighbourhood?

A Only 2	**B** Zero
C Exactly 8 always	**D** Stayed strong at 19

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: 19 in 2025. **Logic:** Strong year.

Q15 **UP RO/ARO 2014**

How many of the following UP negative geography facts are correct?

Rudrasagar≠UP; Sultanpur≠UP; Nokrek≠Manipur

A All three

B Only two

C Only one

D None

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three. **Logic:** Negative geography set.